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Final Lap

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This Academic Support Material is a thoughtfully curated collection of learning materials designed to support students of Standard X in achieving excellence in their English examinations. More than a conventional study guide, this resource is the result of careful planning and the expertise of experienced educators who are well acquainted with the curriculum and the academic challenges faced by students. Its primary objective is to equip learners with effective tools, practical strategies, and clear insights that will help them secure high marks while strengthening their overall command of the English language.

Understanding the value of systematic and goal-oriented preparation, this study material offers a wide range of resources aimed at enhancing both examination performance and language proficiency. The material is structured to promote clarity, confidence, and deeper understanding, enabling students to approach their studies with focus and purpose.

As students progress through this resource, they are encouraged to use it as a guide to navigate the demands of the English syllabus. With consistent effort, strategic practice, and a positive mindset, learners can unlock their full potential and approach their examinations with assurance.

The collection features model questions, answer keys, grammar exercises, writing tips, and practical strategies for effective time management during examinations. Each section addresses common areas of difficulty and provides clear, actionable guidance to support independent and confident learning.

We extend our sincere gratitude to the students and teachers whose valuable feedback and suggestions have contributed to refining this material. It is our hope that this study material will serve as a reliable companion for students, guiding them toward success in their upcoming examinations and laying a strong foundation for future academic pursuits.

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Content Development Team

RAJEEV JOSEPH, St Thomas HSS Erumeli
DHEERAJ AUGUSTINE, St Thomas HSS Marangattupally
JOHNSON T P, CMS HS Pallom
ANJALI A, Ithithanam HSS Malakunnam
Dr JAISON K MATHEW, Lecturer, DIET Kottayam

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COMPREHENSION PASSAGES (PROSE)

UNIT 1 - TRIALS AND TRIUMPHS

The Old Man with Enormous Wings

by Gabriel Garcia Marquez

About the Story:

One gloomy afternoon, Pelayo discovers a frail old man with enormous wings lying face down in the mud. Frightened, he and his wife Elisenda inspect the man closely. Dressed in rags and barely able to speak in an unknown language, the old man appears more like a drenched grandfather than a divine being. They assume he's a shipwrecked foreigner, but a neighbour insists he is an angel who has come for their sick child. The next day, the entire town crowds their courtyard, treating the angel like a spectacle. Pelayo locks him in the chicken coop (birds of a feather!), and when the child recovers, the couple briefly consider setting the angel free.

Instead, Elisenda capitalizes on the situation, charging an admission fee to see the angel. Pilgrims and others from afar visit the angel, hoping for miracles. The angel, passive and enduring, does not resist the indignities he suffers—being pelted with food, poked by cripples, and jeered at like a circus animal. Despite his wings, his only strength seems to be his infinite patience. The people soon lose interest when a new attraction—a spider-woman with a tragic tale—arrives. Still, the couple become wealthy, build a mansion, and improve their lives, ignoring the fact that the angel's condition has worsened.

As time passes; the angel becomes weaker, grows almost blind, and remains bedraggled, but he survives. One day, as Elisenda cuts onions in the kitchen, she sees the angel struggling to fly. At last, he lifts off clumsily and disappears into the distance. Elisenda watches until he becomes a mere dot on the horizon, relieved that the strange burden has finally left their lives.

1. Read the excerpt taken from the story *A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings* and answer the questions that follow.

The man was dressed like a ragpicker. There were only a few faded hairs left on his bald skull and very few teeth in his mouth. His pitiful condition seemed that of a drenched great-grandfather. This took away any sense of grandeur he might have had. His huge buzzard wings, dirty and half-plucked, were entangled in the mud.

They looked at him so long and so closely that Pelayo and Elisenda very soon overcame their surprise. In the end they found him familiar. Then they dared speak to him. He answered in an incomprehensible dialect with a strong sailor's voice.

They concluded that he was a lonely castaway from some foreign ship, wrecked by the storm. Then they called in a neighbour woman to see him. All she needed was one look to show them their mistake."He's an angel," she told them. "He must have been coming for the child, but the poor fellow is so old that the rain knocked him down."

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1. The description of the old man as “dressed like a ragpicker” mainly highlights his …….. .
   A) royal appearance B) supernatural power
   C) poor and miserable condition D) mysterious origin
2. Why did Pelayo and Elisenda initially conclude that the old man was a lonely castaway?
   A) He claimed to be from another land TRIALS AND TRIUMPHS
   B) He spoke in a familiar language
   C) His wings were injured
   D) He spoke in an incomprehensible dialect and looked weather-beaten
3. Which of the following details suggest the old man’s weakness and helplessness?
   A) Very few teeth in his mouth
   B) Huge buzzard wings entangled in the mud
   C) Strong sailor’s voice
   D) Pitiful condition like a drenched great-grandfather

Choose the right option

   i) A, B, and D ii) B, C and D
   iii) A and D iv) None of the above

4. How did the neighbour woman’s reaction differ from that of Pelayo and Elisenda, and what conclusion did she draw about the old man?
5. Pick out the **Noun Phrase** in the subject position and **Verb phrase** in the sentence that follows

   ‘His pitiful condition seemed that of a drenched great-grandfather.’

2. Read the excerpt taken from the story *A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings* and answer the questions that follow.

The angel was the only one who took no part in his own act. He spent his time trying to get comfortable in his borrowed nest. At first, they tried to make him eat some mothballs. But he ate nothing but eggplant mush.

His only supernatural virtue seemed to be patience. He was quite patient when the hens pecked at him, searching for the parasites in his wings. He was patient again when the cripples pulled out his feathers to touch their limbs with. He remained patient when even the most merciful threw stones at him. After all, they were only trying to get him to rise so that they could see him standing.

It so happened that during those days there arrived in the town a travelling show. The main attraction was a woman who had been changed into a spider by a burst of thunder and lightning. The admission fee to see her was less than the fee to see the angel. So, the people flocked to see her. They were also permitted to ask her all manner of questions about her absurd state.

1. Why does the author say that the angel “took no part in his own act”?
   A) He enjoyed entertaining the crowd B) He actively performed miracles
   C) He remainIn the Attic- Wladyslaw Szpilmaned passive and indifferent to the attention
   D) He was unaware of the people around him

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2. What food did the angel finally eat?

A) Mothballs B) Fruits and vegetables

C) Bread and water D) Eggplant mush

3. Which incidents from the passage show the angel's patience?

A) Hens pecking at his wings B) Cripples pulling out his feathers

C) People throwing stones at him D) People asking him questions

Choose the right option

i) A, B and D ii) B, C and D

iii) A, B and C iv) B, C and D

4. Why did the people lose interest in the angel and flock to see the woman in the travelling show?

5. Find a word from the passage that means *strange or ridiculous.*

In the Attic
by Wladyslaw Szpilman

About the Story:

"In the Attic" is an excerpt from Wladyslaw Szpilman's survivor testimony tiled " The Pianist". It revolves around the unusual friendship between Szpilman and Captain Wilm Hosenfeld, a German officer. Hosenfeld discovers Szpilman hiding in an abandoned building and asks him to play the piano. Amidst the unrest and the precarious circumstances that prevailed, Szpilman plays Chopin's Nocturne in C- sharp minor, which moves Hosenfeld deeply. The officer offers to take Szpilman to a safer location and it is then that he learns that Szpilman was a Jew.

Instead of turning him in, he offers to help Szpilman and advices him to stay in a loft which was a safer place than the loft where he had originally hid. Hosenfeld promises to bring Szpilman food. At this point Szpilman realises that he is being helped by a German officer. Hosenfeld admits to the fact that he is ashamed of identifying himself as a German and feels a sense of horror and shame at what has been happening. Despite being on opposite sides of the conflict, Szpilman and Hosenfeld find common ground through music. After three days Hosenfeld returns with several loaves of bread and jam which would eventually keep Szpilman alive for days to come. He tells Szpilman that the war would soon be over and that he must 'hang on'. The gesture instills in him confidence and a renewed hope for survival. Szpilman continues to live in isolation often without human contact for long intervals of time with the only sound he hears is artillery fire and of soldiers going up and down the stairs where he was hiding. He also endures extreme cold, lack of sanitation and pitiable living conditions amidst living in constant fear of discovery, arrest and deportation to concentration camps.

The officer returns one last time on December 12 and brings along with him a larger supply of bread and a warm eiderdown. He tells Szpilman that he would be leaving Warsaw and that he must under no circumstance lose heart. Hosenfeld reminds Szpilman that if they have survived the inferno for over five years, it was God's will. At the parting moment, Szpilman expresses his gratitude and promises to repay Hosenfeld's kindness and assistance that helped him survive the war. That was the last time he

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saw the officer. Szpilman survives another year. The passage of time gnaws his conscience and he recounts the loss of his family, the traumatic experiences distress him.

On the morning of January 15, Szpilman listens to announcements on the street of the defeat of Germany 28and the liberation of Warsaw. He stays in a delusional state not knowing what to do or how to react to the news. Then he comes across voices of women and children. He runs downstairs and peeps out to get a view of the street and finds a woman police officer and a lady carrying a bundle on her head. As Szpilman tries to talk to the lady, she shrieks in fear seeing him wearing a German coat and suspecting that he is a German. Szpilman was wearing the coat Captain Hosenfeld had given him which leads to the misunderstanding and him being reprimanded by Polish soldiers. Later, the soldiers understand the situation and Szpilman is rescued and finally walks free. The friendship between Szpilman and Hosenfeld remains a powerful testament to the human capacity for connection and compassion, even in the most challenging circumstances. Szpilman's story is a testament to the human spirit's ability to persevere in the face of adversity.

1. **Read the excerpt taken from the story *In the Attic* and answer the questions that follow.**

He looked at me more closely. Then his glance fell on the door to the other room. An idea seemed to have struck him. "Come with me, will you?" We went into the next room where a piano stood by the wall. The officer pointed to the instrument "Play something!"

I looked enquiringly at him and did not move. He obviously sensed my fears, since he added reassuringly, "It's all right, you can play. If anyone comes, you can hide in the larder and I'll say it was me trying the instrument out."

When I placed my fingers on the keyboard they shook. I hadn't practised for two and half years, my fingers were stiff and covered with a thick layer of dirt, and I had not cut my nails for some weeks. I played Chopin's Nocturne in C sharp minor. When I finished, the silence seemed gloomy and eerie. I heard a shot down below outside the building – a harsh, loud German noise.

The officer looked at me in silence. After a while he sighed, and muttered, "All the same, you shouldn't stay here. I'll take you out of the city, to a village. You'll be safer there." I shook my head. "I can't leave this place," I said firmly. Only now did he seem to understand my real reason for hiding among the ruins.

1. Why did the officer take the narrator into the next room?

A) To search the room
B) To hide from others
C) To ask him to play the piano
D) To rest for a while

2. Which piece of music did the narrator play on the piano?

A) Beethoven's Moonlight Sonata
B) Chopin's Nocturne in C sharp minor
C) Mozart's Symphony No. 40
D) Bach's Prelude in C

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3. Which details from the passage reveal the narrator's poor physical condition?

A) His fingers were shaking
B) His nails were uncut for weeks
C) His fingers were stiff and dirty
D) He refused to play the piano

Choose the right option.

i) A, B and D
ii) A, C and D
iii) A, B and C
iv) B, C and D

4. Why did the narrator refuse the officer's offer to take him to a village?
5. Find a word from the passage that means *dark, frightening, and mysterious.*

*2.***Read the excerpt taken from the story *In the Attic* and answer the questions that follow.**

On 14 January unusual noises in the building and the street outside woke me. Soldiers ran up and down the stairs, and I heard agitated, nervous voices. Early in the morning of 15 January, the sound of artillery from the previously silent front was heard. The gTRIALS AND TRIUMPHSround and the walls of the building shook under the constant dull thunder. Three hours later the heavy artillery fire died down again, but I was as nervous as ever. I did not sleep at all that night. The street fighting would begin at any moment, and I could be killed. The night passed peacefully. Around one o'clock I heard the remaining Germans leaving the building. Silence fell. I could not even hear the steps of the guards outside the building. Not until the early hours of the next day was the silence broken by a loud and resonant noise, the last sound I had expected. Radio loudspeakers set up somewhere nearby were broadcasting announcements in Polish of the defeat of Germany and the liberation of Warsaw.

The Germans had withdrawn without a fight. As soon as it began to get light, I prepared feverishly for my first venture out. My officer had left me a German military overcoat to keep me from freezing. I had already put it on when I suddenly heard the rhythmic footsteps of guards out in the road again. Had the Soviet and Polish troops withdrawn, then?

1. What first woke the narrator on 14 January?

A) The sound of radio announcements
B) Unusual noises in the building and the street
C) The footsteps of Polish soldiers
D) Heavy artillery fire

2. Which announcement was broadcast through the radio loudspeakers?

A) The beginning of street fighting
B) The retreat of Soviet troops
C) The defeat of Germany and liberation of Warsaw
D) A curfew order for civilians

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3. Which details show the narrator's fear and tension during the events described?

A) He did not sleep the entire night

B) The ground and walls shook from artillery fire

C) He prepared feverishly to go out

D) He heard announcements in Polish

Choose the right option

i) A, D and C ii) B, C and D

iii) A, B and D iv) A, B and C

4. Why was the narrator confused and anxious when he heard footsteps again after wearing the German overcoat?

5. Identify the Noun Phrase in the subject position and Verb Phrase in the sentence below.

The ground and the walls of the building shook under the constant dull thunder.

UNIT II - PATHS TO PROGRESS

Breaking Barriers, I will Fly
by Srikanth Bolla

About the Speech:

Srikanth Bolla, born blind in 1991 in Seetharamapuram, Andhra Pradesh, is a true icon of resilience and innovation.Despite hurdles in his early education, he pursued the study of science, eventually taking a degree in management from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT)

In 2012, Srikanth co-founded Bollant Industries with the stated mission of \providing employment opportunities to individuals with disabilities and to promote sustainable manufacturing. Starting with a modest amount of capital, the company achieved an annual turnover exceeding ₹150 crore in 2018. Bollant Industries specialises in eco- friendly products, such as areca leaf plates, cups, trays, and biodegradable packing materials from recycled paper and agricultural waste.

Bollant Industries is remarkably inclusive, with differently-abled individuals forming a significant part of its workforce. It has expanded its operations across various states in India, and has received backing from prominent investors like Ratan Tata. Srikanth's journey earned him a spot in Forbes Asia's 30 Under 30 list in 2017. His life story was depicted in the 2024 biopic Srikanth, starring Rajkummar

1. **Read the excerpt taken from *Breaking Barriers*, *I will Fly* and answer the questions that follow.**

When I was born without eyes, society saw me as a burden. Some even suggested that I should be smothered. But my parents showered on me immense love and care. They felt they were the richest couple in the world, and I consider myself the luckiest person.

As a child, I spent much of my time with my father in the fields. However, my short legs made it difficult for me to help. My father began to think that perhaps the people who doubted my future might

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be right. He realized I didn't fit into the traditional farming model. Then he decided that education was to be my path.

Despite the challenges of trekking to a faraway school and being ignored by teachers and classmates, I persevered. For two years, I sat on the last bench, excluded from activities. I then felt like the poorest child in the world—not on account of lack of money, but because of loneliness and isolation.

Eventually, my parents and relatives decided that I should study in a school with students like me. So, I was sent to a special school in Hyderabad. There I excelled, becoming an outstanding student, earning top ranks, and representing India in chess and cricket. I had the privilege of working with Dr A.P.J. Abdul Kalam on various projects like the Lead India Youth Transformation Project.

1. Why did society initially consider the narrator a burden?
   A) He was born into a poor family B) He was born without eyes
   C) He could not help in the fields D) He was ignored by teachers
2. What made the narrator's father decide that education should be his path?
   A) His success in sports B) His love for books
   C) His inability to fit into traditional farming work D) Advice from teachers
3. Which factors contributed to the narrator feeling like the "poorest child in the world"?
   A) Lack of money B) Loneliness and isolation
   C) Being ignored by teachers and classmates D) Difficulty in walking long distances

Choose the right option

   i)A and C ii) B and C
   iii) C and D iv) All the above

4. How did studying in a special school change the narrator's life?
5. Find a word from the passage that means *continued to make efforts despite difficulties.*

2. **Read the excerpt taken from *Breaking Barriers*, *I will Fly* and answer the questions that follow.**

We established a platform, Bollant Industries together with my partner, to find, rehabilitate, nurture, and reintegrate disabled individuals into society, rather than separate them from it. We have supported over 3,000 students in education, vocational rehabilitation, sports, and much more. Our company now employs over 150 disabled individuals. It grosses over a million dollars in sales. But we're still at the initial stage of our growth, with much more to do.

I want to leave you with three lessons. First, show compassion and help others thrive. True wealth doesn't come from money but from the happiness of others. Second, remove loneliness from people's lives, as it is the worst form of poverty. Finally, remember that when you do something good, you will be the first to benefit. The world may look at me and say, "Srikanth, you can do nothing." But I look at the world and say, "I can do anything." Thank you.

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1. What is the main purpose of establishing Bollant Industries?
   A) To make maximum profit
   B) To provide employment only to skilled workers
   C) To rehabilitate and reintegrate disabled individuals into society
   D) To separate disabled individuals from mainstream society
2. Which of the following best reflects the current status of Bollant Industries?
   A) It has completed its mission successfully
   B) It is still in the early stage of growth
   C) It employs more than 3,000 people
   D) It earns no profit
3. Which of the following activities are supported by Bollant Industries?
   A) Education B) Vocational rehabilitation
   C) Sports D) Political training

Choose the right option
   i) A, B and C ii) B, C and D
   iii) A, C and D iv) All the above

4. What three lessons does the speaker want to leave with the audience?
5. Find a word from the passage that means *helped to become part of society again.*

A Phoenix Rises
by Twinkle Khanna

About the story:

Arunachalam Muruganantham (also known as 'Padman') is a well-known innovator and social entrepreneur born in 1962 in Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu. He grew up in a family of handloom weavers. After his father died in a road accident, Muruganantham dropped out of school at the age of 14 to support his family.

Fighting against the challenges, Muruganantham's determination led him to design inexpensive machinery to produce sanitary napkins. This won him the National Innovation Foundation's Grassroots Technological Innovations Award in 2006. The innovation brought revolutionary changes to menstrual health and hygiene for rural women in India and other countries. Muruganantham's achievements have by now been recognised globally. He was named one of Time Magazine's '100 Most Influential People in the World' in 2014. He also received the Padma Shri award from the Indian government in 2016.

As a social entrepreneur, Muruganantham founded Jayashree Industries, which markets his low-cost machines to groups of rural women across India and elsewhere. His work has impacted millions of lives, providing affordable solutions to problems relating to menstrual hygiene and empowering women. Muruganantham's story is the subject of the documentary Menstrual Man; and the The Legend of

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Lakshmi Prasad. He is also a motivational speaker, sharing his story in places like the IIMs in Ahmedabad, and Bangalore, IIT Bombay, and Harvard University.

1. Read the excerpt taken from *A Phoenix Rises* and answer the questions that follow.

Having seen his father working with cotton yarn, he knew that ten grams of cotton would barely cost ten paise. But here he was paying four rupees for each of these pads. He put the pad back in the packet. Back home, Bablu secretly handed over the pack to Gowri.

Gowri was not pleased. “If Shalu and I start buying these packets every month, then let alone curd and ghee, we will not even have enough money to buy milk.” Bablu looked at her dejectedly. But he then determined to start a new project.

He pulled out a pair of scissors, a needle and some thread, cotton and cloth from his bag. He began flattening the cotton between his hands as if he were spreading out dough to make a chapati. Within twenty- four hours of first touching a sanitary napkin, Bablu had managed to make his own. But he was not able to make a useful one as he could not make out the material used by the brands. Months passed and Bablu procured different qualities of cotton and other materials to make pads.

1. Why was Bablu shocked by the price of the sanitary pads?
   A) They were difficult to find B) He knew cotton was very cheap
   C) The shopkeeper cheated him D) Gowri refused to use them
2. Why was Gowri unhappy with Bablu buying sanitary pads?
   A) She disliked the quality of the pads B) She felt they were unnecessary
   C) They were too expensive for the family D) She preferred homemade pads
3. Which actions show Bablu’s determination to solve the problem?
   A) He secretly handed the pack to Gowri
   B) He decided to start a new project
   C) He experimented with cotton and other materials
   D) He complained about the price to the shopkeeper

Choose the right option

   i)A and B ii) C and D
   iii) B and C iv) All the above

4. How did Bablu try to overcome the problem of costly sanitary pads?
5. Find a word from the passage that means *sad and disappointed.*

2. Read the excerpt taken from *A Phoenix Rises* and answer the questions that follow.

However, his experiments and his obsession caused some unrest even in the family. His mother beseeched him to stop the experiments saying that the whole family would be disgraced by his sordid

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interest in women's menstrual cycles. The news was gradually spreading in the village and the villagers entangled the whole family in a mesh of coarse whispers and rude glances.

Bablu was gloomy for a while at the thought of stopping his experiments. But he devised an idea to conduct experiments on himself rather than others. With the help of a friend, he collected some blood. Using a rubber tube, he experimented with the napkins himself. One day, Lata, his neighbour Parul's daughter, happened to see this.

The next day all kinds of rumours spread over the small town. Unable to bear the humiliation, Bablu's wife left him. She said she would only return when he gave up his madness. His mother too followed suit. He had lost his wife, his family, his friends, and money that he could not afford to waste, all in pursuit of the sanitary pad project. Bablu was a simple welder whose life had been ripped apart. And all because he had wanted to give Gowri a gift: a gift for all the poor women in the village and outside it

1. Why did Bablu's mother ask him to stop his experiments?
   A) They were too expensive
   B) They took too much time
   C) She feared the family would be disgraced
   D) The experiments were unsuccessful
2. What made Bablu decide to conduct experiments on himself?
   A) Lack of materials
   B) Fear of villagers
   C) To avoid involving others and stop unrest
   D) His wife's encouragement
3. Which factors contributed to Bablu's isolation and suffering?
   A) Villagers spreading rumours
   B) His wife leaving him
   C) His mother's support
   D) Loss of friends and money

Choose the right option

   i) A, B and D
   ii) A, C and D
   iii) B, C and D
   iv) None of the above

4. How did Bablu's dedication to his project affect his personal life?
5. Identify the Noun Phrase in the subject position and Verb Phrase from the sentence belo

   The next day all kinds of rumours spread over the small town.

UNIT III - TRUMPETS OF CHANGE

War

by Luigi Pirandello

About the Story:

Luigi Pirandello's short story War is set in the context of World War I. The action takes place on a train carrying a group of passengers, most of whom are parents of soldiers fighting at the front. Among them is a grieving couple whose only son has recently been called to war. The mother, devastated by this, remains silent and withdrawn, while the father, though sorrowful, attempts to stay calm and

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composed. As the train moves, the passengers engage in a conversation about their children and cost of war.

The discussion soon turns into a debate about patriotic duty. One father, whose son has died in battle, argues that parents should not mourn selfishly. He claims that once children grow up, they belong to the country, not to their families. He insists that soldiers go to war for honour, and parents should take pride in the sacrifice rather than grieve the loss. His words seem to carry conviction, and for the moment, the other passengers appear to accept his reasoning.

The grieving father whose son had recently been conscripted listens carefully to the discussion but does not speak at first. The other passengers try to comfort themselves by holding on to the idea that their sons are destined to die for a noble cause. They convince themselves that the children are fulfilling their patriotic duty and that as parents they should be proud rather than sad. This notion provides some relief, and they try to suppress their sorrow.

However, as the conversation progresses, the man who had at first spoken so confidently about the nobility of sacrifice begins to show signs of grief and pain. His voice starts to tremble, and his expressions betray the enormity of his sorrow.This transformation is triggered by the grieving mother who had been silent. At one point, she breaks in with the question to the man if his son is truly dead. The man is unable to respond at first. Then, overwhelmed by emotion, he breaks down, realizing at that very moment the depth of his suffering and the extent of his self-deception.

This transforms the atmosphere in the compartment. The passengers, who had been trying to rationalize their pain now recognize the undeniable grief in their own hearts and souls. They had tried to convince themselves that the sacrifices of their sons were necessary and honourable, but now they see they cannot escape the unbearable weight of inevitable loss. Even the strongest conviction of patriotic duty cannot negate the sorrow of losing one’s child.

In this story, Pirandello shows us little we know ourselves. People often successfully hide their pain even from themselves behind a dark curtain of high- sounding ideals. The curtain will, however, sooner or later, be ripped away from our own eyes at least. The story highlights the universal anguish of parents who send their children to war. It is a powerful reflection on the cost of ‘duty’ and the explosion of suppressed suffering.

1. Read the excerpt taken from the story *War* and answer the questions that follow.

The passengers who had left Rome by the night express had to stop until dawn at the small station of Fabriano. They then needed to continue their journey by the old- fashioned local train to Sulmona. At dawn, in a stuffy and smoky second class carriage in which a few people had already spent the night, a stout woman in deep mourning was hoisted in. Behind her, puffing and moaning, followed her husband—a tiny man, thin and weak, his face death-white. His eyes were small and bright and he looked shy and uneasy. Having at last taken a seat, he politely thanked the passengers who had helped his wife by making room for her. Then he turned round to the woman and politely inquired: “Are

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you all right, dear?" The wife, instead of answering, pulled up the collar of her coat to hide her face. "Nasty world," muttered the husband with a sad smile.

And he felt it his duty to explain to his travelling companions that the poor woman was to be pitied. The war was taking away from her their only son, a boy of twenty. Both of them had devoted their entire life to him. They had even broken up their home at Sulmona to follow him to Rome, where he had to go as a student. They allowed him to volunteer for war with an assurance that for at least six months he would not be sent to the war front. And now, all of a sudden, they received a wire from him saying that he was due to leave in three days' time. They were now going to see him off.

1. Why did the passengers have to stop at the station of Fabriano?

A) The train was delayed due to war B) They had to change to a local train

C) The station was their final destination D) The train broke down

2. How is the husband described in the passage?

A) Tall and strong B) Loud and confident

C) Tiny, weak, and uneasy D) Angry and aggressive

3. Which details show the parents' deep attachment to their son?

A) They broke up their home to follow him to Rome

B) They allowed him to volunteer for the war

C) They devoted their entire life to him

D) They were travelling to see him off

Choose the right option

i) A, C and D ii) A, B anC

iii) A, B and D iv) A and C

4. Why does the husband feel that his wife "was to be pitied"?

5. Identify the Noun Phrase and Verb Phrase in the sentence below.

The passengers who had left Rome by the night express had to stop until dawn at the small station of Fabriano.

2. Read the excerpt taken from the story *War* and answer the questions that follow.

The woman, bundled in a corner, had been sitting and listening till he finished. For the last three months, she had been trying to find in the words of her husband and her friends, something to console her. She wanted something that might show her how a mother should send her son to a probable danger of life. Her grief had been greater in seeing that nobody—as she thought—could share her feelings.

But now the words of the traveller amazed and almost stunned her. She suddenly realised that it wasn't the others who were wrong, but herself. It was she who could not rise up to the height of those

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other fathers and mothers. They seemed willing to resign themselves, without crying, not only to the departure of their sons but even to their death.

She lifted her head and bent over from her corner. She was trying to listen with great attention to the details which the stout man was giving to his companions. He was telling them the way his son had fallen as a hero, for his Country, happy and without regrets. It seemed to her that she had stumbled into a world so far unknown to her. And she was so pleased to hear everyone joining in congratulating that brave father, so stoically speaking of his child's death.

1. Why had the woman been listening carefully to the words of her husband and friends for the last three months?

A) To argue with them
B) To distract herself from her sorrow
C) To find something that could console her
D) To understand the rules of war

2. What effect did the traveller's words have on the woman?

A) They made her angrier
B) They confused her completely
C) They amazed and almost stunned her
D) They made her leave the compartment

3. Which details show the woman's change in attitude?

A) She realised she herself was unable to rise to the height of other parents
B) She listened attentively to the stout man's account
C) She felt happy hearing people congratulate the brave father
D) She remained silent in her corner

Choose the right option

i) A, B and C
ii) A, C and D
iii) B, C and D
iv) All the above

4. How did the woman's understanding of her grief change after listening to the traveller?

5. Find a word from the passage that means *calmly accepting suffering or pain without complaint.*

A Piece of String
by Guy de Maupassant

About the Story:

Guy de Maupassant's short story A Piece of String is set in a small French village and revolves around Hauchecome, an innocent peasant, whose life is turned upside down by a simple misunderstanding. The story begins on a market day in Goderville, when the villagers gather to trade goods and share news. Hauchecome, a humble and thrifty farmer, stoops to pick up a small piece of string on the ground, as he believes that anything useful should be saved. Unfortunately, this action is

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witnessed by Malandain, an old enemy, who misinterprets it and spreads the rumour that Hauchecome had picked up something precious.

When news spreads that a pocketbook containing money has gone missing, suspicion immediately falls on Hauchecome. He is summoned to the Mayor's office, where the Mayor, a pompous personality, questions him sternly. Hauchecome tries to explain that he had only picked up a piece of string, showing it to the Mayor in an attempt to establish his innocence. However, the Mayor does not believe him, insisting that Malandain, a reputable man, had seen him pick up the pocketbook. Hauchecome is allowed to go, but the seed of doubt has been planted in the minds of the villagers

The villagers crowd around Hauchecome, demanding an explanation and making fun of his protestations of innocence. The man tirelessly retells the story of the piece of string to anyone who will listen, hoping to clear his name. Even when the pocketbook is found and returned by someone else, the villagers continue to suspect Hauchecome of being involved in the 'fraud.' They laugh at his explanations, dismissing these as lies or excuses.

Hauchecome becomes obsessed with defending his honour and clearing his name. Each time he tells the story, he is met with scorn and disbelief. Through repeated accusations and ridicule, the villagers drive Hauchecome to despair. The weight of suspicion breaks him down. Finally, he falls ill and dies, haunted by the injustice of his experience. In his final delirious moments, he still mumbles the tale of the piece of string, and dies a victim of gossip, misunderstanding and prejudice.

1. Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow.

Hauchecome had just arrived at Goderville, and he was walking towards the public square. Then he saw a little piece of string on the ground. He thought that everything useful ought to be picked up. He took the bit of thin cord from the ground and began to roll it carefully. Then he noticed Malandain, on the threshold of his door, looking at him. They were on bad terms with each other. Hauchecome was seized with shame to be seen thus by his enemy. He concealed his find quickly in his trousers pocket. He pretended to be looking on the ground for something else. Then, he went towards the market.

He was soon lost in the noisy crowd. Soon, the square was deserted. At the tavern, the great hall was full of people eating. An appetising odour of roast meat rose from the hearth which made everybody's mouth water. The dishes were passed and emptied, as were the jugs of cider. The peasants discussed the crops, and their purchases and sales. The weather was favourable for the green things but not for the wheat. Suddenly the drum beat in the courtyard outside the tavern. Everybody rose, except a few, and ran to the door or to the windows, their mouths still full. After the public crier had ceased his drum beating, he called out in a jerky voice:

"This is hereby made known to the inhabitants of Goderville, and to all persons present at the market: There was lost this morning on the road, between nine and ten o'clock, a black leather pocketbook containing five hundred francs and some business papers. The finder is requested to return the same with all haste to the Mayor's office. There will be twenty francs reward."

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1. Why did Hauchecome pick up the piece of string?

A) He wanted to sell it in the market
B) He thought everything useful should be picked up
C) He mistook it for a purse
D) He wanted to hide it from Malandain

2. Why did Hauchecome feel ashamed when he saw Malandain?

A) Malandain had accused him earlier
B) He was stealing something
C) Malandain was his enemy and saw him picking up the string
D) Malandain laughed at him

3. Which details show Hauchecome's attempt to hide his action?

A) He quickly hid the string in his pocket
B) He pretended to look for something else on the ground
C) He immediately left the town
D) He went towards the market

Choose the right option

i) A and B
ii) B and C
iii) A, C and D
iv) All the above

4. What announcement did the public crier make, and why did it draw everyone's attention?

5. Identify the Noun Phrase and Verb Phrase in the sentence below.

A black leather pocketbook containing five hundred francs and some business papers.

2. Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow.

The next day about one o'clock in the afternoon, an employee in a shop returned the pocketbook. The man claimed to have found the object in the road. Not knowing how to read, he had given it to his employer.

The news spread through the neighbourhood. Hauchecome was informed of it. He immediately began to recount his story with its happy climax. He was in triumph. He talked of his adventure all day long. He told it on the highway to people who were passing by, in the wine shop to people who were drinking there and to persons coming out of church the following Sunday. He stopped strangers to tell them about it.

He was calm now, and yet something disturbed him. People had the air of joking while they listened. They did not seem convinced. He seemed to feel that remarks were being made behind his back. The next Tuesday, he went to the market at Goderville, just to discuss the case. Malandain,

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standing at his door, began to laugh on seeing him pass. When he was seated at the table in the tavern, he began to explain the affair.

1. Who returned the lost pocketbook the next day?
   A) Hauchecome B) Malandain
   C) An employee in a shop D) The Mayor

2. How did Hauchecome react after hearing that the pocketbook was found?
   A) He remained silent and calm B) He felt ashamed and avoided people
   C) He began to recount his story repeatedly D) He left Goderville

3. Which details show that Hauchecome was becoming uneasy despite his calmness?
   A) People joked while listening to him
   B) He felt remarks were being made behind his back
   C) Malandain laughed on seeing him
   D) He continued to visit the market

Choose the right option
   i) A and B ii) B and C
   iii) A, B and C iv) All the above

4. Why did Hauchecome feel disturbed even though he was calm and confident about his story?
5. Identify the Noun Phrase and Verb Phrase in the sentence below.
   An employee in a shop returned the pocketbook.

UNIT IV - WOODLAND WHISPERS

Trills and Thrills: Birdwatching in India
by Dr Salim Ali

Read the excerpt taken from the autobiography *Trills and Thrills: Birdwatching in India* and answer the questions that follow.

My journey by the romantic Cochin Forest Tramway was in February 1946, shortly before it was dismantled to make way for the gigantic Parambikulam hydro-electric project. The huge dam and reservoir have now completely submerged Parambikulam and all the lovely country around it. We reached Parambikulam just as it was getting dark. In the verandah of the forest bungalow, I found a large group of Kadar adivasis, and in their midst, a bare-footed ‘topless’ European male in crumpled khaki shorts.

We soon introduced ourselves. He was an Austrian anthropologist, Baron Omar Rolf. He claimed ornithology to be his second love and expressed great keenness on accompanying me the next morning.

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Led by a forest guard, we were stalking along a narrow animal trail through dense tall grassland above five feet high – the right kind of habitat for the Broad-tailed Grass Warbler.

1. Who did the narrator meet in the verandah of the forest bungalow at Parambikulam?

2. When did the narrator travel by the Cochin Forest Tramway?
   A) January 1947 B) February 1946
   C) March 1945 D) December 1946

3. Why was the Cochin Forest Tramway dismantled?
   A) To build a railway station
   B) To make way for agricultural expansion
   C) To construct the Parambikulam hydro-electric project
   D) To create a wildlife sanctuary

4. Pick out an instance of how modernisation affects the environment.

5. Pick out the Noun Phrase and Verb Phrase from the sentence given below.
   The huge dam and reservoir has now completely submerged Parambikulam.

2. **Read the excerpt taken from the autobiography *Trills and Thrills: Birdwatching in India* and answer the questions that follow**.

Ornithology may sometimes entail hazards of a different kind. I recall one particularly hair-raising incident along the Himalayan trail from Almora to the Lipu Lekh Pass on my way to Lake Manasarovar and Mount Kailas in 1945. It was at a particularly narrow part of the trail with a thousand feet of vertical scarp on one side and the roaring Kali river some 300 feet vertically down the other. The porters pitched the tent there, though I had walked ahead of them. Just at that moment a tiny bird – how well I remember that Yellow-naped Yuhina! – got up to the top of a bush, some yards away on the flanking hillside.

Just as I got it in the field of my glasses, it hopped a bit further up. So, to get a better view I took a step back, with the glasses still glued to my eyes, entirely unmindful of where I was standing with my back to the abyss. As I did so, I felt a small pebble slip from under my heel and heard a faint continuing clatter as it went rolling down the hill. Still unmindful of anything untoward, I casually looked back over my shoulder. What I saw literally made my hair stand on end. In a flash I realised that I was on the very edge of beyond two inches more and I would have followed that rollicking pebble.

1. Where did the narrator have the hair-raising experience?
   A) Near Lake Manasarovar
   B) On the Himalayan trail from Almora to the Lipu Lekh Pass
   C) On the banks of the Kali river
   D) At Mount Kailas

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2. What distracted the narrator and led to the dangerous situation?

A) The roaring sound of the Kali river B) The narrowness of the trail
C) A tiny bird he was observing D) The arrival of the porters

3. Which details show the seriousness of the danger the narrator was in?

A) The trail had a thousand-foot vertical scarp B) The Kali river was roaring below
C) He was only two inches away from the edge D) The porters pitched the tent nearby

Choose the right option

i) A, B and C ii) A and B
iii) B and D iv) All the above

4. Why did the narrator realise that he was in grave danger only after hearing the pebble roll down?

5. Find a word from the passage that means *a deep, dangerous drop.*

UNIT V - SONGS OF THE SELF

Beloved Boles
by Maxim Gorky

About the Story

Beloved Boles by Maxim Gorky is a touching story about loneliness, imagination, and the deep human need for affection. The story is narrated by a young student living in Moscow, whose room faces that of a Polish woman named Teresa. At first, the student is uncomfortable around her. Teresa is tall, strong, and rough- looking, with a loud bass voice, bushy eyebrows, and a coarse face. She often appears drunk, with messy hair and bleary eyes, and her loud greetings make him uneasy. Because of her strange and intimidating appearance, he always keeps his door shut when she is at home.

One day, Teresa approaches the student with an unusual request. She asks him to write a letter to a man named Boleslav Kashput, whom she lovingly calls “Boles,” her “beloved,” her “heart of gold.” Though surprised by her tender words, the student writes the letter as she dictates. When she returns later asking him to write a reply “from Boles,” he grows suspicious. Her nervousness and trembling hands confuse him further. Finally, irritated, he accuses her of lying and trying to fool him. Hurt and frightened, Teresa runs away in distress. Feeling uneasy after their encounter, the student visits her room and discovers the truth. Teresa breaks down and confesses that Boles does not exist at all. She has invented him because she has no one in the world who shows her affection or speaks to her kindly. The letters allow her to imagine that someone loves her and cares for her. Writing to Boles and receiving replies makes her feel less lonely and gives her the illusion of being valued. When others read the letters

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aloud, she feels, for a moment, that Boles is truly by her side. Hearing her painful confession, the student is overwhelmed with sympathy and shame for misunderstanding her.

From that day onwards, the student begins writing letters to Boles and replies to Teresa regularly, twice a week. She listens to them and weeps loudly, moved by the imaginary affection she longs for so deeply. In return, she mends his torn clothes and looks after his small needs. Her simple acts of care show her gratitude for the emotional comfort the letters provide. After some months, Teresa is arrested for unknown reasons, and the narrator believes she must be dead now. Reflecting on her life, he realises how people like Teresa, who have suffered bitterness and loneliness, hunger more than anyone for kindness and tenderness. The story ends with a powerful message: while society judges people from the outside, it often fails to see their emotional pain, and the lack of love can drive people to create their own fragile fantasies to survive.

1. Read the excerpt taken from *Beloved Boles* and answer the questions that follow.

An acquaintance of mine once told me this story:

When I was a student at Moscow, I happened to live alongside a Polish woman, Teresa by name. She was tall and strong, with bushy black eyebrows, dark brown hair and a large coarse face. The gleam of her dark eyes, her thick bass* voice, and her muscular vigour, horrified me. I lived on the top floor and her room was opposite mine. I never left my door open when I knew her to be at home. Sometimes I chanced to meet her on the staircase or in the yard, and she would smile at me. Occasionally, I saw her drunk, with bleary eyes, and tousled hair. On such occasions she would speak to me.

"How d'ye do, Mr Student!" she'd say with a stupid laugh. I should have liked to change my quarters; but my little chamber was a nice one. There was such a wide view from the window, and it was always so quiet in the street below–so I endured. One morning I was sprawling on my couch, trying to find some sort of excuse for not attending my class. The door opened, and Teresa's bass voice resounded:

"Good health to you, Mr Student!"

"What do you want?" I asked. I saw that she was confused. This was very unusual for her.

"Sir! I want to beg a favour of you. Will you grant it?"

I lay there silent.

"I want to send a letter home, that's what it is," she said; her voice was beseeching, soft, timid. I jumped, sat down at my table, took a sheet of paper, and said:

"Come here, sit down, and dictate!"

1. How does the narrator initially feel about Teresa?

A) He admires her strength
B) He is frightened and uncomfortable around her
C) He feels friendly towards her
D) He is indifferent to her presence

2. Why did the narrator not change his quarters despite disliking Teresa?

A) He could not afford another room
B) Teresa persuaded him to stay
C) He liked his room and its surroundings
D) He feared meeting new neighbours

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3. Which details show Teresa's usual intimidating nature?

A) Her thick bass voice
B) Her muscular vigour
C) Her timid and beseeching tone
D) Her coarse facial features

Choose the right option

i) A, B and D
ii) A and C
iii) B, C and D
iv) All the above

4. What change does the narrator notice in Teresa when she comes to ask for a favour?
5. Find a word from the passage that means *unkempt or untidy.*

2. Read the excerpt taken from *Beloved Boles* and answer the questions that follow.

And thenceforth, regularly, twice a week, I wrote a letter to Boles, and an answer from Boles to Teresa. She, of course, listened to them, and wept like anything. She roared, I should say, with her bass voice. And in return for my service, she began to mend the holes I had in my socks, shirts, and other articles of clothing. Three months later she was thrown into prison for some reason or the other and by now she must surely be dead.

My acquaintance shook the ash from his cigarette, looked pensively up at the sky, and thus concluded: Well, well, the more a human creature has tasted of bitter things, the more it hungers after the sweet things of life. And we, wrapped in the rags of our virtues, regard others through the mist of our self- sufficiency. Convinced of our righteousness, we do not understand this.

And the whole thing turns out pretty stupidly–and very cruelly. But enough of this. It is all as old as the hills. So old that it is a shame to speak of it. Very old indeed–yes, that's what it is!

1. Why did Teresa weep while listening to the letters?

A) They reminded her of her hardships
B) They were badly written
C) They brought her emotional comfort and memories
D) They contained bad news

2. How did Teresa repay the narrator for writing the letters?

A) By giving him money
B) By cooking meals for him
C) By mending his clothes
D) By protecting him from others

3. Which statements reflect the acquaintance's reflection on human nature?

A) People who suffer value sweetness more deeply
B) Humans judge others through self-righteousness
C) Everyone is naturally kind and understanding
D) People often fail to understand others' pain

Choose the right option

i) A, B and D
ii) A and C
iii) B, C and D
iv) All the above

4. What message does the acquaintance convey through his concluding remarks?
5. Find a word from the passage that means *thoughtfully or deeply.*

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Préférence Nationale
by Fatou Diome

About the Story:

Fatou Diome's Préférence Nationale is a powerful and deeply personal narrative that exposes the everyday racism, prejudice, and structural discrimination faced by immigrants in France. The narrator, a Senegalese woman living in Strasbourg, describes how the French system creates barriers for foreigners, especially through laws that quietly delay or deny citizenship. She sarcastically remarks that even her Senegalese cat has official papers, while she, a human being, is denied recognition. Her sharp humour highlights how laws, though created by governments, are enforced and strengthened by ordinary people who apply them rigidly in daily life.

In her search for work, the narrator responds to a newspaper advertisement from a city-center bakery seeking a salesgirl. Despite her qualifications, her French friend discourages her, failing to understand the challenges immigrants face. Determined to survive, the narrator visits the bakery, only to encounter racial prejudice face to face. The bakery owner, a man with a German moustache and a hat in French colours, dismisses her the moment he sees her skin. He insists she speak the local Alsatian dialect, knowing she cannot, and finally humiliates her by suggesting she should "work in her own country." His refusal reveals how préférence nationale, the idea of privileging French natives over foreigners, operates not just in law but in people's attitudes.

Still unemployed, the narrator later applies for another job as a French tutor. When she meets the woman, a supermarket cashier, she is once again rejected purely because she is not 'European-type.' Despite having a degree and more competence than the woman judging her, she is dismissed due to her race. The narrator responds with dignity and sharp wit, exposing the hypocrisy of someone who looks down on her while lacking the education she possesses. The woman's final racist insult only reinforces the cruelty the narrator faces, but she remains emotionally strong, remarking that unlike those who turn red with anger or shame, her skin "always keeps its dignity." Through these incidents, Diome portrays the harsh realities of immigrants who struggle not because of a lack of qualifications, but because of systemic racism and social prejudice. Despite this, the narrator's voice remains strong, intelligent, and courageous as she challenges injustice with satire, truth, and a refusal to lose her self-respect. Ultimately, the story reveals that identity is not granted by society's approval but shaped by one's inner strength, dignity, and resilience.

1. Read the excerpt taken from *Préférence Nationale* and answer the questions that follow.

The law changed very quietly, thanks to Mr Borders: if you're married to a French citizen, it will now take two years for you to claim the benefits of citizenship. By this delay, Mr Borders is relying on the nature of his countrymen to break up the relationship. Then, as the ex-wife of a Frenchman, the foreign woman becomes no more than an ex-object. And as with any object, she has no rights, not even

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the right to earn an honest living. They won't give me citizenship, but my Senegalese cat has his papers. Perhaps it's because he's ginger.

Laws only gather pace when ordinary people start applying them. Termites can cause the collapse of \African mahogany trees, and the size of an anthill depends on the number of worker ants. It is thus the small employers who make the policy of preference nationale effective.

I was looking for a job in one of the free papers and came across this ad: Large bakery in the city centre looking for salesgirl. Dialect desirable. Please come to the shop.

1. What change in the law is mentioned in the passage?
   A) Foreigners cannot marry French citizens
   B) Citizenship can be claimed immediately after marriage
   C) A foreign spouse must wait two years to claim citizenship
   D) Citizenship is granted only to skilled workers

2. What comparison does the writer make to explain how laws become effective?
   A) Laws and machines
   B) Laws and elections
   C) Laws and natural processes like termites and ants
   D) Laws and written documents

3. Which statements highlight the writer’s criticism of the law and society?
   A) The law relies on relationships breaking up
   B) Ordinary people help enforce discriminatory policies
   C) Foreigners are treated with dignity
   D) Even animals seem to have more rights than people

Choose the right option
   i) A, B and D
   ii) A and C
   iii) B, C and D
   iv) All the above

4. Why does the writer mention her Senegalese cat having citizenship papers?
5. Identify the Noun Phrase and Verb Phrase from the sentence below.
   My Senegalese cat has his papers.

2. Read the excerpt taken from *Préférence Nationale* and answer the questions that follow.

When I arrived at the cafe it was packed, but Madame had told me she would be wearing ‘a white jersey with blue stripes’. I spotted her immediately. I introduced myself and showed her a part of my brain that had been lying dormant in a folder: the famous degree.

Then the waiter approached in a friendly way and asked, "And for you, madame?” I ordered some kind of mocktail, thinking, that's funny - when they want to sell something, national preference is nowhere to be seen. The waiter brought my glass. The woman opposite me examined the piece of paper, then gave it back to me, saying, “I want a European-type person.” Lifting her chin in the air, she added, “I don't want anyone messing up my child's education.”

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Madame is French, true, but hasn't even passed her degree and seems to think she could not tutor her daughter herself. She is refusing me work on account of my black lips which can drone the niceties of French grammar better than hers.

1. How did the narrator recognise Madame in the café?
   A) By the waiter's description
   B) By her voice
   C) By the white jersey with blue stripes
   D) By the document she was holding

2. Why does the narrator find the waiter's behaviour ironic?
   A) The waiter was rude to her
   B) National preference disappeared when selling something
   C) The waiter refused to serve her
   D) The café was overcrowded

3. Which details show Madame's prejudice and hypocrisy?
   A) She demanded a "European-type person"
   B) She examined the narrator's degree
   C) She doubted the narrator's ability despite her qualifications
   D) She admitted she could tutor her child herself

Choose the right option
   i) A, B and C
   ii) A and C
   iii) B, C and D
   iv) All the above

4. Why does the narrator feel insulted and unfairly treated by Madame?
5. Identify the Noun Phrase and Verb Phrase from the sentence below.
   The woman opposite me examined the piece of paper

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POSSIBLE ANSWERS

UNIT 1 - TRIALS AND TRIUMPHS

The Old Man with Enormous Wings

Passage 1

1. C) poor and miserable condition
2. D) He spoke in an incomprehensible dialect and looked weather-beaten
3. iii) A, B and D
4. Pelayo and Elisenda believed that the old man was a lonely castaway from a foreign ship but the neighbour woman immediately recognised him as an angel.
5. NP: His pitiful condition. VP: seemed that of a drenched great-grandfather.

Passage 2

1. C) He remained passive and indifferent to the attention
2. D) Eggplant mush
3. iii) A, B and C
4. The admission fee to see her was less than the fee to see the angel. So, the people flocked to see her
5. absurd

In the Attic

Passage 1

1. C) To ask him to play the piano
2. B) Chopin's Nocturne in C sharp minor
3. iii) A, B and C
4. The narrator refused the officer's offer because he felt deeply attached to the place where he was hiding.
5. eerie

Passage 2

1. B) Unusual noises in the building and the street
2. C) The defeat of Germany and liberation of Warsaw
3. iv) A, B and C
4. The narrator became anxious because he feared that the Soviet and Polish troops might have withdrawn and that German soldiers had returned.
5. NP: The ground and the walls of the building. VP: shook under the constant dull thunder.

UNIT II - PATHS TO PROGRESS

Breaking Barriers, I will Fly

Passage 1

1. B) He was born without eyes
2. C) His inability to fit into traditional farming work
3. ii) B and C

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4. Studying in a special school transformed the narrator's life by giving him acceptance, opportunities, and encouragement. There he excelled academically, achieved top ranks, represented India in sports, and gained the confidence that led him to work on important national projects.
5. persevered

Passage 2

1. C) To rehabilitate and reintegrate disabled individuals into society
2. B) It is still in the early stage of growth
3. i) A, B and C
4. The speaker wants to convey three lessons: to show compassion and help others thrive, to remove loneliness from people's lives as it is the worst form of poverty, and to remember that doing good benefits the doer first
5. reintegrate

A Phoenix Rises

Passage 1

1. B) He knew cotton was very cheap
2. C) They were too expensive for the family
3. iii) B and C
4. Bablu decided to make sanitary pads on his own using cotton and cloth. He experimented with different materials over several months in order to create a useful and affordable sanitary napkin.
5. dejected

Passage 2

1. C) She feared the family would be disgraced.
2. C) To avoid involving others and stop unrest
3. i) A, B and D
4. Bablu's dedication to the sanitary pad project caused severe personal loss. He was humiliated by rumours, abandoned by his wife and mother, lost his friends and money, and was left isolated.
5. NP: The next day all kinds of rumours VP: spread over the small town.

UNIT III - TRUMPETS OF CHANGE

War

Passage 1

1. B) They had to change to a local train
2. C) Tiny, weak, and uneasy
3. i) A, C and D
4. The husband feels that his wife was to be pitied because the war was taking away their only son. She was deeply distressed as they were going to see him off to the war front.
5. NP: The passengers who had left Rome by the night express
   VP: had to stop until dawn at the small station of Fabriano.

Passage 2

1. C) To find something that could console her
2. C) They amazed and almost stunned her

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3. i) A, B and C
4. After listening to the traveller, the woman realised that her grief was different from that of other parents. She felt that she was unable to accept her son's possible death as bravely as others who spoke of sacrifice and heroism. This understanding changed the way she looked at her sorrow.
5. stoically

A Piece of String

Passage 1

1. B) He thought everything useful should be picked up
2. C) Malandain was his enemy and saw him picking up the string
3. i) A and B
4. The public crier announced that a black leather pocketbook containing five hundred francs and business papers had been lost and offered a reward for its return. This drew everyone's attention because it was an important and valuable loss announced publicly in the market.
5. NP: A black leather pocketbook VP: containing five hundred francs and some business papers.

Passage 2

1. C) An employee in a shop
2. C) He began to recount his story repeatedly
3. iii) A, B and C
4. Hauchecome felt disturbed because people did not seem convinced by his explanations. Their joking manner, the feeling that they were speaking behind his back, and Malandain's laughter made him realise that he was still suspected and not fully believed.
5. NP: An employee in a shop VP: returned the pocketbook

UNIT – 4 – WOODLAND WHISPERS

Trills and Thrills: Birdwatching in India

Passage 1

1. He found a large group of Kadar adivasis, and in their midst, a bare-footed 'topless' European male in crumpled khaki shorts the Austrian anthropologist, Baron Omar Rolf.
2. B) February 1946
3. C) To construct the Parambikulam hydro-electric project
4. The construction of the huge dam and reservoir completely submerged Parambikulam and all the lovely country around it.
5. NP: The huge dam and reservoir VP: has now completely submerged Parambikulam.

Passage 2

1. B) On the Himalayan trail from Almora to the Lipu Lekh Pass
2. C) A tiny bird he was observing
3. i) A, B and C
4. The narrator realised the danger only after hearing the pebble roll down and looking back, which made him aware that he was standing on the very edge of the abyss
5. abyss

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UNIT V - SONGS OF THE SELF

Beloved Boles

Passage 1

1. B) He is frightened and uncomfortable around her
2. C) He liked his room and its surroundings
3. i) A, B and D
4. When Teresa comes to ask for a favour, the narrator notices that she is confused, soft-spoken, and timid, which is completely different from her usual bold and intimidating manner.
5. tousled

Passage 2

1. C) They brought her emotional comfort and memories
2. C) By mending his clothes
3. i) A, B and D
4. The acquaintance conveys that human beings often judge others harshly without understanding their suffering. He suggests that those who have experienced pain crave kindness, while others, blinded by self-righteousness, fail to show empathy, making life cruel and unjust.
5. pensively

Préférence Nationale

Passage 1

1. C) A foreign spouse must wait two years to claim citizenship
2. C) Laws and natural processes like termites and ants
3. i) A, B and D
4. The writer mentions her Senegalese cat to highlight the absurdity and injustice of the law. By showing that even her cat has official papers while she does not, she criticises the unfair treatment of foreign women and the rigid citizenship rules.
5. NP: My Senegalese cat VP: has his papers.

Passage 2

1. C) By the white jersey with blue stripes
2. B) National preference disappeared when selling something
3. ii) A and C
4. The narrator feels insulted because Madame rejects her despite her qualifications, solely due to her appearance and racial prejudice.
5. NP: The woman opposite me VP: examined the piece of paper.

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COMPREHENSION - POETRY

1. **Read the lines from *Friends ,Romans ,Countrymen* ... and answer the questions that follow.**

Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears;
I come to bury Caesar, not to praise him.
The evil that men do lives after them;
The good is oft interred with their bones;
So let it be with Caesar. The noble Brutus
Hath told you Caesar was ambitious:
If it were so, it was a grievous fault;
And grievously hath Caesar answered it.
Here, under leave of Brutus and the rest, -
For Brutus is an honourable man;

a. Who claimed that Caesar was ambitious?

b. Why do you think Antony starts the speech with Friends, Romans, countrymen?

i. He is so worried after the murder of Caesar.
ii. He wants to create an emotional bond with the crowd.
iii. He is trying to provoke the crowd against the murderers.
iv. He has no intension.

c. What is the occasion of Mark Antony's speech?

d. Which literary device is Antony using while he says "For Brutus is an honourable man"?

e. What does the speaker mean by saying 'the evil that men do lives after them'?

2. Read the lines from *Friends, Romans, Countrymen* ... and answer the questions that follow.

For Brutus is an honourable man;
So are they all, all honourable men, -
Come I to speak in Caesar's funeral.
He was my friend, faithful and just to me:
But Brutus says he was ambitious;
And Brutus is an honourable man.
He hath brought many captives home to Rome,
Whose ransoms did the general coffers fill:
Did this in Caesar seem ambitious?

a. What is the significance of the line 'For Brutus is an honourable man''?

b. Which literary device is used in the line "Did this in Caesar seem ambitious?"

i. Irony
ii. Apostrophe
iii. Rhetorical question
iv. judgment

c . What does the speaker mean by these lines
"He hath ..... coffers fill"

d. What is the purpose of Antony's speech

i. to praise Brutus
ii. to contemn Caesar
iii. to bury Caesar
iv. to disprove Brutus

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3. Read the lines from *Friends, Romans, Countrymen* ... and answer the questions that follow.

When that the poor have cried, Caesar hath wept:
Ambition should be made of sterner stuff:
Yet Brutus says he was ambitious;
And Brutus is an honourable man.
You all did see that on the Lupercal
I thrice presented him a kingly crown,
Which he did thrice refuse: was this ambition?
Yet Brutus says he was ambitious;
And, sure, he is an honourable man.
I speak not to disprove what Brutus spoke,
But here I am to speak what I do know.

a. According to Antony which of the following is not a quality of Brutus

i. Faithfulness ii. Ambition
iii. Loyalty iv. Honour

b. Pick out the lines that show Caesar was selfless.

c. What did Caesar do when the poor cried?

d. What was Caesar's reaction to the crown?

e. "Ambition should be made of sterner stuff"; What does the line suggest?

4. Read the lines from *Friends, Romans, Countrymen* ...and answer the questions that follow.

I speak not to disprove what Brutus spoke,
But here I am to speak what I do know.
You all did love him once, not without cause:
What cause withholds you, then, to mourn for him?
O judgement, thou art fled to brutish beasts,
And men have lost their reason! - Bear with me;
My heart is in the coffin there with Caesar,
And I must pause till it come back to me.

a. Who is the speaker ?

b. What was Antony's final appeal to the crowd?

c. 'My heart is in the coffin there with Caesar' find out the poetic device used here.

i. Metaphor ii. Irony
iii. Hyperbole iv. Personification

d. What does the line "O judgement, thou art fled to brutish beasts,
And men have lost their reason" suggest?

a. Mark Antony b. To mourn for Caesar.
c. Hyperbole
d. the crowd has lost their ability to think and they are acting or behaving like beast.

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5. Read the lines from *The Seedling* and answer the questions that follow.

As a quiet little seedling
Lay within its darksome bed,
To itself it fell a-talking,
And this is what it said:
"I am not so very robust,
But I'll do the best I can;"
And the seedling from that moment
Its work of life began.

a. What does the seedling say about itself?

i. I am very healthy.
ii. I am not ready to grow.
iii. I am not very robust.
iv . I am not ready to talk.

b. Pick out the line that suggests the seedling's optimistic attitude .

c. Which poetic device is used in the line 'To itself it fell a-talking'?

d. Where did the seedling lie?

6. Read the lines from *The Seedling* and answer the questions that follow.

So it pushed a little leaflet
Up into the light of day,
To examine the surroundings
And show the rest the way.
The leaflet liked the prospect,
So it called its brother, Stem;
Then two other leaflets heard it,
And quickly followed them.

a. What did the seedling push up into the day light?

b. Pick out a set of rhyming words .

c. Why did the seedling push a leaflet out?

d. How did the leaflets react to the call of the stem?

7. Read the lines from *The Seedling* and answer the questions that follow.

Little folks, be like the seedling,
Always do the best you can;
Every child must share life's labour
Just as well as every man.
And the sun and showers will help you
Through the lonesome, struggling hours,
Till you raise to light and beauty
Virtue's fair, unfading flowers.

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a. Whom does the speaker address ?

i. Sun ii. Leaflets
iii. Children iv. Every man

b. What lesson does the seedling teach us?

c. What does the phrase unfading flower suggest?

d. Pick out the line that suggests the hard times in life.

8. Read the lines from *Another Day in Paradise* and answer the questions that follow.

She calls out to the man on the street
"Sir, can you help me?
It's cold and I've nowhere to sleep,
Is there somewhere you can tell me?"
He walks on, doesn't look back
He pretends he can't hear her
Starts to whistle as he crosses the street
Seems embarrassed to be there.
Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for
You and me in paradise.
Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for you,
You and me in paradise,
Think about it.

a. Pick out an instance of irony from the lines.

b. What does the woman ask the man on the street?

c. How does the man respond to the woman's call?

d. Comment on the line "Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for
You and me in paradise".

9. Read the lines from *Another Day in Paradise* and answer the questions that follow.

She calls out to the man on the street.
He can see she's been crying,
She's got blisters on the soles of her feet
She can't walk but she's trying
Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for
You and me in paradise.
Oh, think twice, it's just another day for you,
You and me in paradise.
Just think about it.

a. Why can't the woman walk?

b. The word paradise in the context refers to

i. Street ii. heaven
iii. A life without suffering. iv. A lower-class life.

c. Pick out an instance of visual image from the given lines.

d. Which line brings out the resilience of the woman?

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10. Read the lines from *Another Day in Paradise* and answer the questions that follow.

Oh Lord, is there nothing more anybody can do
Oh Lord, there must be something you can say.
You can tell from the lines on her face
You can see that she's been there,
Probably been moved on from every place
'Cause she didn't fit in there.
Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for
You and me in paradise.
Oh, think twice, it's just another day for you,
You and me in paradise.
Just think about it.
It's just another day for you and me in paradise,
It's just another day for you and me in paradise
Just think about it

a. What do the lines on the woman's face suggest?

b. Pick out an instance of metaphor from the lines?

c. The woman probably been moved on from every place. Why?

i. because she doesn't like the place.
ii. because the society often pushes her away.
iii. because she is searching her family.
iv. because the society accepts her plea.

d. What is the message of the poem?

11. Read the lines from *Wild Swans at Coole* and answer the questions that follow.

The trees are in their autumn beauty,
The woodland paths are dry,
Under the October twilight the water
Mirrors a still sky;
Upon the brimming water among the stones
Are nine-and-fifty swans.
The nineteenth autumn has come upon me
Since I first made my count;
I saw, before I had well finished,
All suddenly mount
And scatter wheeling in great broken rings
Upon their clamorous wings.

a. Autumn season is pictured in the poem .Do you think it is significant ? Why?
b. What changes the poet might have noticed in nature during autumn season?
c. What did the swans do when the poet tries to count them?
d. Pick out an instance of visual image form the lines.
e. Comment on the line 'The nineteenth autumn has come upon me ,Since I first made my count.

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12. Read the lines from *Wild Swans at Coole* and answer the questions that follow.

I have looked upon those brilliant creatures,
And now my heart is sore.
All's changed since I, hearing at twilight,
The first time on this shore,
The bell-beat of their wings above my head,
Trod with a lighter tread.
Unwearied still, lover by lover,
They paddle in the cold
Companionable streams or climb the air;
Their hearts have not grown old;
Passion or conquest, wander where they will,
Attend upon them still.

a. What is the tone of the poem?

i. Happy and enthusiastic ii. Reflective and nostalgic
iii. Anger and bitterness iv. Optimism

b. How do the swans' actions contrast with the speaker's emotions?
c. What has triggered the speaker's sorrow?
d. Pick out an instance of auditory image from the lines.

13. Read the lines from *Wild Swans at Coole* and answer the questions that follow.

Unwearied still, lover by lover,
They paddle in the cold
Companionable streams or climb the air;
Their hearts have not grown old;
Passion or conquest, wander where they will,
Attend upon them still.
But now they drift on the still water,
Mysterious, beautiful;
Among what rushes will they build,
By what lake's edge or pool
Delight men's eyes when I awake some day
To find they have flown away?

a. How do the swans paddle and soar?
b. The inspiration of the swans fails to delight the poet .Why?
c. Which poetic device is used in the line ‘Passion or conquest, wander where they will, Attend upon them still’.

i. Simile ii. Metaphor
iii. Personification iv. Irony

d. Find out the rhyme scheme of the stanza.

14. Read the lines from *Mirror* and answer the questions that follow.

I am silver and exact. I have no preconceptions.
Whatever I see I swallow immediately

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Just as it is, unmisted by love or dislike.
I am not cruel, only truthful,
The eye of a little god, four-cornered.
Most of the time I meditate on the opposite wall.
It is pink, with speckles. I have looked at it so long
I think it is part of my heart. But it flickers.
Faces and darkness separate us over and over.

a. Who is the speaker of the poem?
b. Pick out an instance of personification from the stanza.
c. How does the mirror consider the opposite wall?
d. What separate the mirror and the wall?
e. How does the mirror describe itself?
f. What does the line 'I have no preconceptions' convey?

15. Read the lines from *Mirror* and answer the questions that follow.

Now I am a lake. A woman bends over me,
Searching my reaches for what she really is.
Then she turns to those liars, the candles or the moon.
I see her back, and reflect it faithfully.
She rewards me with tears and an agitation of hands.
I am important to her. She comes and goes.
Each morning it is her face that replaces the darkness.
In me she has drowned a young girl, and in me an old woman
Rises toward her day after day, like a terrible fish.

a. Who looked into the mirror?
   i. The Wall ii. The Moon
   iii. The young girl iv. The Woman
b. Who are considered as liars?
c. What does the woman search in the mirror?
d. Why does the mirror consider itself as a lake?
e. Pick out the line that shows how much the woman dislikes her present appearance.
f. Why does the woman turn to candles and moon?
g. Comment on the comparison 'Rises toward her day after day, like a terrible fish'.

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Answers – Comprehension (Poetry)

1. Answers

a. Brutus
b. ii. He wants to create an emotional bond with the crowd.
c. At the funeral of Julius Caesar.
d. Irony
e. Mistakes are remembered and kindness and goodness are often forgotten.

2. Answers

a. It is a poetic device called irony. The speakers intention is to destroy Brutus's reputation.
b. iii. Rhetorical question
c. The speaker is highlighting Caesar's loyalty and sincerity to Rome.
d. iv. to disprove Brutus

3. Answers

a. ii. Ambition
b. I thrice presented him a kingly crown,
Which he did thrice refuse.
c. He wept.
d. He refused the crown thrice.
e. The line suggests that ambitious person should not show compassion or empathy.

4. Answers

a. Mark Antony
b. To mourn for Caesar.
c. iii. Hyperbole
d. The line suggest that the crowd has lost their ability to think and they are acting or behaving like beast.

5. Answers

a. iii. I am not very robust.
b. "I am not so very robust,
But I'll do the best I can;"
c. Personification
d. It lay within its darksome bed.

6. Answers

a. A leaflet
b. stem;them/prospect;it
c. To examine the surroundings
And show the rest the way.
d. The leaflets quickly followed the first leaflet.

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7. Answers

a. iii. Children
b. Always do the best .
c. Strong and good character
d. Through the lonesome, struggling hours.

8. Answers

a. Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for
You and me in paradise.
b. The woman asked whether he could help her to find a place to sleep.
c. He pretends he can’t hear and cross the road whistling.
d. The poet asks us to be kind and think about the poor unfortunate ones who are suffering.

9. Answers

a. She has blisters on the soles of her feet so she couldn’t walk.
b. iii. A life without suffering.
c. She's got blisters on the soles of her feet
d. She can't walk but she's trying.

10. Answers

a. The woman has faced many hardships
b. The word paradise is used metaphorically.
C ii. because the society often pushes her away.
d. The poem urges us to be empathetic and socially responsible.

11. Answers

a. Yes .Because it symbolise the autumnal phase in the life of the poet.
b. The leaves changed its colour and woodland paths are covered with dry leaves.
c. The swans fly up into the air and spread out,forming irregular patterns in the sky.
d. The trees are in their autumn beauty/ The woodland paths are dry/ the October twilight/Mirrors a still sky
e. The poet reflects on the passage of nineteen years since he first saw the swans.

12. Answers

a. ii. Reflective and nostalgic
b. The swans are "unwearied" and full of passion, where the speaker is weary and full of sorrow.
c. The timeless passion of the swans triggered the speaker's sorrow.
d. The bell-beat of their wings above my head.

13. Answers

a. They move in pairs unaffected by the passage of time.
b. He is unable to find delight in them because he is growing old.
c. iii. Personification
d. ABCBDD

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14. Answers

a. mirror

b. I have no preconceptions./I meditate the opposite wall.

c. The wall is considered as the part of mirror's heart.

d. Faces and darkness separate them.

e. The mirror considered itself as silver and exact. It also considered it as a little god.

f. It reflects an unbiased truth.

15. Answers

a. iv. The Woman

b. Moon and candles

c. The woman searches her youth and beauty/ She is searching the young girl whom she drowned in the mirror..

d. Because the lake gives a deeper reflection.

e. She rewards me with tears and an agitation of hands.

f. Unlike the mirror they hide her flaws in soft shadow.

g. This simile conveys shock ,fear and helplessness as she watches the sign of ageing emerge with clarity.

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UNFAMILIAR PASSAGES

1. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow. (4x1=4)

In recent years, community libraries have begun to reappear in towns and villages, taking on new forms and purposes. Unlike traditional libraries that focused mainly on silent reading, modern community libraries function as shared learning spaces. They offer books, newspapers, digital resources, and even workshops for people of all ages. These libraries play a crucial role in promoting reading habits, especially among children who may not have access to books at home. Community libraries also help bridge the digital divide. Many of them provide free internet access and basic computer training, enabling people to apply for jobs, access government services, and learn new skills. For elderly people, these spaces offer a sense of belonging, while young learners benefit from group activities such as storytelling sessions and reading clubs.

Beyond education, community libraries strengthen social bonds. They encourage interaction among people from different backgrounds and promote values such as cooperation and mutual respect. In a world increasingly dominated by individual screen time, these libraries remind us of the importance of shared spaces for collective growth. By nurturing curiosity and lifelong learning, community libraries quietly contribute to the intellectual and social development of society.

1. Which of the following best describes the role of modern community libraries?
   A. Places meant only for storing old books
   B. Silent spaces restricted to individual reading
   C. Shared learning spaces that support education and social interaction
   D. Centres used only by students preparing for examinations
2. Which of the following benefits of community libraries are mentioned in the passage?
   A. Providing free internet access
   B. Offering workshops and group activities
   C. Supplying financial aid to villagers
   D. Helping people access government services

Choose the correct option from the following:

i) B and C only ii) A and C only
iii) A, B, and D iv) A, B, C, and D

3. How do community libraries help bridge the digital divide?
4. According to the passage, how do community libraries strengthen social bonds?

2. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow. (4x1=4)

Water is one of the most valuable natural resources on Earth, yet it is often taken for granted. Although nearly three-fourths of the planet is covered with water, only a small percentage of it is fresh and suitable for human use. Rapid population growth, urbanisation, and careless consumption have increased the pressure on available water resources. As a result, many regions experience water scarcity, especially during summer months. Rainwater harvesting has emerged as a practical solution to this problem. It involves collecting and storing rainwater for future use instead of allowing it to flow away as runoff. This method not only helps conserve water but also reduces flooding and soil erosion. In rural areas, harvested rainwater supports agriculture, while in cities it can be used for household purposes such as washing and gardening.

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Apart from conserving water, rainwater harvesting promotes environmental sustainability. It recharges groundwater levels and lessens dependence on rivers and reservoirs. By adopting simple water conservation practices at home and in public spaces, individuals can play a significant role in ensuring water security. Small efforts, when multiplied across communities, can lead to meaningful and long-lasting change.

1. What is the main idea of the passage?
   A. Water covers most of the Earth's surface
   B. Water scarcity is caused only by climate change
   C. Rainwater harvesting is an effective solution to water scarcity
   D. Rivers and reservoirs are the only sources of water
2. Which of the following advantages of rainwater harvesting are mentioned in the passage?
   A. Helps reduce flooding
   B. Supports agricultural activities
   C. Produces drinking water without treatment
   D. Recharges groundwater levels

Choose the correct option from the following:

   i) A and C only
   ii) A, B, and D
   iii) B and C only
   iv) A, B, C, and D

3. Why does water scarcity occur according to the passage?
4. How can individuals contribute to water security as suggested in the passage?

3. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow. (4x1=4)

In the modern world, success is often measured by speed—how quickly goals are achieved and how fast results are produced. This obsession with immediacy has gradually altered the way people work, learn, and even think. While technological advancements have undoubtedly increased efficiency, they have also reduced the patience required for deep understanding and careful reflection. Many people now prefer quick answers over thoughtful inquiry. Slow thinking, however, plays a vital role in meaningful learning and sound decision-making. It allows individuals to analyse information, question assumptions, and evaluate consequences before acting. In fields such as science, medicine, and governance, rushed judgments can lead to serious errors. Even in everyday life, impulsive decisions often result in regret, whereas deliberate choices tend to be wiser and more sustainable.

Moreover, slow thinking encourages creativity and emotional intelligence. When the mind is given time to wander and reflect, it can connect ideas in unexpected ways. This process nurtures innovation and empathy—qualities that cannot be developed through haste. In a society driven by constant urgency, rediscovering the value of slowing down may help individuals achieve not only better outcomes but also a deeper sense of fulfilment and balance.

1. What is the passage mainly concerned with?
   A. The disadvantages of technological advancement
   B. The importance of speed in modern education
   C. The value of slow thinking in learning and decision-making
   D. The role of creativity in professional success
2. Which of the following ideas are supported by the passage?
   A. Rushed decisions can lead to serious mistakes
   B. Slow thinking helps develop creativity and empathy

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C. Speed always guarantees better results

D. Thoughtful reflection improves decision-making

Choose the correct option from the following:

i) A, B, C, and D ii) A and C only

iii) B and C only iv) A, B, and D

3. How has the obsession with speed affected the way people think, according to the passage?

4. Why does the author suggest that slowing down can lead to a more balanced life?

4. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow. (4x1=4)

Artificial Intelligence, commonly known as AI, refers to machines that are programmed to think and learn like humans. Today, AI is a part of our daily lives, even if we do not always realise it. Voice assistants on mobile phones, recommendation systems on shopping websites, and navigation apps that suggest the fastest routes all use AI technology.

AI helps make tasks easier and saves time. In hospitals, AI is used to analyse medical reports and assist doctors in diagnosing diseases more accurately. In education, AI-powered tools help students learn at their own pace by providing personalised feedback. Farmers also use AI-based systems to predict weather conditions and improve crop production. However, AI should be used responsibly. Over-dependence on machines may reduce human skills and creativity. Therefore, it is important to balance technological progress with human judgment. When used wisely, Artificial Intelligence can improve efficiency and contribute positively to society.

1. What does Artificial Intelligence refer to?

2. Which of the following is an example of AI mentioned in the passage?

A. Printed textbooks B. Voice assistants

C. Handwritten letters D. Typewriters

3. Which benefits of AI are mentioned in the passage?

A. Helps doctors diagnose diseases B. Improves farming practices

C. Completely replaces human creativity D. Saves time

Choose the correct option from the following:

i) A, B, and D ii) A and C only

iii) B and C only iv) A, B, C, and D

4. Why should AI be used responsibly?

5. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow. (4x1=4)

Trees are one of the most valuable resources on Earth. They provide oxygen, improve air quality, and support life in many ways. Trees help control climate by absorbing carbon dioxide and reducing the effects of global warming. They also prevent soil erosion by holding the soil together with their roots. Trees play a vital role in maintaining biodiversity. Many birds, animals, and insects depend on trees for food and shelter. In addition, trees provide humans with fruits, medicines, wood, and shade. Green spaces created by trees improve mental health and make living environments more pleasant. Unfortunately, large numbers of trees are being cut down for construction and industrial purposes. This leads to environmental imbalance and climate problems. Protecting trees and planting

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new ones is a shared responsibility. By conserving forests and promoting afforestation, people can help protect the environment for future generations.

1. What is the main idea of the passage?
   A. Trees are used only for wood
   B. Trees are important for the environment and life
   C. Trees cause climate problems
   D. Trees grow only in forests
2. Which of the following functions of trees are mentioned?
   A. Prevent soil erosion
   B. Improve air quality
   C. Increase pollution
   D. Support wildlife

Choose the correct option from the following:
   i) A, B, C, and D
   ii) A and C only
   iii) B and C only
   iv) A, B, and D

3. How do trees help in controlling climate?
4. What responsibility do humans have towards trees according to the passage?

6. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow. (4x1=4)

Volunteerism refers to the act of offering one's time and skills to help others without expecting payment. Volunteers play an important role in supporting communities, especially during times of crisis such as natural disasters or public health emergencies. Their efforts help reduce the burden on government and social organisations.

Volunteering also benefits the volunteers themselves. It helps them develop skills such as leadership, teamwork, and communication. Young people who engage in volunteer work gain confidence and a sense of responsibility towards society. Moreover, volunteering promotes empathy by allowing individuals to understand the difficulties faced by others.

In a world where people are often focused on personal success, volunteerism encourages social responsibility and cooperation. Even small acts of service can create positive change. By volunteering time and effort, individuals contribute to building a more caring and inclusive society.

1. What does the term 'volunteerism' mean?
2. Which of the following best describes the role of volunteers?
   A. They work only for personal benefit
   B. They replace government officials
   C. They support communities during difficult times
   D. They work only for payment
3. Which benefits of volunteering are mentioned in the passage?
   A. Develops leadership skills
   B. Promotes empathy
   C. Guarantees financial success
   D. Encourages social responsibility

Choose the correct option from the following:
   i) A and C only
   ii) A, B, and D
   iii) B and C only
   iv) A, B, C, and D

4. How does volunteerism help build a better society?

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7. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow. (4x1=4)

The Lost Wallet

Ravi was returning home from school when he noticed a wallet lying near the bus stop. He picked it up and looked around, but there was no one nearby. Inside the wallet were some currency notes, an identity card, and a few receipts. Ravi felt confused for a moment. His family was going through financial difficulties, and the money could help them.

However, Ravi remembered his father's words that honesty was more valuable than money. He decided to return the wallet. Using the address on the identity card, he walked to a nearby house and rang the bell. An elderly man opened the door. When Ravi handed over the wallet, the man's face lit up with relief. He explained that the money was meant for his medical expenses.

The man thanked Ravi and offered him a reward, but Ravi politely refused. As he walked back home, Ravi felt a deep sense of happiness. Though he had returned home empty-handed, his heart was full of pride.

1. Why did Ravi feel confused after finding the wallet?

2. Which of the following best describes Ravi's action?

A. Careless B. Greedy
C. Honest D. Fearful

3. Which ideas are conveyed through the story?

A. Honesty brings inner happiness B. Money is more important than values
C. Moral choices can be difficult D. Honesty brings self-respect

Choose the correct option from the following:

i) A, C, and D ii) A and B only
iii) B and C only iv) A, B, C, and D

4. How did Ravi feel at the end of the story?

8. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow. (4x1=4)

The Silent Apology

Anjali had always been proud of her handwriting. One afternoon, she noticed that her classmate Meera was struggling to complete her notes. Without thinking much, Anjali remarked loudly that neat writing came only with practice and talent. Meera remained silent, but her eyes filled with tears. Later that day, Anjali learned that Meera had injured her hand in an accident and was finding it painful to write. Anjali felt ashamed of her words. She realised that she had judged Meera without knowing her situation.

The next day, Anjali placed a neatly written set of notes on Meera's desk with a small message: "I'm sorry. I didn't understand." Meera looked up, smiled gently, and nodded. No words were exchanged, but the silence spoke louder than any apology. From that day on, Anjali learned to pause before judging others, understanding that kindness often begins with empathy.

1. What mistake did Anjali make?

2. What does the "silent apology" refer to?

A. Anjali's public comment B. The written note and help
C. Meera's silence D. The teacher's advice

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3. Which themes are highlighted in the story?

A. Importance of empathy
B. Dangers of quick judgment
C. Competition among classmates
D. Power of kindness

Choose the correct option from the following:

i) A, B, C, and D
ii) A and C only
iii) B and C only
iv) A, B, and D

4. What lesson did Anjali learn by the end of the story?

9. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow. (4x1=4)

Plastic waste has become a major environmental concern across the world. Single-use plastics such as bags, bottles, and packaging materials are used for a short time but remain in the environment for years. These plastics pollute soil and water and pose a serious threat to animals, especially marine life. Reducing plastic waste begins with small changes in daily habits. Carrying cloth bags, using refillable bottles, and avoiding plastic straws can make a significant difference. Recycling plastic waste properly also helps reduce pollution and conserve resources. Governments and organisations have introduced rules to limit plastic use, but public participation is equally important. When individuals become responsible consumers, environmental protection becomes a shared effort. By choosing sustainable alternatives, people can contribute to a cleaner and healthier planet.

1. What problem does the passage mainly discuss?

2. Which actions help reduce plastic waste?

A. Using cloth bags
B. Avoiding plastic straws
C. Burning plastic waste
D. Recycling plastics

Choose the correct option from the following:

i) A, C, and D
ii) A and C only
iii) B and C only
iv) A, B, C, and D

3. Why is plastic waste harmful to animals?

4. How can individuals help protect the environment?

10. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow. (4x1=4)

Learning from Failure

Failure is often seen as something negative, but it can be one of the greatest teachers in life. Many successful people have faced repeated failures before achieving their goals. Failure helps individuals understand their mistakes and encourages them to improve. Students, in particular, can learn valuable lessons from failure. Poor exam results may highlight weak areas that need more attention. Instead of losing confidence, learners can use failure as an opportunity to develop better study habits and discipline. Failure also builds resilience. When people learn to accept setbacks calmly, they become stronger and more determined. With the right attitude, failure can lead to personal growth and long-term success.

1. What is the author’s view about failure?

2. Which benefits of failure are mentioned in the passage?

A. Helps identify mistakes
B. Builds resilience
C. Guarantees success
D. Encourages improvement

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Choose the correct option from the following:

i) A, B, and D ii) A and C only

iii) B and C only iv) A, B, C, and D

3. How can students use failure positively?

4. What attitude towards failure does the passage suggest?

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Unfamiliar Passages - Answers

Passage 1: Community Libraries

1. C

2. iii) A, B, and D

3. By providing free internet access and basic computer training to people who otherwise lack digital access.

4. They encourage interaction among people from different backgrounds and promote cooperation and mutual respect.

Passage 2: Rainwater Harvesting

1. C

2. ii) A, B, and D

3. Due to rapid population growth, urbanisation, and careless consumption of water.

4. By adopting simple water conservation practices at home and in public spaces.

Passage 3: Value of Slow Thinking

1. C

2. iv) A, B, and D

3. It has reduced patience for deep understanding, making people prefer quick answers over thoughtful reflection.

4. Slowing down encourages creativity, empathy, better decisions, and a deeper sense of fulfilment.

Passage 4: Artificial Intelligence

1. Artificial Intelligence refers to machines programmed to think and learn like humans.

2. B

3. i) A, B, and D

4. Because over-dependence on machines may reduce human skills and creativity, so balance is needed.

Passage 5: Importance of Trees

1. B

2. iv) A, B, and D

3. By absorbing carbon dioxide and reducing the effects of global warming.

4. Humans should protect trees, conserve forests, and promote afforestation.

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Passage 6: Volunteerism

1. Volunteerism means offering time and skills to help others without expecting payment.

2. C

3. iv) A, B, C, and D

4. It promotes empathy, cooperation, and social responsibility, helping build a caring and inclusive society.

Passage 7: The Lost Wallet

1. Because his family faced financial difficulties and the money could help them.

2. C

3. i) A, C, and D

4. He felt happiness, pride, and inner satisfaction.

Passage 8: The Silent Apology

1. She judged Meera without understanding her situation and made a hurtful public remark.

2. B

3. iv) A, B, and D

4. She learned to pause before judging others and to practise empathy and kindness.

Passage 9: Plastic Waste

1. The problem of plastic waste and its harmful effects on the environment.

2. iv) A, B, C, and D

3. Because plastics pollute land and water and pose a serious threat, especially to marine life.

4. By reducing plastic use, recycling properly, and choosing sustainable alternatives.

Passage 10: Learning from Failure

1. Failure is a valuable teacher that helps in learning and personal growth.

2. i) A, B, and D

3. By identifying weak areas, improving study habits, and learning from mistakes.

4. The passage suggests accepting failure positively and using it as an opportunity for growth.

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DISCOURSES

WRITE-UP

1. The story *A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings* shows how human beings often react negatively to the miraculous. Prepare a write-up discussing how fear, curiosity, and selfishness influence the villagers' behaviour towards the old man.

[Hints: fear of the unknown – villagers' curiosity – greed and exploitation – mockery and imprisonment – lack of compassion – symbolic meaning of wings – human response to miracles]

In *A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings*, Gabriel García Márquez presents a disturbing picture of human behaviour when people encounter the miraculous. Instead of compassion and understanding, the villagers respond with fear, curiosity, and selfishness.

The appearance of the old man frightens the villagers because they cannot understand the unknown. Their fear soon turns into curiosity, and people gather to see him as a strange object. Pelayo and Elisenda exploit this curiosity by charging money, reducing a miracle to a source of profit. The old man is mocked, imprisoned in a chicken coop, and treated without dignity.

Even religious authority fails to show empathy. Through the silent suffering of the old man, the author exposes human cruelty and lack of compassion. The wings, instead of being a blessing, become a burden due to human selfishness.

2. Prepare a write-up on the theme "Human Response to the Miraculous" based on the story *A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings*.

[Hints: arrival of the old man – fear and confusion – curiosity of villagers – exploitation and greed – mockery and cruelty – lack of compassion – symbolic meaning – message on humanity]

A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings presents how humans often fail to respond compassionately to miracles. The arrival of the old man creates fear and confusion among the villagers instead of empathy.

People treat him as an object of curiosity and profit. Pelayo and Elisenda exploit him, while others mock and imprison him. Even religion fails to recognise his humanity.

Through this behaviour, the writer exposes human selfishness and suspicion. The story reminds us that true miracles lie in kindness and understanding, not in spectacle.

3. *In the Attic* highlights the power of hope and inner strength during times of extreme suffering. Prepare a paragraph explaining how music and memories helped the narrator survive the horrors of war.

[Hints: war and destruction – isolation and fear – hiding in the attic – music as emotional support – memories of normal life – mental strength – survival beyond physical needs]

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In *In the Attic*, Władysław Szpilman shows that survival during war depends not only on physical strength but also on inner resilience. Living in fear and isolation, the narrator finds comfort in music and memories. Music becomes a source of emotional support and helps him retain his identity as an artist. Memories of his earlier life give him hope and prevent him from losing his humanity. Even in extreme loneliness, these memories provide strength to endure suffering. Thus, music and memories help the narrator survive mentally and emotionally, proving that hope can exist even in the darkest moments.

4. The lesson *Breaking Barriers, I Will Fly* presents the triumph of determination over social and institutional barriers. Prepare a write-up describing how perseverance helped Srikanth achieve success despite challenges.

[Hints: visual impairment – denial of science education – social prejudice – legal struggle – family support – confidence and determination – breaking stereotypes – message of hope]

Breaking Barriers, I Will Fly portrays the inspiring journey of Srikanth Bolla, who overcame severe challenges through determination. Despite being visually impaired, Srikanth excelled in his studies but was denied the chance to study science due to rigid rules and prejudice.

Instead of giving up, he fought legally for his right to education. With the support of his family and strong self-belief, he challenged the system and proved his capability. His perseverance helped him break social barriers and achieve success.

The lesson conveys a powerful message that determination and confidence can overcome even the strongest obstacles.

5. *A Phoenix Rises* shows how failure can become the foundation for success. Prepare a write-up explaining how the life of Arunachalam Muruganantham reflects resilience and innovation.
[*Hints: social stigma – repeated failures – ridicule and isolation – scientific curiosity – determination to solve a problem – innovation and success – rising after setbacks – symbolism of phoenix]*

A Phoenix Rises presents the inspiring story of Arunachalam Muruganantham, whose life proves that failure can lead to success. His efforts to create low-cost sanitary napkins were met with ridicule, rejection, and isolation from society.

Despite repeated failures, he remained determined and focused on solving a real social problem. His scientific curiosity and resilience helped him innovate and succeed. Like a phoenix rising from ashes, Muruganantham transformed setbacks into achievements.

The lesson highlights the importance of perseverance, innovation, and courage in overcoming social resistance.

6. The short story *War* presents the emotional suffering caused by armed conflict. Prepare a paragraph explaining how the story reveals the pain and helplessness of ordinary people affected by war.

[Hints: train journey – parents of soldiers – grief and anxiety – false courage – mother's silent suffering – final question – irony of war – human cost of conflict]

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In *War*, Luigi Pirandello reveals the deep emotional suffering caused by armed conflict. The story is set during a train journey where parents speak about their sons fighting in the war. Though they try to appear brave, their words hide fear and pain. The grieving mother silently carries her sorrow, and her final question exposes the helplessness of parents who may lose their children. The story highlights the irony of war, where ordinary people bear the greatest suffering. Through simple conversations, the author powerfully presents the human cost of war.

7. **The story *A Piece of String* shows how suspicion and public opinion can destroy an innocent person's life. Prepare a write-up explaining how misunderstanding and gossip lead to injustice in the story.**

[Hints: simple incident – picking up the string – Malandain's accusation – villagers' suspicion – Hauchecorne's repeated explanations – loss of dignity – power of gossip – cruelty of public opinion]

In *A Piece of String*, Guy de Maupassant exposes the cruelty of public opinion and the danger of misunderstanding. Hauchecorne's life changes when he picks up a small piece of string from the road.

Malandain falsely accuses him of stealing a wallet, and the villagers quickly believe the accusation. Even though Hauchecorne repeatedly tries to prove his innocence, no one trusts him. His constant explanations only deepen the suspicion.

The gossip and judgement of society destroy Hauchecorne's peace and dignity. The story clearly shows how public opinion, once formed, can become more powerful than truth and justice.

8. In *Trills and Thrills: Birdwatching in India*, Salim Ali shows how passion and curiosity can shape a meaningful life. Prepare a paragraph explaining how his love for birds influenced his career and personality.

[Hints: childhood curiosity – first birdwatching experiences – guidance from experts – scientific approach – patience and observation – lifelong dedication – contribution to ornithology – inspiration to readers]

In *Trills and Thrills: Birdwatching in India*, Salim Ali describes how his passion for birds shaped his life. His curiosity about birds began in childhood and gradually developed into a serious interest. Through careful observation and guidance from experts, he adopted a scientific approach to birdwatching. His patience and dedication helped him become a renowned ornithologist. Birdwatching was not just a hobby but a lifelong commitment. The lesson inspires readers to pursue their passions with sincerity and curiosity, showing how interest can grow into a meaningful career.

9. *Préférence Nationale* exposes the realities of racism and discrimination faced by immigrants. Prepare a paragraph explaining how personal experiences are used to highlight prejudice and the need for human dignity.

[Hints: immigrant experience – racial discrimination – everyday humiliation – inequality and exclusion – silent suffering – demand for dignity – criticism of racist attitudes – message of equality]

In *Préférence Nationale*, Fatou Diome uses personal experiences to reveal the harsh reality of racism and discrimination. As an immigrant, the narrator faces inequality and exclusion in everyday life. Simple interactions expose deep-rooted prejudice and unfair treatment. These experiences highlight

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the silent suffering of immigrants who are denied respect and dignity. Through honest narration, the author criticises racist attitudes in society. The lesson strongly argues for equality, human dignity, and mutual respect beyond race or nationality.

10. Prepare a write-up on the topic "Rising Above Social Ridicule" based on A Phoenix Rises.

[Hints: social taboo – mockery and isolation – personal sacrifice – scientific curiosity – perseverance – social impact – symbolic title]

A Phoenix Rises presents the inspiring journey of Arunachalam Muruganantham, who rises above social ridicule to bring about meaningful change. When he begins working on menstrual hygiene, society treats the issue as a taboo. His curiosity and experiments invite mockery, suspicion, and isolation, even from his own family. He faces personal sacrifice and emotional suffering, but his commitment to improving women's lives never weakens.

Guided by scientific curiosity and perseverance, he develops a low-cost sanitary napkin machine that empowers rural women. The title symbolically reflects his journey—like a phoenix, he emerges stronger from humiliation and hardship. The story highlights how courage, patience, and innovation can challenge social prejudice and create lasting social impact.

11. Prepare a write-up on the theme "The Hidden Suffering of War" based on the story *War*.

[Hints: train journey – parents of soldiers – false pride – suppressed fear – grieving mother – irony – emotional impact – anti-war message]

The short story War powerfully presents the theme of the hidden suffering caused by war. Set during a train journey, the story brings together parents whose sons are fighting at the front. Outwardly, they speak with false pride about their children's bravery, trying to suppress their fear and anxiety. However, beneath their words lies deep emotional pain and uncertainty. The grieving mother, who has already lost her son, represents the true face of war's suffering. Her final question to the fellow traveller exposes the painful irony of glorifying war while silently fearing loss. Through this emotional moment, Pirandello delivers a strong anti-war message, showing that war destroys not only lives but also the emotional peace of families.

12. Prepare a write-up on the theme "Prejudice and Human Dignity" based on *Préférence Nationale*.

[Hints: racial discrimination – immigrant experience – daily humiliation – assertion of identity – resistance – universal relevance]

Préférence Nationale explores the theme of prejudice and human dignity through the author's immigrant experience. Fatou Diome exposes racial discrimination faced by immigrants in their daily lives, where subtle and open acts of racism lead to repeated humiliation. Ordinary situations become reminders of exclusion and inequality. However, instead of surrendering to discrimination, the author strongly asserts her identity and self-respect. Her resistance to prejudice highlights the importance of dignity and self-worth. The essay goes beyond personal suffering and carries universal relevance, urging society to reject discrimination and treat all individuals with equality and humanity. Through honest narration, the writer reminds readers that human dignity must never be compromised, regardless of race, origin, or nationality.

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CHARACTER SKETCH

1. Prepare a character sketch of the old man in *A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings*. Highlight his appearance, behaviour, and symbolic significance in the story.

[Hints: physical appearance – wings and weakness – silence and patience – suffering and neglect – public humiliation – mysterious nature – symbolic figure – contrast with human cruelty]

The old man in *A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings* is portrayed as a weak, silent, and mysterious figure. He appears old, shabby, and helpless, with large wings that attract fear and curiosity rather than respect. He rarely speaks and patiently endures humiliation, confinement, and neglect. Despite being treated cruelly, he does not show anger or resistance. His silence adds to the mystery surrounding his identity. Symbolically, the old man represents the miraculous misunderstood by humanity. Through his suffering, the author exposes human cruelty, selfishness, and lack of compassion.

2. Prepare a character sketch of Władysław Szpilman, highlighting his emotional strength and resilience during the war.

[Hints: war victim – fear and isolation – hiding in the attic – love for music – inner strength – hope and determination – survival instinct – dignity as an artist]

Władysław Szpilman is portrayed as a sensitive yet resilient survivor of war. Forced into hiding, he lives in constant fear, isolation, and uncertainty. Despite physical weakness and hunger, his love for music gives him emotional strength. Music helps him preserve his identity and dignity as an artist. He remains hopeful and determined even in the darkest moments. Szpilman's character reflects courage, mental strength, and the human will to survive against overwhelming odds.

3. Prepare a character sketch of Srikanth Bolla, bringing out his determination and confidence in overcoming social barriers.

[Hints: visual impairment – academic excellence – denial of opportunities – confidence and courage – legal struggle – family support – breaking stereotypes – inspirational personality]

Srikanth Bolla is a determined and confident individual who refuses to be limited by his visual impairment. Despite excelling academically, he faces discrimination and denial of opportunities. Instead of surrendering, he challenges the system through legal means. His courage, confidence, and strong self-belief help him break social and institutional barriers. Srikanth's character inspires readers to believe in themselves and fight injustice with determination.

4. Prepare a character sketch of Arunachalam Muruganantham, focusing on his resilience and innovative spirit.

[Hints: social reformer – curiosity and courage – repeated failures – ridicule and isolation – persistence – scientific innovation – social impact – symbol of resilience]

Arunachalam Muruganantham is portrayed as a courageous and innovative thinker. His desire to solve a social problem leads him to face ridicule and isolation. Despite repeated failures, he remains persistent and focused. His scientific curiosity and determination help him succeed in developing

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affordable sanitary napkins. Muruganantham's character symbolises resilience, innovation, and the courage to challenge social taboos.

5. Prepare a character sketch of the grieving mother in *War*. Describe her emotions and explain how her silence reveals deep sorrow.

[Hints: mother of a soldier – quiet appearance – suppressed grief – listening to others – emotional restraint – final question – intense sorrow – symbol of parental suffering]

The grieving mother in *War* is a deeply sorrowful yet restrained character. She travels with other parents whose sons are fighting in the war. Unlike others who speak bravely, she remains silent, listening quietly. Her silence reflects intense emotional pain and helplessness. The final question she asks exposes her deep fear and sorrow. She symbolises the suffering of parents who silently bear the emotional cost of war.

6. Prepare a character sketch of Hauchecorne, highlighting his innocence and the injustice he suffers.

[Hints: simple villager – honest nature – minor incident – false accusation – humiliation – obsession with proving innocence – emotional breakdown – tragic figure]

Hauchecorne is a simple, honest villager whose life is ruined by suspicion. His innocent act of picking up a piece of string leads to a false accusation. Though innocent, he is humiliated and distrusted by society. His repeated attempts to prove the truth only increase suspicion. This obsession finally breaks him emotionally. Hauchecorne represents the tragic victim of injustice and cruel public opinion.

7. Prepare a character sketch of Salim Ali, focusing on his passion for nature and dedication to birdwatching.

[Hints: curious child – love for birds – patience and observation – scientific approach – lifelong dedication – humility – contribution to science – inspirational figure]

Salim Ali is portrayed as a passionate and dedicated naturalist. His curiosity about birds begins in childhood and grows into a lifelong commitment. He observes birds patiently and scientifically, showing discipline and humility. His dedication contributes significantly to ornithology in India. Salim Ali inspires readers to pursue their passions with sincerity and respect for nature.

8. Prepare a character sketch of the narrator in *Préférence Nationale*, focusing on her experiences of discrimination and resilience.

[Hints: immigrant identity – experiences of racism – everyday humiliation – silent suffering – courage to speak out – demand for dignity – strong voice – resilience]

The narrator in *Préférence Nationale* is a strong and sensitive immigrant woman. She faces racism and discrimination in everyday life. Despite humiliation and exclusion, she speaks honestly about her experiences. Her voice reflects courage and a demand for human dignity. Through resilience and self-respect, she challenges racist attitudes and asserts equality.

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DIARY

1. Imagine that the old man writes a diary entry on the night after being locked in the chicken coop. Write the diary entry expressing his suffering and silent endurance.

29 March 2026
Monday 9 pm

The night is cold, and the ground beneath me is hard. My wings ache, yet no one understands my pain. They stare at me with fear and curiosity, as if I am not human.

I remain silent, for words seem useless here. Their laughter and cruelty hurt more than the cage. Still, I endure. Somewhere deep within, I feel a quiet strength urging me to survive.

I long for freedom, not from the cage alone, but from the cruelty of hearts. Until then, I will wait in silence.

2. Imagine that Szpilman writes a diary entry after spending a day hiding alone in the attic during the war. Write the diary entry.

23 May 2025
Monday 9 pm

Another day passes in silence and fear. Every sound makes my heart race, afraid that I may be discovered. Hunger weakens my body, but my mind clings to hope.

Music lives within me, even when my fingers cannot touch the keys. Memories of my family and past life give me strength. I refuse to let fear destroy my spirit.

As long as I can remember music, I know I am alive. Tomorrow, I will endure again.

3. Imagine that Srikanth writes a diary entry on the day he is denied permission to study science. Write the diary entry expressing his feelings and determination.

22 June 2026
Monday 9 pm

Today’s decision has shaken me deeply. Despite my hard work, I was denied the chance to study science. It hurts to be judged by disability rather than ability.

For a moment, disappointment tried to defeat me. But I will not surrender. I know my worth and my potential. If doors are closed, I will find another way.

This is not the end. I will fight for my right to learn and succeed.

4. Imagine that Muruganantham writes a diary entry during the period when he was mocked and isolated for his experiments. Write the diary entry.

13 January 2026

Monday 9 pm

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Today was another day of mockery and loneliness. People avoid me, whispering behind my back. At times, the pain feels unbearable.

Yet, I know my purpose is greater than their laughter. My experiments may fail, but my determination remains strong. I believe in what I am trying to achieve.

Someday, this suffering will make sense. Until then, I will continue.

5. Imagine that the grieving mother writes a diary entry after the train journey to meet her son. Write the diary entry expressing her inner conflict.

15 January 2026
Monday 9 pm
Everyone speaks of bravery and pride, but my heart trembles. I smile, yet fear grips me tightly. A mother's love cannot silence the dread of loss.

I pray silently, afraid even to voice my fears. What if I never see my son again? The thought crushes me.
I carry my sorrow quietly, for words cannot express this pain.

6. Imagine that Hauchecorne writes a diary entry on the night after being publicly accused. Write the diary entry expressing his humiliation and helplessness.

05 January 2026
Monday 9 pm

I am innocent, yet no one believes me. A piece of string has stolen my peace and honour. Every face I see reflects suspicion.

The more I explain, the worse it becomes. My words sound empty even to me now. I feel trapped and helpless.

How cruel society can be when truth is ignored. I fear this pain will never leave me.

7. Imagine that Salim Ali writes a diary entry after his first serious birdwatching experience. Write the diary entry expressing his excitement and curiosity.

11 January 2026
Monday 9 pm

Today I watched birds more closely than ever before. Their movements and calls filled me with wonder. I felt a strange excitement within me.

Every detail fascinated me. I wanted to know more, to understand their world. This experience has awakened a deep curiosity.

I feel this is only the beginning of a lifelong journey.

8. Imagine that the narrator writes a diary entry after facing racial discrimination. Write the diary entry expressing pain and self-respect.

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03 January 2026
Monday 9 pm

Today's encounter left me wounded. A simple moment revealed deep prejudice. It hurts to be judged by colour and origin.

Yet, I refuse to lose my dignity. My identity is not defined by their ignorance. I will continue to speak, to resist, and to demand respect.

Silence may protect me, but truth will free me.

LETTER WRITING

1. Władysław Szpilman writes a letter to a close friend describing how music helped him survive the darkest days of war. Write the letter.

Peters House No.11
Warsaw
12 March 19—
Dear Friend,

I write to you from a place of silence and fear. The war has taken away my family, my home, and even my freedom. Each day feels like a battle for survival.

In this darkness, music has become my greatest strength. Though I cannot touch the piano, melodies live within me. They remind me that I am still human.

Music keeps my hope alive. I believe it has saved my spirit when everything else failed.

Yours lovingly,

Szpilman

2. Srikanth writes a letter to the Education Minister complaining about the injustice he faced when he was denied permission to study science. Write the letter.

From
Srikanth Bolla
Hyderabad
11.11.1991
To
The Education Minister
Government of India
Subject : Denied permission to study science due to visual impairment

Sir,

I wish to bring to your attention the injustice I faced despite securing excellent marks in the board examinations. I was denied admission to study science solely because of my visual impairment.

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This decision reflects discrimination rather than merit. I firmly believe that disability should not become a barrier to education. I request you to reconsider such policies and uphold the right to equal opportunities.

I remain determined to pursue my dreams and contribute meaningfully to society.

Yours faithfully,

Srikanth Bolla

3. Muruganantham writes a letter to a social organisation explaining the purpose of his invention and seeking support. Write the letter.

From

A. Muruganantham
Tamil Nadu

11.11.1991

To

The Secretary
Social Welfare Organisation

Subject : Information about a new low-cost sanitary napkin machine

Sir/Madam,

I am writing to inform you about a low-cost sanitary napkin machine I have developed after years of struggle and research. Rural women suffer due to lack of affordable hygiene products.

My invention aims to empower women and improve health awareness. However, I need support to expand its reach. I request your organisation’s assistance in promoting this initiative.

Together, we can bring meaningful change.

Yours sincerely,

Muruganantham

4. The grieving mother writes a letter to her son serving in the army, expressing her suppressed fear and unconditional love. Write the letter.

My Dear Son,

I received your letter and was relieved to know you are safe. As a mother, my heart is filled with both pride and fear. I try to remain strong, but worry never leaves me.

I pray every day for your safety and quick return. Remember that my love surrounds you wherever you are.

Take care, my child. I await the day I can hold you again.

With love,

Mother

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5. Hauchecorne writes a letter to the village mayor explaining his innocence and requesting justice. Write the letter.

From

Hauchecorne

Goderwille, France

11.11.1888

To

The Mayor

Goderville

Subject : Regarding the lost wallet incident

Sir,

I write this letter to assert my innocence regarding the lost wallet incident. I picked up nothing but a piece of string, yet I have been treated like a criminal.

Public suspicion has destroyed my peace and reputation. I request a fair enquiry so that the truth may be known.

I hope justice will prevail.

Yours sincerely,

Hauchecorne

6. The narrator writes a letter to a newspaper editor expressing concern over the destruction of trees and environmental imbalance. Write the letter.

From

A Concerned Citizen

To

The Editor

A National Daily

Sir,

Through your esteemed newspaper, I wish to draw attention to the ruthless cutting down of trees. Trees are living beings that sustain life and balance nature.

Human greed has caused irreversible damage to the environment. I urge authorities and citizens to act responsibly and protect our natural heritage.

Let us preserve nature before it is too late.

Yours truly,

A Nature Lover

7. The narrator in *Préférence Nationale* writes a letter to a friend describing her experience of racial discrimination and her resolve to fight prejudice. Write the letter.

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Dear Friend,

I wish to share an experience that left me deeply hurt. Once again, I faced discrimination simply because of my origin. Such moments question one's dignity.

Yet, I refuse to be silent. My identity is my strength, not a weakness. I will continue to speak against prejudice and stand for equality.

Your support means a lot to me.

With affection,

——

REVIEW

1. Prepare a short review of the story *A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings*, focusing on its theme, characters, and message.

Hints: *strange arrival – villagers' reaction – exploitation and cruelty – role of Pelayo and Elisenda – magical realism – irony – human response to miracles – message on compassion*

A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings by Gabriel Garcia Márquez is a powerful short story that blends reality with fantasy through magical realism. The story revolves around an old man with wings whose arrival creates confusion and curiosity among villagers.

Instead of compassion, the villagers respond with fear, mockery, and greed. Pelayo and Elisenda exploit the old man for money, treating him like an object rather than a human being. The angel's silent endurance highlights human cruelty and selfishness.

Through irony and symbolism, the writer exposes society's inability to accept the extraordinary with kindness. The story strongly criticises human nature and reminds readers of the need for empathy and understanding.

2. Prepare a review of the autobiographical account *In the Attic*, highlighting its theme and emotional impact.

[Hints: Holocaust background – isolation and fear – struggle for survival – importance of music – emotional strength – human resilience – message of hope]

In the Attic is a moving autobiographical account by Władysław Szpilman that portrays the horrors of the Holocaust and the intense struggle for survival. Set against the background of war, the narrative describes the author's life in isolation, marked by constant fear, hunger, and loneliness.

Music plays a vital role in sustaining his emotional strength, helping him preserve his identity and humanity. The simple yet powerful narration creates a deep emotional impact on the reader. The work highlights human resilience and conveys a strong message of hope, showing that inner strength can help one survive even the darkest moments of life.

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3. Prepare a review of the speech *Breaking Barriers, I Will Fly*, focusing on its theme and inspirational value.

[Hints: visual impairment – educational discrimination – determination – legal struggle – achievement against odds – motivational tone – message of equality]

Breaking Barriers, I Will Fly is an inspiring speech by Srikanth Bolla that highlights his journey against social and institutional discrimination. Despite being visually impaired, he dreams of studying science and faces unjust restrictions.

With determination and courage, he challenges these barriers and proves his ability. The speech is motivational and empowering, especially for students facing difficulties.

The message is clear: disability should never limit ambition, and perseverance can overcome any obstacle.

4. Prepare a review of the story *A Phoenix Rises*, highlighting the struggles and achievements of Arunachalam Muruganantham.

[Hints: menstrual hygiene issue – social taboo – personal sacrifice – mockery and isolation – innovation – empowerment of women – symbolic title]

A Phoenix Rises is an inspiring story that highlights the struggles and achievements of Arunachalam Muruganantham. The narrative focuses on his efforts to address the taboo issue of menstrual hygiene in rural India. Due to social prejudice, he faces mockery, isolation, and personal sacrifice.

However, his strong determination and scientific curiosity help him continue his work. His invention of a low-cost sanitary napkin machine empowers women by providing dignity and health awareness. The symbolic title reflects his journey of rising from humiliation and failure to success. The story celebrates courage, innovation, and a deep sense of social responsibility.

5. Prepare a review of the short story *War*, focusing on its portrayal of human emotions and the theme of loss.

[Hints: train journey – parents of soldiers – false bravery – grieving mother – suppressed sorrow – irony – impact of war – universal suffering]

Luigi Pirandello's War is a powerful short story that portrays the deep human emotions and sense of loss caused by war. Set during a train journey, the story brings together parents whose sons are fighting at the front. They speak with false bravery, hiding their suppressed fear and sorrow. The grieving mother, who has already lost her son, silently reveals the harsh reality of war through her final question. This moment exposes the irony behind the glorification of war. The story leaves a strong emotional impact, showing that war leads to universal suffering rather than honour or victory.

6. Prepare a short review of the story *A Piece of String*, focusing on its theme and moral lesson.

[Hints: Hauchecorne – picking up string – false accusation – villagers' suspicion – humiliation – obsession with innocence – cruelty of public opinion]

A Piece of String by Guy de Maupassant is a powerful short story that highlights the cruelty of suspicion and public opinion. Hauchecorne's innocent act of picking up a piece of string is

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misinterpreted, leading to a false accusation of theft. Though he repeatedly asserts his innocence, the villagers remain suspicious and humiliate him.

Society's refusal to believe the truth turns his life into a painful struggle. His obsession with proving his innocence gradually destroys his peace of mind. The story conveys a strong moral lesson about the dangers of prejudice and the injustice caused by blind judgement and cruel public opinion.

7. Prepare a review of the autobiographical excerpt *Trills and Thrills: Birdwatching in India*.

[Hints: childhood curiosity – first observation – passion for birds – scientific attitude – joy of discovery – love for nature]

Trills and Thrills: Birdwatching in India is an engaging autobiographical excerpt in which Salim Ali narrates his early experiences with birdwatching. His childhood curiosity and first careful observation of birds awaken a lifelong passion for studying them. The author's scientific attitude and patience help him understand bird behaviour in detail.

The joy of discovery is evident throughout the narrative, making the account lively and inspiring. Written in simple and clear language, the work reflects the author's deep love for nature and wildlife. It encourages readers to observe the natural world closely and develop respect and concern for the environment.

8. **Prepare a review of the autobiographical essay *Préférence Nationale*, focusing on its theme and relevance.**

[Hints: racial discrimination – immigrant experience – everyday prejudice – loss of dignity – assertion of identity – universal message]

Préférence Nationale by Fatou Diome is a powerful autobiographical essay that focuses on the theme of racial discrimination and its relevance in society. Drawing from her immigrant experience, the author exposes everyday prejudice faced by immigrants in subtle and open forms. These experiences often result in humiliation and a loss of dignity. However, Diome firmly asserts her identity and self-respect, refusing to accept discrimination. The essay carries a universal message that goes beyond personal suffering, reminding readers of the need for equality and humanity. Written in a direct and honest tone, the work urges society to reject prejudice and uphold human dignity.

SPEECH

1. Prepare a speech on the topic "Hope and Resilience in Times of Crisis" based on *In the Attic*.

Hints: *war background – isolation and fear – physical suffering – power of music – mental strength – survival of spirit – relevance today*

Respected teachers and my dear friends,

In the Attic teaches us that hope can survive even in the darkest times. Amid war, hunger, and loneliness, the narrator preserves his spirit through music.

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Though physically trapped, his mind remains free. Music becomes a source of strength and identity. The story shows that resilience is not the absence of fear, but the courage to endure.

Even today, this lesson inspires us to remain hopeful in times of crisis.

Thank you.

2. Prepare a motivational speech based on Srikanth Bolla's life, highlighting the importance of determination and equal opportunity.

[Hints: visual impairment – academic excellence – denial of opportunity – legal struggle – self-belief – success against odds – message to youth]

Dear friends,

Srikanth Bolla's life teaches us that disability is not inability. Despite being visually impaired, he excelled academically but faced discrimination.

Instead of surrendering, he fought for justice and proved his worth. His journey reminds us that determination can break any barrier.

Let us believe in our abilities and demand equal opportunities for all.

Thank you.

NEWSPAPER REPORT

1. A strange winged old man was found in a coastal village, attracting large crowds and public attention. Prepare a newspaper report on the incident.

Winged Old Man Found in Coastal Village

By Staff Reporter
Coastal Village, March 12

A mysterious old man with enormous wings was found in a coastal village following a heavy storm last night. The man was discovered in the courtyard of a local resident, Pelayo.

Villagers gathered in large numbers, reacting with fear and curiosity. The old man was kept in a chicken coop as people paid money to see him. Authorities were informed but failed to identify his origin.

The incident has raised questions about human behaviour and compassion as the mystery surrounding the old man continues.

2. A Jewish pianist survived the war by hiding alone in an attic for several months. Prepare a newspaper report highlighting his survival story.

Hints: World War background – hiding in attic – fear and hunger – survival against odds – role of music – liberation – human resilience

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Pianist Survives War in Attic Hideout

By Special Correspondent
Warsaw, April 5

Władysław Szpilman, a renowned pianist, survived the horrors of war by hiding in an attic for several months. Living in constant fear, he endured hunger and isolation.

Music became his emotional support during this period. After liberation, Szpilman emerged as a symbol of human resilience and hope.

His story stands as a powerful reminder of survival amidst adversity.

3. A visually challenged student was denied permission to study science despite securing high marks. Prepare a newspaper report on the issue.

[Hints: visually impaired student – excellent academic performance – denial of admission – discriminatory rules – legal intervention – public response – victory for equality]

Visually Challenged Student Fights for Right to Study Science

By Education Correspondent
Hyderabad, June 10

Srikanth Bolla, a visually challenged student who scored exceptionally well in board examinations, was denied permission to study science due to outdated regulations.

The decision sparked public debate and legal action. Following intervention, authorities reconsidered the case, marking a victory for equal educational opportunities.

The incident highlights the need for inclusive policies in education.

4. A social innovator from Tamil Nadu developed a low-cost sanitary napkin machine after years of struggle. Prepare a newspaper report.

[Hints: menstrual hygiene issue – social taboo – years of research – ridicule and isolation – low-cost invention – benefits to rural women – national recognition]

Innovator Develops Low-Cost Sanitary Napkin Machine

By Staff Reporter
Tamil Nadu, July 18

Arunachalam Muruganantham, a social innovator, has developed a low-cost sanitary napkin machine aimed at improving menstrual hygiene among rural women.

Despite facing social ridicule and isolation, he continued his research. The invention has brought dignity and health awareness to thousands of women.

His work has received national recognition for its social impact.

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5. Parents travelling to meet their soldier sons revealed deep emotional suffering during a train journey. Prepare a newspaper report.

[Hints: war background – train journey – parents of soldiers – emotional conversations – grieving mother – irony of war – human cost]

War's Hidden Pain Reflected in Train Journey

By Special Correspondent
Rome, August 3

A train journey carrying parents of soldiers to the warfront revealed the silent emotional suffering caused by war. Though many spoke of pride, fear and sorrow dominated their hearts.

One grieving mother's emotional breakdown exposed the true cost of war beyond the battlefield.

The incident highlights the deep psychological impact of war on families.

6. A villager died after being falsely accused of theft, despite his repeated claims of innocence. Prepare a newspaper report.

[Hints: village fair – lost wallet – false accusation – public suspicion – humiliation – death of Hauchecorne – moral lesson]

False Accusation Leads to Tragic Death

By Village Correspondent
Goderville, September 14

Hauchecorne, a local villager, died yesterday after prolonged humiliation caused by a false accusation of theft. Though innocent, he failed to convince society.

The accusation followed the loss of a wallet during a village fair. Continuous suspicion ruined his mental peace, leading to his tragic end.

The incident exposes the cruelty of public opinion.

7. An immigrant writer exposed racial discrimination through personal experiences. Prepare a newspaper report.

[Hints: immigrant experience – racial prejudice – everyday discrimination – personal narrative – public awareness – demand for equality]

Writer Highlights Racial Discrimination Faced by Immigrants

By Staff Reporter
Paris, December 8

Writer Fatou Diome has brought attention to racial discrimination faced by immigrants through her personal experiences.

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Her narrative exposes everyday prejudice and challenges societal inequality. Readers and activists have praised her courage in speaking out.

The report has reignited discussions on equality and human dignity.

8. A young boy named Salim Ali's interest in birdwatching marked the beginning of a distinguished scientific career. Prepare a newspaper report.

[Hints: childhood curiosity – bird shooting incident – scientific observation – passion for birds – future ornithologist – inspiration to students]

Curiosity Leads to Career in Bird Science

By Education Reporter
Mumbai, January 15

A childhood incident involving a bird sparked Salim Ali's lifelong passion for ornithology. His curiosity led him to observe and study birds scientifically.

This early interest later shaped his remarkable career as a renowned bird expert. His journey continues to inspire students and nature lovers.

PARAGRAPH

1. Write a paragraph on how human beings react to the extraordinary in *A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings*.

The story *A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings* shows that humans often react negatively to the extraordinary. Instead of compassion, the villagers respond with fear, curiosity, and cruelty. Pelayo and Elisenda exploit the old man for money, while others mock and imprison him. Even religious authority fails to understand his presence. Through this behaviour, the writer exposes human selfishness and lack of empathy, reminding readers that true humanity lies in kindness.

2. Write a paragraph on the role of music in sustaining the narrator's spirit in *In the Attic*.

In *In the Attic*, music plays a crucial role in helping the narrator survive the horrors of war. Though physically isolated and deprived of food, music keeps his spirit alive. It reminds him of his identity as a pianist and provides emotional strength. Music becomes a source of hope and resilience, helping him endure fear and loneliness during the darkest moments of his life.

3. Write a paragraph on how Srikanth Bolla challenges social and institutional barriers.

Srikanth Bolla challenges social and institutional barriers through determination and self-belief. Despite being visually impaired, he excels academically but is denied permission to study science. Instead of giving up, he fights legally against discrimination. His courage and perseverance help him overcome injustice, proving that ability matters more than disability.

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4. Write a paragraph on how Arunachalam Muruganantham rises above social ridicule.

Arunachalam Muruganantham rises above social ridicule through perseverance and innovation. When he attempts to address menstrual hygiene, society misunderstands and mocks him. Despite isolation and personal loss, he continues his research. His invention of a low-cost sanitary napkin machine brings dignity and health awareness to rural women. His journey shows that courage can overcome prejudice.

5. Write a paragraph on the hidden emotional suffering caused by war as portrayed in *War*.

The story *War* reveals the hidden emotional suffering caused by war. Parents pretend to be proud of their sons serving in the army, hiding their deep fear and sorrow. The grieving mother's final question exposes the painful truth of loss. Pirandello uses irony to show that war destroys families emotionally, even before it takes lives.

6. Write a paragraph on how suspicion and public opinion destroy Hauchecorne's life in *A Piece of String*.

In *A Piece of String*, suspicion and public opinion ruin Hauchecorne's life. A harmless act leads to a false accusation of theft. Though innocent, he is repeatedly humiliated and disbelieved by society. His obsession with proving his innocence destroys his peace and health, showing the cruelty of blind judgement.

7. Write a paragraph on how curiosity leads to scientific interest in *Trills and Thrills*.

In *Trills and Thrills*, Salim Ali shows how curiosity leads to scientific interest. His careful observation of birds awakens a desire to learn more about nature. This curiosity gradually develops into a lifelong passion for birdwatching and scientific study, inspiring readers to observe the world closely.

8. Write a paragraph on how *Préférence Nationale* exposes everyday racism.

Préférence Nationale exposes everyday racism faced by immigrants through personal experiences. The author highlights subtle discrimination that humiliates individuals and questions their dignity. Despite this, she asserts her identity and self-respect. The essay calls for equality and respect for all human beings.

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INFORMATION TRANSFER

1. Study the table showing the performance of Class X students in an English test and answer the questions that follow. **(5x1=5)**

Student	Reading (20)	Writing (20)	Grammar (20)	Total (60)
Arun	14	15	16	45
Beena	18	14	15	47
Manoj	12	16	14	42
Reshma	16	17	18	51

1. Who scored the highest total marks in the test?
2. Which student scored the lowest marks in Reading?
   A. Arun B. Beena
   C. Manoj D. Reshma
3. Which of the following statements are correct?
   A. Reshma scored the highest in Grammar
   B. Beena scored more than Arun in total marks
   C. Manoj scored higher than Beena in Writing
   D. Arun scored the lowest total marks

   Choose the correct option:
   i) A, B, and C ii) A and D only
   iii) B and D only iv) A, B, C, and D
4. How many students scored more than 45 marks in total?
5. In which skill area is the overall class performance the best? Support your answer using data.

2. Study the table showing electricity consumption of four houses and answer the questions. **(5x1=5)**

House	Units Consumed	Amount Paid (₹)	Number of Members
A	180	720	4
B	240	960	6
C	200	800	5
D	160	640	3

1. Which house consumed the maximum electricity?
2. What is the electricity charge per unit?
   A. ₹3 B. ₹4
   C. ₹5 D. ₹6

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3. Which of the following statements are true?
   A. House B has the highest number of members
   B. House D paid the lowest amount
   C. House C consumed more units than House A
   D. House A has higher per capita consumption than House B

   Choose the correct option:
   i) A, B, and C
   ii) A, B, and D
   iii) B and D only
   iv) A, B, C, and D

4. Which house has the highest per capita electricity consumption?

5. Suggest one reason why House B's bill is higher than House C's.

3. The table gives details from the cover pages of famous books. Study it and answer the questions. (5x1=5)

Book Title	Author	Genre	Year of Publication
The Alchemist	Paulo Coelho	Fiction	1988
Wings of Fire	A.P.J. Abdul Kalam	Autobiography	1999
The Blue Umbrella	Ruskin Bond	Children's fiction	1980
Malgudi Days	R.K. Narayan	Fiction	1943

1. Which book is the earliest published among the four?

2. Who wrote an autobiographical work?
   A. Paulo Coelho
   B. Ruskin Bond
   C. R.K. Narayan
   D. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

3. Which of the following statements are correct?
   A. Two books listed belong to the fiction genre
   B. The Blue Umbrella was published after Wings of Fire
   C. Malgudi Days is the oldest book in the table
   D. Paulo Coelho's book was published in the 20th century

   Choose the correct option:
   i) A, C, and D
   ii) A and B only
   iii) B and D only
   iv) A, B, C, and D

4. Which author is known for writing books for children, based on the table?

5. Arrange the books in chronological order of publication.

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4. Study the information from the covers of books written by women authors. (5x1=5)

Book Title	Author	Theme	Award Received
The God of Small Things	Arundhati Roy	Social issues	Booker Prize
Pride and Prejudice	Jane Austen	Social relationships	—
To Kill a Mockingbird	Harper Lee	Justice & racism	Pulitzer Prize
The Diary of a Young Girl	Anne Frank	War & human suffering	—

1. Which book deals with the theme of racism and justice?
2. Which author won a Booker Prize?
   A. Jane Austen B. Harper Lee
   C. Anne Frank D. Arundhati Roy
3. Which of the following statements are correct?
   A. Two books listed have received major awards
   B. Pride and Prejudice deals with war
   C. Anne Frank's book is based on real-life experiences
   D. Harper Lee's book focuses on social inequality

   Choose the correct option:
   i) A, C, and D ii) A and B only
   iii) B and C only iv) A, B, C, and D
4. Which books highlight social issues, based on the table?
5. What general conclusion can you draw about the themes chosen by women writers?

5. Study the table showing the attendance of students in a class during a week. (5x1=5)

Day	Boys Present	Girls Present	Total Strength
Monday	18	20	40
Tuesday	20	22	40
Wednesday	19	21	40
Thursday	17	20	40
Friday	21	23	40

1. On which day was the highest attendance recorded?
2. How many students were absent on Monday?
   A. 2 B. 4
   C. 6 D. 8
3. Which of the following statements are correct?
   A. Friday recorded the highest attendance
   B. Girls' attendance was always higher than boys'

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C. Thursday had the lowest attendance
D. Full attendance was recorded on Tuesday

Choose the correct option:

i) A, B, and C
ii) A and C only
iii) B and D only
iv) A, B, C, and D

4. Find the average daily attendance of the class.
5. What general trend do you notice in students' attendance during the week?

6. Study the table showing rainfall received in four districts during a monsoon month. (5x1=5)

District	Rainfall (mm)	Flood Risk	Crops Affected
A	420	High	Paddy
B	280	Moderate	Rubber
C	150	Low	Coconut
D	360	High	Banana

1. Which district received the least rainfall?
2. Which district faces moderate flood risk?

A. District A
B. District B
C. District C
D. District D

3. Which of the following statements are correct?

A. District A and D face high flood risk
B. Coconut crops are affected in areas of heavy rainfall
C. District C has the lowest flood risk
D. Rubber is grown in areas with moderate rainfall

Choose the correct option:

i) A, C, and D
ii) A and B only
iii) B and C only
iv) A, B, C, and D

4. Which crop is affected in districts receiving more than 300 mm rainfall?
5. What relationship can be observed between rainfall and flood risk?

8. Read the following news headlines and answer the questions that follow. (5x1=5)

i. NASA's James Webb Telescope Discovers New Earth-like Planet.

ii. Kerala Government to Launch 'Green Schools' Initiative This June.

iii. India Wins Gold in International Physics Olympiad Held in Tokyo.

iv. Heavy Rainfall Predicted in Wayanad and Idukki for the Next 48 Hours.

v. Local Youth Honored for Saving a Drowning Child in Periyar River.

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vi. Bollant Industries Announces New Factory Launch in Andhra Pradesh.

1. Which headline discusses a scientific discovery related to space exploration?

2. What is the specific location where the International Physics Olympiad was conducted?

3. For how many days has the weather department predicted heavy rainfall?

4. Which headline is related to a character or entrepreneur studied in your textbook?

A. Headline ii B. Headline iii

C. Headline vi D. Headline v

5. According to the headlines, which TWO districts in Kerala are under a heavy rain alert?

i. Wayanad ii. Periyar

iii. Idukki iv. Andhra Pradesh

Choose the right option from the following

A. i and iv B. ii and iv

C. i and ii D. i and iii

9. Read the following news headlines and answer the questions that follow. (5x1=5)

i. Legendary Poet’s Birth Anniversary Celebrated at Coole Park.

ii. New ‘Anti-War’ Mural Unveiled by High School Students in Sulmona.

iii. Scientists Discover Rare Species of ‘Nilgiri Langur’ in Silent Valley.

iv. Local Government Bans Plastic Usage in All Major Tourist Destinations.

v. Young Girl from Rural Village Wins ‘National Bravery Award’ for 2026.

vi. Global Climate Summit: World Leaders Agree to Reduce Carbon Emissions.

1. Which headline is related to the setting of a poem you have studied in your textbook?

2. In which specific location was a rare animal species discovered by scientists?

3. What is the main objective of the world leaders mentioned in Headline vi?

4. Which headline features a location mentioned in the story "War"?

A. Headline i B. Headline ii

C. Headline iii D. Headline v

5. According to the headlines, which TWO themes are being promoted through the activities in Headline ii and Headline iv?

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i. Environmental Conservation
ii. Space Exploration
iii. Promotion of Peace
iv. Space Research

Choose the right option from the following:

A. i and ii
B. ii and iii
C. i and iii
D. iii and iv

10. Study the following table about five world-famous movies and answer the questions that follow. (5x1=5)

Movie Title	Country of Origin	Genre	Director	Year of Release
Pather Panchali	India	Drama	Satyajit Ray	1955
Parasite	South Korea	Thriller	Bong Joon-ho	2019
The Lion King	USA	Animation	Roger Allers	1994
Seven Samurai	Japan	Action/Epic	Akira Kurosawa	1954
Amélie	France	Romance/ Comedy	Jean-Pierre Jeunet	2001

1. Which movie in the table was directed by the Japanese filmmaker Akira Kurosawa?

2. In which year was the South Korean thriller Parasite released?

3. What is the genre of the French movie Amélie?

4. If a student is interested in the origins of Indian Parallel Cinema, which director's work from the table should they watch?

A. Bong Joon-ho
B. Satyajit Ray
C. Jean-Pierre Jeunet
D. Roger Allers

5. Based on the table, which TWO statements are true?

i. Pather Panchali is the oldest movie in the list.

ii. Seven Samurai was released before Pather Panchali.

iii. The Lion King is an animated film from the USA.

iv. Only one movie in the list was released in the 21st century.

Choose the right option from the following:

A. i and ii
B. ii and iii
C. iii and iv
D. i and iv

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Answers – Information Transfer

Performance of Class X Students

1. Reshma

2. C. Manoj

3. iii) B and D only

4. 2 students (Beena and Reshma)

5. Grammar – The total grammar scores (16+15+14+18 = 63) are higher compared to Reading (60) and Writing (62).

2. Electricity Consumption of Houses

1. House B

2. B. ₹4

3. iv) A, B, C, and D

4. House D

5. House B has consumed more electricity units than House C, leading to a higher bill.

3. Details of Famous Books

1. *Malgudi Days*

2. D. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

3. i) A, C, and D

4. Ruskin Bond

5. *Malgudi Days* → *The Blue Umbrella* → *The Alchemist* → *Wings of Fire*

4. Books by Women Authors

1. *To Kill a Mockingbird*

2. D. Arundhati Roy

3. i) A, C, and D

4. *The God of Small Things* and *Pride and Prejudice*

5. Women writers often focus on social issues, justice, human relationships, and real-life experiences.

5. Weekly Attendance of Students

1. Friday

2. B. 4

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3. ii) A and C only

4. Average attendance = (38 + 42 + 40 + 37 + 44) ÷ 5 = **40.2 students**

5. Attendance shows minor fluctuations, with the highest attendance towards the end of the week.

6. Rainfall in Districts

1. District C

2. B. District B

3. i) A, C, and D

4. Paddy and Banana

5. Higher rainfall is associated with higher flood risk.

8. News Headlines (Set 1)

1. Headline i

2. Tokyo

3. 48 hours (2 days)

4. C. Headline vi

5. D. i and iii

9. News Headlines (Set 2)

1. Headline i

2. Silent Valley

3. To reduce carbon emissions

4. B. Headline ii

5. C. i and iii

10. World-Famous Movies

1. *Seven Samurai*

2. 2019

3. Romance / Comedy

4. B. Satyajit Ray

5. C. iii and iv

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LANGUAGE ELEMENTS

UNIT 1

A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

(i). The angel was a (a) only one who took no part on (b) his own act. He spent his time tried (c) to get comfortable in her (d) borrowed nest. At first, they tried at (e) make him eat some mouthballs (f). But he ate nothing but eggplant mush.

(ii). The owners of the house have (a) no reason to lament. With the money they saved them (b) built a two-story (c) mansion with balconies and gardens. It also had high netting as that (d) crabs wouldn't get in during the winter, and iron bars on a (e) windows so that angels wouldn't get up (f).

(iii). When the child began school, a (a) sun and rain had caused the collapse to (b) the chicken (c) coop. The angel went dragging himself about here and their (d) like a stray dying man. He seems (e) to be in so many places in (f) the same time.

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

(i). Dressed like a ragpicker, the old winged man looked miserable; age and mud _____ (a) any grandeur. Pelayo and Elisenda _____ (b) him closely, _____ (c) courage, and spoke. He answered strangely. They assumed he was a castaway _____ (d) from a wreck and _____ (e) a neighbour for help.

(look at, call in, get up, come back, go out, take away)

(ii). News of the angel spread fast, _____ (a) peace. Crowds were _____ (b) by troops. Pelayo fenced the yard, _____ (c) entry, and charged visitors. Invalids came seeking cures. Exhausted but rich, the couple kept _____ (d) late, while pilgrims were _____ (e) in endless lines for days together.

(go to bed, watch over, drag out, call in, knock down, lock up,)

(iii). The child _____ (a) woke up healthy, and pity replaced fear. They planned to send the angel away, but hope _____ (b) took away mercy. The angel was _____ (c) locked up in a coop. At dawn they _____ (d) went out and saw crowds. Visitors _____ (e) put on a show, treating him like a circus animal.

(locked up, took away, look at, put on, went out, woke up)

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

(i). _____ (a) light was weak, even _____ (b) noon. When Pelayo was coming back to _____ (c) house, it was hard _____ (d) him to see what was moving and groaning _____ (e) the rear of _____ (f) courtyard.

(at, the, for, the, a, in, the)

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(ii). On _____ (a) following day everyone knew that _____ (b) flesh-and-blood angel was held captive _____ (c) Pelayo's house. Pelayo watched _____ (d) him all afternoon from the kitchen, armed with his bailiff's club. Before going _____ (e), he dragged him out of the mud and locked him up _____ (f) the hens in the chicken coop.

(with, the, to, into, a, over, in)

(iii). The news _____ (a) the captive angel spread with great rapidity. After _____ (b) few hours, the courtyard had _____ (c) bustle of a marketplace. The couple had _____ (d) call in troops to disperse the mob. They got _____ (e) idea of fencing in the yard, and charging five cents _____ (f) admission to see the angel.

(the, to, in, a, of, for, the)

4. Complete the conversation.

i. Complete the conversation between Pelayo and Elisenda.

Pelayo: Elisenda, we are lucky, ____ (a) ____?
Elisenda: Yes, we are rich now, isn't it surprising? _____ (b) _____?
Pelayo: It's better to repair the house first.
Elisenda: Yes, that's wise. Either we rebuild the house or _____ (c) _____.
Pelayo: If people keep coming, _____ (d) _____.
Elisenda: True. But we have to think about our safety too. What if something goes wrong?
Pelayo: Don't worry. Who would harm us when everyone is happy?
Elisenda: Still, we had better _____(e)_____.

ii. Complete the conversation between Elisenda and neighbour woman.

Elisenda: This old man with wings is strange, ____ (a) ____?
Neighbour Woman: What do you think he really is?
Elisenda: I don't know. But he must be an angel; no ordinary man has wings.
Should we _____ (b) _____?
Neighbour Woman: Yes, we should. If we get angry with him, something bad may happen.
Elisenda: His powers may be hidden. We must not judge him by his appearance.
Neighbour Woman: He is neither young _____ (c) _____ , yet people believe in his miracles, don't they?
Elisenda: True. If people have faith, _____ (d) _____.
Neighbour Woman: Sorry, Elisenda, if I sound harsh, but _____ (e) _____?
Elisenda: Yes, I think so. I believe that he can cure the sick.
Neighbour Woman: You are right. We must be careful with such a mysterious being.

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) Neighbour Woman: He's an angel.
(a) Elisenda: The poor fellow is so old that the rain knocked him down.

(a) Elisenda: Where did you find this old man?
(a) Pelayo: The man was lying face down in the mud in the rear of our courtyard.

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(a) Neighbour woman: Let's try to make the old man eat some mothballs.
(a) Pelayo: He eats nothing but eggplant mush.

(a) Elisenda: Both the old man and the child came down with chicken pox at the same time.
(a) Doctor: I found so much whistling from his heart and so many sounds in the kidneys.

6. Complete the passage with suitable idioms choosing from the brackets.

(i). The doctor advised Pelayo to _____(a)_____ and not declare the old man an angel. A visitor _____(b)_____ by revealing that miracles were happening in Pelayo's house.

(spill the beans, hold his tongue, a piece of cake)

(ii). For Elisenda, earning money from the curious crowd became _____(a)_____ after fencing the courtyard. The arrival of pilgrims from distant places was _____(b)_____, increasing their fame and wealth.

(the icing on the cake, a piece of cake, when pigs fly)

(iii). Pelayo told Elisenda to _____(a)_____ when the crowd mocked the old angel. The angel's survival after the storm was _____(b)_____, strengthening people's belief in miracles.

(spilled the beans, hold one's tongue, the icing on the cake)

In the Attic

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

(i). When I placed my (a) fingars on the keyboard they shook. I hadn't practised (b) at two and half years, my fingers (c) was stiff and covered with a thick layer of dirt, and I (d) have not cut my nails for some weeks. I (e) plays Chopin's Nocturne in C sharp minor. When I finished, (f) a silence seemed gloomy and eerie.

(ii). He inspected a (a) attic and discovered somebody (b) I had not yet noticed: a loft made on (c) boards directly above the entrence (d) to the attic. The officer said he thought I should hide in these (e) loft. He asked if I had anything to ate (f).

(iii). Monotonos (a), hopeless weeks passed by. I heard less but (b) less artillery fire. There where (c) days when not the (d) single shot broke the silence. Soldiers go (e) up and down the stairs, often bringing large packages up into (f) the attic and fetching others down.

(iv). The first hard frosts came on (a) the middle of December. Christmas came, and than (b) the New Year 1945: a (c) sixth Christmas and New Year celebrations of the war, an (d) the worst I had known. I lays (e) in the dark, listening to the stormy wind. I heard the sqeaking (f) and rustling of rats and mice running back and forth in the attic.

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

(i). Frightened, the narrator slumped by the larder as the officer questioned him. On learning he was a pianist, the officer decided to _____ (a) the next room. _____ (b) the idea of music, he asked him to _____ (c) the piano. He urged him to _____ (d), promising not to _____ (e) his anger.

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(try out, look out, bring up, go into, take out, hang on)

(ii). The officer inspected the attic and chose a safe loft for hiding. He promised to _____ (a) food and told him not to _____ (b). The man _____ (c) courage to ask a question. Ashamed yet kind, the officer tried to _____ (d) his fear and asked him to _____ (e) carefully.

(put out, look out, fetch down, go on, put on, venture out,)

(iii). From the attic, Szpilman _____ (a) and saw the building surrounded by Polish soldiers. A woman _____ (b) her heels as soldiers _____ (c) the stairs. Fearing death, he _____ (d) shouting his identity. After checking him, the soldiers believed him and let him _____ (e) safely for food and rest.

(rush up, go on out, look out, try out, come down, take to)

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

(i). His voice sounded harsh, almost as if he were giving _____ (a) order, convincing me _____ (b) his unyielding belief that _____ (c) war would end well _____ (d) us. Only then did I hear _____ (e) quiet sound _____ (f) the attic door closing.

(for, of, the, an, of, the, a)

(ii). We had already said goodbye, and he was _____ (a) to go, when _____ (b) idea came _____ (c) me at _____ (d) last moment. I had long been racking my brains _____ (e) some way _____ (f) showing him my gratitude.

(the, about, of, an, a, to, for)

(iii). _____ (a) my mind, I went _____ (b) every Christmas before and during _____ (c) war. At first, I had _____ (d) home, parents, two sisters and _____ (e) brother. Then we had no home_____ (f) our own any more, but we were together.

(an, a, in, of, over, the, a)

(iv). _____ (a) night passed peacefully. _____ (b) one o'clock I heard _____ (c) remaining Germans leaving _____ (d) building. Silence fell. I could not even hear the steps _____ (e) the guards outside _____ (f) building.

(the, an, the, around, the, the, of)

4. Complete the conversation.

(i). Complete the conversation between the captain and Szpilman.

Captain: You have suffered a lot during this war, _____(a)_____?
Szpilman: Yes, I have. What choice did I have when everything was destroyed?

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Captain: You must have felt lonely, hiding among ruins.
Szpilman: I did. I was neither safe _____(b)_____.

Captain: I'm sorry you had to go through such pain.
Szpilman: Thank you. If I had not hidden, _____(c)_____.

Captain: You should _____(d)_____. *(advice)*
Szpilman: I will. I must rebuild my life; it is my duty.

Captain: _____(e)_____?
Szpilman: Music helped me to build hope and that it survives if one believes, doesn't it?

(i). Complete the conversation between Szpilman and the Polish lieutenant.

Lieutenant: You are Polish, _____(a)_____? *(question tag)*
Szpilman: Yes. What reason would I have to lie? *(WH question)*

Lieutenant: _____(b)_____?
Szpilman: Sorry, Lieutenant. A German officer gave it to me to survive the cold. *(apology)*

Lieutenant: You must realise how suspicious that looks. *(modal – must)*
Szpilman: I was _____(c)_____ nor a collaborator. *(neither–nor)*

Lieutenant: If you had not explained, _____(d)_____. *(if clause)*
Szpilman: I understand. I should have spoken sooner. *(modal – should)*

Lieutenant: _____(e)_____. *(advice)*
Szpilman: I will report at the earliest; it is my duty and I must obey orders. *(obligation)*

Complete the conversation between Szpilman and the Polish woman with a bundle on her back.

Polish Woman: You are not German, _____(a)_____? *(question tag)*
Szpilman: No. Who would I be if not a Polish man waiting for freedom? *(WH question)*

Polish Woman: _____(b)_____?
Szpilman: Sorry, madam, I frightened you. I wore it only to survive the cold. *(apology)*

Polish Woman: You must be relieved now that the war is over. *(modal – must)*
Szpilman: Yes. I was neither a soldier _____(c)_____, only a survivor. *(neither–nor)*

Polish Woman: _____(d)_____, they may mistake you again. *(if clause)*
Szpilman: You should tell the soldiers who I really am. *(advice)*

Polish Woman: I will. It is my duty; I must _____(e)_____. *(obligation)*

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) German Captain: Hello, are you there?
(b) Szpilman: Yes, I'm here, hiding in the attic.

(a) Polish lieutenant: What are you doing in the German coat?

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(b) Szpilman: I put it on to keep me from freezing.

(a) Szpilman: How will I survive the war hiding here?
(b) Captain: I have brought you a larger supply of bread and a warm eiderdown.

6. Complete the passage with suitable options choosing from the brackets.

(i). The situation was _____(a)_____ (urgent / urgently) when soldiers surrounded the building. Szpilman shouted _____(b)_____ (anxious / anxiously) to prove his identity. The soldiers were _____(c)_____ (entire / entirely) convinced after checking his identity. After the danger passed, the night ended _____(d)_____ (peaceful / peacefully).

(ii). Szpilman: You are leaving Warsaw now. I ___(a)___ (must / may) survive alone during the street fighting.
German Officer: You ___(b)___ (must / shouldn't) lose heart. You have survived this long.
Szpilman: But how ___(c)___ (can / should) I live if the fighting grows worse?
German Officer: If we have survived this inferno for years, we ___(d)___ (must / might) be meant to live.

(iii). The officer looked at me _____ (closely / close) and asked if I had anything to eat. I asked my question _____ in an (enquiring / enquiringly) way. He was _____ (obvious / obviously) troubled, but he spoke _____ (reassuring / reassuringly), promising to bring food and then left abruptly.

(iv). Officer: You _____ (must / may) play the piano; it will calm you.
Szpilman: I _____ (can / should) try, though I haven't practised for years.
Officer: Don't worry. You _____ (needn't / mustn't) be afraid.
Szpilman: If anyone comes, I _____ (will / should) hide in the larder.

UNIT 2

Breaking Barriers, I will Fly

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

(i). When I was born without eyes, society see (a) me as a burden. Some even suggested that I should been (b) smothered. But my parents showred (c) on me immense love and care. They felt they where (d) the richest couple in a (e) world, and I consider himself (f) the luckiest person.

(ii). However, my journey didn't end their (a). When it was time for (b) apply to top engineering schools like IIT, I was told that I couldn't sit for the competetive (c) exams because of my blindness. If IIT didn't want me, I decided I doesn't (d) want it either. I applied to top schools in a (d) United States and was accepted into MIT, Stanford, berkeley (f), and Carnegie Mellon.

(iii). We established an (a) platform, Bollant Industries together with my partner, to find, rehabilitate, nature (b), and reintegrate disabled individuals into society, rather then (c) separate them from it. We has (d) supported over 3,000 student (e) in education, vocational rehabilitation, sports, and must (f) more.

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(iv). I want to left (a) you with three lessons. First, show compasion (b) and help others thrive. True wealth don't (c) come from money but from a (d) happiness of others. Second, remove loneliness from peoples (e) lives, as it is the worst form on (f) poverty.

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

(i). For two years, Srikanth _____ the last bench, feeling excluded from other students. Despite the challenges, he was _____ a special school in Hyderabad to continue his studies. His father realized he didn't _____ the traditional farming model. He wanted to _____ science at the A.P. State Board, but was initially told he could only take arts. Srikanth couldn't _____ the competitive exams in India due to his blindness.

(fit into, sit for, send to, go on, sit on, take up)

(ii). These questions about inequality and opportunity _____ him _____ to India to make a difference. He gave up corporate opportunities in America, effectively _____ them _____. When people challenge him, he doesn't just accept it; he continues to _____ the situation confidently. Srikanth wanted to _____ corporate America or settle down, but instead focused on helping disabled individuals. Sometimes he reflects on his journey and can't help but _____ his life and achievements.

(work in, led back, get into, look at, look back, giving up)

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

(i). Let me share ___(a) story of the richest entrepreneurial couples ___(b) the world—my parents. They earned just ₹20,000 ___(c) year from their small plot of land. Giving birth to ___(d) child is the happiest thing for every married couple. At that moment___(e) time, the term *'apple of the eye' did not mean much to them. Neither of my parents had ever seen an apple, nor did I have ___(e) eye.

(a, in, the, in, a, of, an)

(ii). As ___(a) child, I spent much of my time ___(b) my father in the fields. However, my short legs made it difficult for me ___(c) help. My father began to think that perhaps ___(d) people who doubted my future might be right. He realized I didn't fit ___(e) the traditional farming model. Then he decided that education was ___(f) be my path.

(the, to, a, to, with, an, into)

(iii). Despite ___(a) challenges of trekking to ___(b) faraway school and being ignored by teachers and classmates, I persevered. For two years, I sat ___(c) the last bench, excluded from activities. I then felt like ___(d) poorest child in the world - not ___(e) account of lack of money, but because ___(f) loneliness and isolation.

(of, the, an, on, the, on, a)

(iv). After six months ___(a) legal battle, I received ___(b) government order allowing me ___(c) study science, but at my own risk. Despite the lack of resources, I worked hard, with ___(d) help of a mentor. She recorded my textbooks ___(e) audio, and I scored 98% in my exams. This proves that anyone, regardless ___(f) their 'impairment' or challenges, can achieve great things.

(on, of, an, a, to, of, the)

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4. Complete the conversation.

(i). Complete the conversation between Srikanth Bolla's Parents

Father: I worry about Sreekanth because he is blind, ___(a)____?
Mother: Yes, but what will he do if schools don't accept him?
Father: If he could see, _____(b)_____, wouldn't he?
Mother: True. Since he cannot, _____(c)_____. Could you speak to them tomorrow?
Father: Of course. Can you help him practice at home?
Mother: Certainly. Would you mind _____(d)_____?
Father: Not at all. As long as anyone believes in him, _____(e)_____.

(ii). Complete the conversation between Srikanth Bolla's and his teacher .

Teacher: Srikanth, you are confident about your future, ___(a)___?
Srikanth: Yes, madam. _____(b)_____?
Teacher: I trusted you because your determination was stronger than any limitation.
Srikanth: Since I cannot read printed books, would you mind _____(c)_____?
Teacher: Of course. Can you listen to them regularly and revise every day?
Srikanth: Yes, madam. Could you also _____(d)_____guide me if I make mistakes?
Teacher: Certainly. As long as you work hard, _____(e)_____.
Srikanth: If I could see, I would still choose education as my path.

(iii). Complete the conversation between Dr Abdul Kalam and Srikanth Bolla.

Dr Kalam: Srikanth, you believe this project can transform young minds, ___(a)___?
Srikanth: Yes, Sir. What inspired you to begin the *Lead India Youth Transformation Project*?
Dr Kalam: I started it because _____(b)_____.
Srikanth: Since I work with disabled students, would you mind _____(c)_____?
Dr Kalam: Certainly. Can you share your experiences with young people across the country?
Srikanth: Yes, Sir. Could you guide me on _____(d)_____?
Dr Kalam: As long as you stay committed, your efforts will bring change.
Srikanth: If I were not visually challenged, _____(e)_____.

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) Srikanth: Would you help me when I make mistakes?
(b) Teacher: Of course. If you continue to work hard, you will achieve success.

(a) Srikanth : My short legs make it difficult for me to help you on the farm.
(b) Father: You don't fit into the traditional farming model. You have to study.

(a) Srikanth: Why should blind children be made to sit on the last bench?
(b) His friend: You have to build a strong support system for the disabled.

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6. Complete the passage with suitable words choosing from the brackets.

(i). Srikanth Bolla proved that if determination guides a person, success is possible. _____(a) he was born blind, he refused to surrender _____(b) his parents trusted education. _____(c) society doubted his abilities, he faced obstacles with courage and patience. _____(d) he worked hard to change attitudes and create opportunities, he emerged as a successful entrepreneur and inspiration.

(as, although, after, since, because)

(ii). Srikanth Bolla faced many challenges in his college days _____(a) he was born blind. _____(b) some Indian colleges did not accept him, he worked hard _____(c) he earned a place at MIT in America. He gained confidence as teachers and peers supported him. _____(d) society provides opportunities for all, many talented students will remain unable to achieve their dreams.

(although, unless, though, until, because)

A Phoenix Rises

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

(i). Bablu Kewat had be (a) an indifferent student at best. He still remembers his science teacher Mrs Sharma, and a (b) egg incubator that he had made under her supervison (c). But when Bablu's father died living (d) his mother struggling for (e) support her small family, he dropped out of school to got (f) a job and help her out.

(ii). That evening in (a) his way back from the workshop, Bablu decided by (b) surprise Gowri with a gift. He went to a small store. The storekeeper quickly wraped (c) the napkin pack in a (d) old newspaper. Bablu was startles (e) at the exorbitant price,but dutifully paid him fourty (f) rupees.

(iii). Within twenty-four hours of first touching an (a) sanitary napkin, Bablu have (b) managed to make his own. But he was not able in (c) make a useful one as he could not make out a (d) material used by the brands. Months passed and Bablu procurred (e) different qualities of cotton and other materials in (f) make pads.

(iv). However, his experiments an (a) his obsession caused some unrest even on (b) the family. His mother beseeched him to stop a (c) experiments saying that the whole family would be disgraced on (d) his sordid interest in womens (e) menstrual cycles. The news was gradually spreading in the village and the villagers entangled the all (f) family in a mesh of coarse whispers and rude glances.

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

(i). Bablu had once _____ (a) of school to _____ (b) his family and later _____ (c) responsibilities at home. After his arranged marriage, he _____ (d) one morning looking for Gowri and _____ (e) that women used rags instead of sanitary napkins, which deeply disturbed him.

(make out, come to know, drop out, saunter out, help out take over)

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(ii). On his way home, Bablu decided to _____ (a) to a small store and buy a napkin. He _____ (b)the pad, _____ (c) the cotton on his palm to judge its weight, _____ (d) the pad in the packet, and later _____ (e) the gift to Gowri at home.

(pulled out, put back, go back, give up, handed over, spread out)

(iii). Bablu continued his experiments to help poor women. He _____ (a) materials and _____ (b) cotton to test new ideas but could not _____ (c) a perfect pad. Seeing little girls _____ (d) barefoot strengthened his resolve, and he refused to _____ (e) his mission despite many difficulties.

(give up, pulled out, make out, run around, spread out, help out)

(iv). Bablu, who had once _____ (a) to _____ (b) his family, faced strong opposition to his experiments. Though villagers mocked him, he refused to stop. He _____ (c) materials, _____ (d) cotton, and tried to _____ (e) a solution by experimenting on himself.

(turn out, dropped out, spread out, make out, pulled out, help out)

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

(i). He joined a workshop as _____ (a) busboy, getting tea _____ (b) the owner. He slowly worked his way up _____ (c) becoming _____ (d) welder. Gradually he took over _____ (e) mortgage of the workshop. After that, he ran _____ (f) business himself, growing it steadily.

(the, an, for, a, to, a, the)

(ii). One morning, Bablu's mother and younger sister, Shalu, were drinking tea. Looking _____ (a) his wife, Bablu sauntered out to _____ (b) back porch. He saw Gowri walking hurriedly _____ (c) _____ (d) bathroom, holding _____ (e) rag _____ (f) her hand.

(an, for, in, the, a, towards, the)

(iii). He unwrapped _____ (a) packet and examined _____ (b) pad. It seemed to be just plain cotton wrapped in _____ (c) gauze sheet. He placed it _____ (d) his palm, trying _____ (e) calculate the approximate weight of _____ (f) pad. 'Ten grams,' he said to himself.

(by, the, a, the, on, the, to)

(iv). He pulled out _____ (a) pair of scissors, a needle and some thread, cotton and cloth _____ (b) his bag. He began flattening _____ (c) cotton _____ (d) his hands as if he were spreading out dough _____ (e) make _____ (f) chapati.

(in, a, from, the, a, to, between)

4. Complete the conversation.

Complete the conversation between Bablu and Gowri.

Gowri: _____(a)_____, Bablu? *(wh-question)*
Bablu: I believe women need affordable sanitary pads, and someone must solve this problem.

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Gowri: People are talking about us since they do not understand your work, ___(b)___? *(question tag)*
Bablu: I know, and as society resists change, I have to be patient.

Gowri: Would you mind _____(c)_____?
Bablu: Could you trust me a little longer while I complete my experiments?

Gowri: Can you _____(d)_____?
Bablu: If I were afraid of people's words, I would never change anything. *(impossible condition)*

Gowri: I worry because _____(e)_____, but I hope your dream succeeds.

(i). Complete the conversation between Arunachalam and his mother.

Mother: Bablu, why are you working day and night on this strange machine? *(wh-question)*
Arunachalam: I am doing this because _____(a)_____, Amma.

Mother: People are mocking our family since they don't understand your intentions, _____(b)_____? *(question tag)*
Arunachalam: I know, and as change always invites criticism, I must continue my work.

Mother: Would you mind explaining how this project will really help women?
Arunachalam: Sure, _____(c)_____.

Mother: Can you take care of your health while doing this work?
Arunachalam: If I were afraid of society's words, _____(d)_____. *(impossible condition)*

Mother: I worry about you, but I pray that _____(e)_____.

(ii). Complete the conversation between Mother and Gowri.

Mother: Bablu has forgotten his workshop and his meals, _____(a)_____?
Gowri: He has, Amma. I am worried because the neighbors are whispering about his strange obsession.

Mother: Since _____(b)_____, he has brought nothing but shame to our family.
Gowri: As his wife, I feel embarrassed by his questions. If he doesn't stop soon, _____(c)_____.

Mother: I have so many questions for him! Why must he do this?
Where did he get such a scandalous idea?
Gowri: I don't know. Would you mind _____(d)_____?

Mother: I will try. Could you bring me that bag of cotton he's hiding?
We had better _____(e)_____.

(iii). Complete the conversation between Bablu and the shop keeper.

Bablu: You sell everything here, _____(a)_____?

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Shopkeeper: Yes, what do you need? I am in a hurry because _____(b)_____.

Bablu: I need a packet of those sanitary pads. Can you give me one?
Shopkeeper: Here you are. As _____(c)_____, I have wrapped it so no one sees it.

Bablu: _____(d)_____? How can a poor woman afford this?
Shopkeeper: I just sell them, I don't make the prices! If you think it's too much, you don't have to buy it.

Bablu: No, I need it. I had better _____(e)_____ why it costs so much.

5. Report the following dialogue.

Bablu : Why are you leaving me alone?
Gowri : I would only return when you give up your madness.

Bablu: Why are women forced to use dirty rags?
Doctor: Because sanitary pads are too expensive for them.

Gowri: People are laughing at your strange obsession.
Bablu: I don't care what society says.

Bablu: I will not stop this project.
Mother: You should think about the family's honour.

Villager: This work is shameful.
Bablu: It is meant to help poor women.

Teacher: Do you believe in the success of your project?
Bablu: Yes, it will change many lives.

6. Complete the passage with suitable form of the verbs choosing from the brackets.

(i). If Bablu works hard on his machine, women _____(a)_____ (will get/ would get) affordable sanitary pads.

If people _____(b)_____ (understand / understood) his intentions, they would support him instead of mocking him.

If Bablu _____(c)_____ (was/were) afraid of society, he would stop his experiments long ago.

If Bablu completes the project successfully, many women _____(d)_____ (will lead/ would lead) healthier lives.

(ii). If society judged Bablu's work properly, it _____(a)_____ (respect/ would respect) his family.

If he got discouraged by rumours, he _____(b)_____ (would abandon / abandon) the machine.

If his wife _____(c)_____ (understand / understood) his intention, she would wait more patiently.

If affordable pads _____(d)_____ (were / are) available, women will live healthier lives.

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(iii). If Bablu _____(a)_____ (was / are) afraid of criticism, he would dare never attempt such a project.

If women have access to sanitary pads, they _____(b)_____ (will avoid / would avoid) infections.

If villagers _____(c)_____ (accept / accepted) scientific thinking, they would stop rumours.

If Bablu continues his research, society _____(d)_____ (will see / would see) the benefits.

(iv). If Bablu remained silent about the issue, no one _____(a)_____ (would become / become) aware of the problem.

If Gowri _____(b)_____ (will trust / trusted) his commitment, she would support him emotionally.

If the project faces failure, Bablu _____(c)_____ (will learn / would learn) from it.

If low-cost pads are produced, poor women _____(d)_____ (will regain / regained) dignity.

(v). If Bablu _____(a)_____ (show / shows) courage, he will inspire social change.

If people had empathy, they _____(b)_____ (would support / have support) him earlier.

If Bablu _____(c)_____ (used / uses) science to solve the problem, society will benefit.

If women _____(d)_____ (gains / gain) awareness, they will make safer choices.

UNIT 3

War

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

(i). At dawn, in a stufy _____(a) and smoky second class carriage on ____(b) which a few people have_____(c) already spent the night, an _____(d) stout woman in deep mourning was hoisted in. Behind her, puffing and moaning, follow _____(e) her husband—a tiny man, thin and weak, his face death-white. his _____(f) eyes were small and bright and he looked shy and uneasy.

(ii). The war was taking away from her there _____(a) only son, a boy of twenty. Both on _____(b) them had devoted their entire life in _____(c) him. They had even broken up their home at sulmona _____(d) to follow him to Rome, where he had to go as an _____(e) student. They allowed him to volunteer for war with an assurance that for at least six month _____(f) he would not be sent to the war front.

(iii). You may spoil your only son by excesive _____(a) attentions, but you cannot love him more then _____(b) you would love all your other childrens _____(c) if you had any. Parental love are _____(d) not like bread that can be broken at _____(e) pieces and split amongst a _____(f) children in equal shares.

(iv). We belong in _____(a) them but they never belong to we _____(b). And when they reaches _____(c) twenty, they are exactly what we are _____(d) at their age. Now, at our age, a _____(e) love of our country is still great, of course, but strongest _____(f) than it is the love of our children.

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2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

(i). Passengers stranded at Fabriano continued their journey by a local train. At dawn, a mourning woman was _____ (a), followed by her weak husband. He _____ (b) to comfort her, but she _____ (c) her collar in grief. The war was _____ (d) their only son, for whom they had _____ (e) their home.

(belong to, take away, hoist in, pull up, turn round, break up)

(ii). The grieving woman felt no one pitied her sorrow. Fellow passengers spoke of sons who had _____ (a) wounded and were _____ (b) to war. They argued that parents must bravely _____ (c) their children, who _____ (d) the nation. A stout traveller angrily rejected selfish grief and _____ (e) his intense belief in sacrifice.

(take away, come back, show off, see off, belong to, send back)

(iii). The travellers listened as one father said children _____ (a) the country. A stout man opposed him, claiming parents belong to their children and must accept sacrifice. Urging others to _____ (b) courage, he tried to _____ (c) his calm. Yet when emotions overwhelmed him, he _____ (d) laughter and finally _____ (e) a sob-like cry.

(show off, belong to, join in, break into, turn to, break down)

(iv). Listening quietly, the woman sought strength to accept a son being _____ (a) by war. The traveller's words made her rethink her grief and _____ (b)her son bravely, as others had. Hearing how his son had died, she realised many families were _____ (c). When she asked the truth, the father _____ (d), his sorrow _____ (e) uncontrollably.

(pull up, take away, see off, break up, break down, come back)

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

(i). Having at last taken _____(a) seat, he politely thanked ____(b) passengers who had helped his wife by making room _____(c) her. Then he turned round _____(d) the woman and politely inquired: "Are you all right, dear?" The wife, instead _____(e) answering, pulled up the collar of her coat to hide her face. "Nasty world," muttered _____(f) husband with a sad smile.

(the, on, a, the, to, of, for)

(ii). The woman was twisting and wriggling, _____(a) times growling like ____(b) wild animal. She felt certain that all those explanations would not have aroused even _____(c) shadow _____(d) sympathy from those people. They _____(e) all, most likely, in _____(f) same plight as herself.

(for, a, at, were, of, the, a)

(iii). If Country is _____(a) natural necessity like bread, somebody must go ____(b) defend it. And our sons go, when they _____(c) twenty, and they don't want tears, because _____(d) they die, _____(e) die happy. Everyone _____(f) stop crying; everyone should laugh.

(to, are, the, a, they, should, if)

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(iv). The woman, bundled in _____(a) corner, had been sitting and listening till he finished. For ____(b) last three months, she had been trying _____(c) find in the words of her husband and her friends, something _____(d) console her. She wanted something that might show her how _____(e) mother should send her son to a probable danger _____(f) life.

(to, a, and, to, a, of, the)

4. Complete the conversation.

(i). Complete the conversation in the Railway Compartment.

Passenger 1: We have been travelling for hours discussing our children all this time.
Mother: Yes, everyone here _____(a)_____ because of the war.
Father: You look tired, _____(b)_____?
Mother: I am sorry if I sounded harsh earlier.
Father: That's all right, but I had been_____(c)_____ before I spoke.
Passenger 2: Either we accept fate _____(d)_____.
Father: Neither anger nor tears can bring our sons back.
Mother: If the war ends, parents will suffer less.
Passenger 3: You had better _____(e)_____.
Mother: I disagree; a parent has the right to grieve.

(ii). Complete the conversation between the Father and the Mother

Father: My son _____(a)_____ at the front for six months before the letter arrived.
Mother: I have been waiting for news every single day.
Father: You understand my pain, _____(b)_____?
Mother: I'm truly sorry for your loss.
Father: _____(c)_____ or he dies with honour.
Mother: Neither prayers nor tears stopped the war.
Father: If parents were united, _____(d)_____.
Mother: You had better control your emotions in public.
Father: I object to that; _____(e)_____.
Mother: He had had great courage even as a child.

(iii). Complete the heated discussion in the Train

Father: I have been _____(a)_____ since we boarded.
Mother: My husband had been talking proudly before he broke down.
Father: War is cruel, _____(b)_____?
Stout man: Sorry, I didn't mean to interrupt you.
Father: Either a son dies young or a parent lives in sorrow.
Mother: Neither hope _____(c)_____.
Stout man: If the train stops, we will hear more bad news.
Mother: You had better _____(d)_____; others are listening.
Father: I strongly disagree _____(e)_____ .
Mother: He had had dreams like any other boy.

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(iv). Complete the conversation between the Father and the Mother consoling each other

Mother: I have been crying since _____(a)_____.
Father: I had been praying all night before dawn.
Mother: You feel helpless too, _____(b)_____?
Father: I apologise if my words sounded insensitive.
Mother: _____(c)_____ or it destroys us.
Father: Neither courage nor fear saved our sons.
Mother: If people understood war, _____(d)_____.
Father: You had better _____(e)_____.
Mother: I don't agree; silence only deepens sorrow.
Father: He had had a bright future before the war.

(v). Complete the reflection on war between the father and mother

Father: We have been sharing our grief with strangers today.
Mother: I had been _____(a)_____ till the last moment.
Father: War changes everyone, _____(b)_____?
Mother: Forgive me if I sound bitter.
Father: Either parents lose sons or nations lose humanity.
Mother: Neither victory _____(c)_____ comforts parents.
Father: _____(d)_____, suffering will multiply.
Mother: You had better _____(e)_____, even if it hurts.
Father: I must protest; war has no justification.
Mother: He had had innocence before becoming a soldier.

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) Father: Our son was brave till the end.
(b) Mother: Yes, but no parent should lose a child to war.

(a) Traveller: I received a letter from my son yesterday.
(b) Father: My son has been missing for three months.

(a) Father: Why are you trembling like this?
(b) Mother: Control yourself, what a terrible war it is!

(a) Father: I sent my son to fight for the country.
(b) Traveller: Every parent here has made the same sacrifice.

(a) Traveller: Will our children return alive from the war?
(b) Father: Don't lose hope, what a tragic time we live in!

6. Complete the passage with suitable words choosing from the brackets.

(i). The travelers did not know how to _____(a)_____ the grieving woman without offending her. The woman felt it was not _____(b)_____ that some were sent to the warfront while others stayed behind. The old man began to _____(c)_____ the crowd in the carriage, explaining why they should not weep. Despite his _____(d)_____ arguments about patriotism, the man eventually broke down in tears.

(address, fair)

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(ii). The mourning mother was not feeling _____(a)_____ due to the heat in the stuffy carriage. The fat man argued that a son belongs to the Country, and the Country has the _____(b)_____ to claim him. The passengers noticed that tears did not _____(c)_____ up in the eyes of the old man who spoke of his son's stoicism. He believed his perspective was the only _____(d)_____ way to view a soldier's sacrifice.

(well, right)

(iii). The _____(a)_____ war had taken away the peace of every family in the compartment. An underlying _____(b)_____ of grief moved through the passengers as they listened to the man's speech. The grieving mother continued to _____(c)_____ the floor of the carriage, lost in her own pain. The old man glanced at his _____(d)_____ as the train moved slowly toward the next station

(watch, current)

(iv). Because the carriage windows were shut, the air inside became very _____(a)_____ and uncomfortable. The parents found it difficult to _____(b)_____ their deep sorrow to the other passengers. The fat man insisted that his son had died _____(c)_____ to his side in spirit, fulfilling his duty. The _____(d)_____ journey was interrupted by many stops, adding to the travelers' irritation.

(express, close)

(v). The passengers found it hard to _____(a)_____ the loud, intellectual arguments of the fat man. The old man claimed that a father should _____(b)_____ the loss of a son with pride and stoicism. The passengers were not the _____(c)_____ of people to ignore a lady in distress. The fat man argued that it was actually _____(d)_____ of the Country to take their sons when they were young and happy.

(bear, kind)

A Piece of String

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

(i). Along all _____(a) a roads around Goderville, the peasants ____(b) or their wives were coming _____(c) by the town because _____(d) that was market day. Some led a cow _____(e) and a calf by a cord, and their wives, walking behind the animal, whipped it with a _____(f) leaf branch to hasten its progress.

(ii). At the tavern, the great hall _____(a) is full of people eating. ____(b) A appetising odour of roast meat rose _____(c) in the hearth which made everybody's _____(d) month water. The dishes were _____(e) passing and emptied, as were the jugs of cider. The _____(f) peasants discussed the crops, and their purchases and sales.

(iii). This is hereby made known _____(a) by the inhabitants of ____(b) goderville, and to all persons _____(c) presented at the market: There was lost _____(d) thus morning on the road, between nine _____(e) or ten o'clock, a black leather pocketbook _____(f) contains five hundred francs and some business papers.

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(iv). The next Tuesday, he went _____(a) in the market at Goderville, just to discuss ____(b) a case. Malandain, standing at _____(c) their door, began to laugh on seeing him _____(d) passive. When he was seated _____(e) on the table in the tavern, _____(f) she began to explain the affair.

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

(i). On market day at Goderville, peasants crowded the square. Hauchecome arrived, _____ (a) a piece of string and ____ it _____ (b) quietly. Ashamed when Malandain noticed him, he pretended to _____ (c) something else and _____ (d) the market as people _____ (e) around him.

(shut up, roll up, pick up, run to, look for, call out)

(ii). After the crowd began to _____ (a), Hauchecome _____ (b) for the tavern. When the public crier_____ (c) the announcement, fear seemed to _____ (d) of the villagers' hearts, as the news of the lost pocketbook threatened to _____ (e) the peace of the market.

(fall out, go away, mix up, take away, draw out, set out)

(iii). After the news _____ (a) the tavern, a gendarme appeared and ordered Hauchecome to _____ (b) and meet the Mayor. As he _____ (c), the truth slowly _____ (d) to be twisted by suspicion, while Malandain watched him _____ (e), accusing him falsely.

(keep on, turn out, pass by, spread through, go along, get out)

(iv). Though the truth finally _____ (a), the villagers told Hauchecome to _____. (b) They _____ (c) his innocence with suspicion. Shamed and hurt, he _____ (d) repeating his story and _____ (e) proving himself, though no one was ready to believe him.

(keep on, come out, roll up, mix up, take to, shut up)

(v). When the truth _____ (a), Hauchecome _____ (b) to tell his story everywhere. But villagers only laughed and _____ (c) insults. At the market, events _____ (d) against him, and he was told to _____ (e), leaving him humiliated and broken.

(put out, come out, call out, turn out, set out, get out)

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

(i). Hauchecome had just arrived _____(a) Goderville, and he was walking towards ____(b) public square. Then he saw _____(c) little piece of string _____(d) the ground. He thought that everything useful ought _____(e) be picked up. He took the bit of thin cord _____(f) the ground and began to roll it carefully.

(from, at, a, to, in, the, on)

(ii). Suddenly _____(a) drum beat in the courtyard ____(b) the tavern. Everybody rose, except a few, and ran _____(c) the door or to _____(d) windows, their mouths still full. _____(e) the public crier had ceased his drumbeating, he called out in_____(f) jerky voice.

(on, to, the, outside, the, a, after)

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(iii). The news spread through _____(a)the neighbourhood. Hauchecome was informed ____(b)of it. He immediately began _____(c)to recount his story with its happy climax. He was _____(d)in triumph. He talked of his adventure all day long. He told it _____(e)on the highway to people who were passing _____(f)by, in the wine shop to people who were drinking there

(of, the, by, in, a, on, to)

(iv). He went home ashamed and indignant, choking _____(a) anger and confusion. His innocence was impossible ____(b) prove. And he was stricken to the heart _____(c) the injustice _____(d) the suspicion. Then he began _____(e) recount _____(f) adventure again, prolonging his history every day.

(with, of, a, to, the, by, to)

4. Complete the conversation.

(i). Complete the conversation between Hauchecome and a villager

Hauchecome: I only picked up a piece of string, _____(a)_____? *(question tag)*
Villager: _____(b)_____? *(question)*
Hauchecome: I had been walking slowly because my rheumatism was troubling me. *(past perfect continuous)*
Villager: People have been _____(c)_____ since morning. *(present perfect continuous)*
Hauchecome: It was either a string or nothing at all. *(either–or)*
Villager: It was neither a purse _____(d)_____ that we saw you take. *(neither–nor)*
Hauchecome: If I had stolen it, I would have run away. *(if condition)*
Villager: You had better _____(e)_____. *(had better)*
Hauchecome: I'm sorry you doubt me; I swear I am innocent. *(apology)*
Villager: You argue too much, but your words sound honest. *(argument expression)*

(ii). Complete the conversation between Hauchecorne and the Mayor

Mayor: You picked something up, _____(a)_____? *(question tag)*
Hauchecorne: What do you think I took from the ground? *(question)*
Mayor: People had been watching you closely at the market. *(past perfect continuous)*
Hauchecorne: I have been _____(b)_____. *(present perfect continuous)*
Mayor: It is _____(c)_____ or the purse, choose one. *(either–or)*
Hauchecorne: It was neither gold nor silver, only string. *(neither–nor)*
Mayor: _____(d)_____, matters would not have worsened. *(if condition)*
Hauchecorne: I had better defend my honour till the end. *(had better)*
Mayor: You had accused no one, hadn't you?
Hauchecorne: _____(e)_____, if my words sound angry. *(apology)*

(iii). Complete the conversation between Hauchecorne and Malandain

Malandain: You are hiding something, _____(a)_____? *(question tag)*
Hauchecorne: _____(b)_____? *(question)*
Malandain: I had been observing you before you bent down. *(past perfect continuous)*
Hauchecorne: I have been suffering because of your false claim. *(present perfect continuous)*
Malandain: It is either truth or trickery. *(either–or)*

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Hauchecorne: _____(c)_____ nor coin. *(neither–nor)*
Malandain: If you were honest, you would not argue so much. *(if condition)*
Hauchecorne: You had better _____(d)_____. *(had better)*
Malandain: You had known the trouble this would cause, hadn't you?
Hauchecorne: I regret speaking harshly, _____(e)_____. *(apology + argument)*

(iv). Complete the conversation between Hauchecorne and his neighbour

Neighbour: Everyone doubts you, _____(a)_____? *(question tag)*
Hauchecorne: _____(b)_____? *(question)*
Neighbour: People had been laughing at you all day. *(past perfect continuous)*
Hauchecorne: I have been trying _____(c)_____ since morning. *(present perfect continuous)*
Neighbour: It is either belief or suspicion among villagers. *(either–or)*
Hauchecorne: I took neither money _____(d)_____. *(neither–nor)*
Neighbour: If you had ignored the string, this wouldn't happen. *(if condition)*
Hauchecorne: I had better _____(e)_____. *(had better)*
Neighbour: You had trusted people too much, hadn't you? *(had–had)*
Hauchecorne: Sorry, friend, my anger is only from pain. *(apology)*

(v). Complete the conversation between Hauchecorne and the Doctor

Doctor: You still insist you're innocent, _____(a)_____? *(question tag)*
Hauchecorne: Why won't anyone believe me? *(question)*
Doctor: You had been _____(b)_____ for days. *(past perfect continuous)*
Hauchecorne: I have been suffering more from shame than illness. *(present perfect continuous)*
Doctor: It is either truth _____(c)_____. *(either–or)*
Hauchecorne: I stole neither purse nor money. *(neither–nor)*
Doctor: If people had trusted you, _____(d)_____. *(if condition)*
Hauchecorne: I had better _____(e)_____. *(had better)*
Doctor: You had lost hope, hadn't you? *(had–had)*
Hauchecorne: Forgive them, Doctor; society judged me unfairly. *(apology + argument)*

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) Hauchecorne: I picked up only a piece of string from the ground.
(b) Villager: People think you have stolen the purse.

(a) Mayor: Why did you bend down in the marketplace?
(b) Hauchecorne: I was only picking up a piece of string.

(a) Malandain: I saw you take something from the ground.
(b) Hauchecorne: You are lying; I took nothing but a string.

(a) Neighbour: Why have you been repeating the same story everywhere?
(b) Hauchecorne: I have been trying to clear my name.

(a) Hauchecorne: What a cruel world this is!
(b) Doctor: You must control your emotions.

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6. Complete the passage by choosing the appropriate words from the brackets.

(i). The Mayor confronted Maitre Hauchecorne about the lost pocketbook. Hauchecorne was shocked because he had (a) _____ seen the purse (b) _____ stolen it. He tried to explain that it was just a piece of string, but (c) _____ the Mayor (d) _____ the townspeople believed his story.

(neither, nor, either, or)

(ii). Maitre Malandain and Hauchecorne were old enemies. There was (a) _____ a deep-seated grudge (b) _____ a simple misunderstanding between them that led to the false accusation. Malandain would (c) _____ tell the truth (d) _____ keep quiet; he chose to lie to ruin Hauchecorne's reputation.

(neither, nor, either, or)

(iii). After the purse was found by a farm laborer, Hauchecorne felt relieved. He thought that (a) _____ the villagers would apologize (b) _____ at least stop mocking him. Unfortunately, (c) _____ the return of the purse (d) _____ his constant explanations could convince the people of his innocence.

(neither, nor, either, or)

(iv). Hauchecorne became obsessed with his innocence. He would (a) _____ stop people on the road (b) _____ visit the tavern to repeat his tale. He realized that in their eyes, he was (c) _____ a simple man (d) _____ a clever thief who was over-explaining his "crime."

(neither, nor, either, or)

(v). By the end of the story, Hauchecorne's health declined rapidly. He could (a) _____ eat (b) _____ sleep peacefully due to the mental agony. It was (c) _____ the weight of the lie (d) _____ the cruelty of the society that finally broke his spirit.

(neither, nor, either, or)

UNIT 4

<u>Shākuntalam</u>

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

(i). Charioteer, _____(a) <u>a</u> deer has led us a long chase. And even now ____(b) <u>he</u> neck in beauty bends as backward looks he sends at _____(c) <u>me</u> pursuing car that threatens death from far. Fear shrinks to half the body small; see how he _____(d) <u>fear</u> the arrow's fall! The path he takes is strewed _____(e) in blades of grass half chewed. He leaps so often and so high He _____(f) <u>do</u> not seem to run, but fly. Pursue as I may, I can hardly keep him in sight.

(ii). I _____(a) <u>thing</u> I hear someone to the right of the grove. He ____(b) <u>walked</u> and looks about. Ah, here are hermit girls, _____(c) <u>by</u> watering pots. They are coming _____(d) <u>on</u> this direction to water _____(e) <u>a</u> young trees….I will draw back into the shade and wait _____(f) <u>in</u> them.

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What _____(a) the pretty pair they make! ____(b) the jasmine shows her youth _____(c) on her fresh flowers, and the mango tree _____(d) show his strength in his _____(e) ripning fruit. Here is the spring creeper that Father Kanva tended with his _____(f) won hands just as he did you. You are forgetting her.

(iii). We are _____(a) in our way to gather firewood. Here, on ____(b) a bank of Malini, you may see the _____(c) hermitege of Father Kanva, over which Shakuntala presides as _____(d) we guardian. He has left his daughter _____(e) for welcome guests, and has just _____(f) go to Somatirtha.

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

(i). The Charioteer had to _____ (a) the horses because of the rough terrain, allowing the deer to take the lead. However, as they _____ (b) on level ground, the King prepares to finish the hunt. He orders the hunt to _____ (c), but the deer tries to _____ (d) in fear. To observe the hermitage, the King must later _____ (e).

(run up, draw near, run away, hold back, draw back, go on)

(ii). When the hermits _____ (a) to save the deer, the King stops his hunt. They _____ (b) his sense of justice to protect the innocent. Before they _____ (c) to collect firewood, they invite the King to the grove. He must _____ (d)the right moment to meet Shakuntala, who stays behind to _____ (e) the sacred hermitage.

(drive on, run up, wait for, care for, cling to, call upon)

(iii). The King orders his charioteer to _____ (a) toward the pious grove. Upon arrival, he decides to dismount so he does not disturb the peaceful atmosphere. He instructs the charioteer to _____ (b) him while he enters the hermitage. The surroundings show how the residents _____ (c) nature, leading the King to _____ (d) his own modesty before he decides to _____ (e) to the grove.

(draw near, drive on, care for, run up, call upon, wait for)

(iv). As the hermit girls _____ (a) to water the trees, the King decided to _____ (b) into the shade. He chose to _____ (c) a better moment to introduce himself. While watching, he noticed how the jasmine vine seemed to _____ (d) the mango tree. Meanwhile, water began to _____ (e) the pots as Shakuntala lovingly tended the grove.

(drop from, draw near, wait for, get up, draw back, cling to)

(v). Shakuntala notices how the jasmine vines _____ (a) the mango tree, symbolizing a perfect union. Her friends remind her to _____ (b) the spring creeper, which has unexpectedly blossomed. As the girls _____ (c) chatting about her future marriage, a bee attacks Shakuntala. The King, having told his driver to _____ (d) earlier, continues to _____ (e) the right moment to intervene.

(go in, cling to, drive on, wait for, go on, care for)

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

(i). O King, this deer belongs _____(a) the hermitage. Why should his tender form expire, as blossoms perish in ____(b) fire? How could that gentle life endure, _____(c) deadly arrow sharp and sure? Restore your arrow _____(d) the quiver; to you were weapons lent the broken hearted _____(e) deliver, not strike _____(f) innocent.

(to, a, the, to, the, to, the)

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(ii). Your Majesty, I have been holding _____(a) horses back because the ground was rough. This gave the deer ____(b) lead. Now we are _____(c) level ground, and you _____(d) easily overtake him. Your Majesty, here are two hermits, who have come _____(e) save the deer just when your arrow was about _____(f) fall.

(to, the, will, on, a, the, to)

(iii). It seems _____(a)to me, dear, that Father Kanva cares more for ____(b) the hermitage trees than he does _____(c)for you. You are delicate as _____(d)a jasmine blossom, yet he tells you to fill the trenches about the trees. We have watered the trees that blossom _____(e)in the summer time. Now let's sprinkle those whose flowering time is past. That will be _____(f)a better deed, because we shall not be working for a reward

(a, to, for, in, the, on, a)

(iv). Shakuntala, we have watered _____(a) trees that blossom ____(b) the summer time. Now let's sprinkle those whose flowering time is past. That will be _____(c) better deed, because we shall not be working for _____(d) reward. When I see you there, it looks as if _____(e) vine were clinging to _____(f) mango tree.

(a, the, a, on, in, a, the)

4. Complete the conversation.

(i). Complete the conversation between the King and the Charioteer

King: The deer has led us a long chase, _____(a)_____?
Charioteer: Yes, Your Majesty. I am holding the horses back because the ground is rough.
King: If the ground becomes level, _____(b)_____ ?
Charioteer: Certainly. You had better prepare your arrow now. (Had better)
King: Would you mind _____(c)_____?
Charioteer: I shall do so. _____(d)_____?
King: It is leaping so high it seems to fly.
Charioteer: I would rather not lose sight of it.
King: You are right. We had better _____(e)_____.
Charioteer: Look! The ground is smooth now; we overtake him easily.

(ii). Complete the conversation between the King and the hermits

Hermit: O King, this deer belongs to the hermitage, _____(a)_____?
King: I did not realize it. I stop the hunt immediately.
Hermit: You had better _____(b)_____.
King: Would you mind forgiving my ignorance?
Hermit: _____(c)_____, you will receive a blessing.
King: _____(d)_____?
Hermit: It is like a child to us. I would rather die than see it harmed.
King: I am returning the arrow to my quiver right now.
Hermit: You had better _____(e)_____.
King: I shall obey your command, holy sage.

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(iii). Complete the conversation between the King and Charioteer

King: This is the entrance to the pious grove, _____(a)_____?
Charioteer: It is, Your Majesty. _____(b)_____.
King: If I enter with my jewels, I will disturb the peace.
Charioteer: You had better _____(c)_____.
King: _____(d)_____?
Charioteer: Not at all. I am waiting here until you return.
King: Which way should I walk to find the girls?
Charioteer: You had better _____(d)_____.
King: I would rather walk modestly than appear as a king. (Rather)
Charioteer: May your visit be peaceful.

(iv). Complete the conversation between Shakuntala and Anasuya

Anasuya: Father Kanva cares more for these trees than for you, _____(a)_____?
Shakuntala: No, I feel like a sister to these plants.
Anasuya: You had better rest while I water the jasmine.
Shakuntala: I would rather do it myself, _____(b)_____.
Anasuya: Would you mind _____(c)_____?
Shakuntala: I am watering the spring creeper next.
Anasuya: _____(d)_____?
Shakuntala: If I water it lovingly, it will bloom even out of season.
Anasuya: You had better not _____(d)_____.
Shakuntala: Look, it is waving its branches at me!

(v). Complete the conversation between Priyamvada and Shakuntala

Priyamvada: You are to be married soon, _____(a)_____?
Shakuntala: Why do you tease me? I water the plants to be helpful.
Priyamvada: You had better _____(b)_____; a bee is coming!
Shakuntala: Would you mind helping me drive it away?
Priyamvada: If you are in trouble, _____(c)_____.
Shakuntala: _____(d)_____?
Priyamvada: You are calling upon King Dushyanta in your mind, I see!
Shakuntala: I would rather you helped me than joked about it.
Priyamvada: You had better not _____(d)_____.
Shakuntala: It is flying right into my face!

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) Charioteer: Your Majesty, I have been holding the horses back as the ground was rough.
(b) King: Now we are on level ground, and you will easily overtake the deer.

(a) Hermit: O King, this deer belongs to the hermitage and must not be killed.
(b) King: I shall stop the chariot immediately.

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(a) Anasuya: Why are you watering the spring creeper so lovingly?
(b) Shakuntala: She is my sister and I want to give her water.

(a) Shakuntala: Save me from this dreadful bee!
(b) Priyamvada: You should call upon King Dushyanta because he is the protector of the grove.

(a) King: Why should I wear these jewels while entering the hermitage?
(b) Charioteer: You are right, Your Majesty; one must be modest in a sacred place.

6. Complete the passage by choosing the appropriate profession from the brackets.

(i). Ravi had a persistent cough, so he consulted a (a) _____ to check his lungs. His sister, who has sensitive skin, visited a (b) _____ for a check-up. Meanwhile, their grandfather, who has a heart condition, regularly sees a (c) _____. Before going home, they stopped at a local shop where a (d) _____ prepared their medicines.

(Cardiologist, Pharmacist, Pulmonologist, Dermatologist)

(ii). Meera is fascinated by the natural world. As a (a) _____, she spends her days studying rare plants in the forest. Her friend, an (b) _____, joins her to observe the migration patterns of birds. In the nearby valley, a (c) _____ examines rock formations to understand the earth's history, while a (d) _____ works in a lab studying living organisms and cells.

(Geologist, Biologist, Botanist, Ornithologist)

(iii). The daily newspaper features work from various talented people. The (a) _____ writes detailed reports about current events, while the (b) _____ creates funny drawings that mock social issues. In the evening, a famous (c) _____ performs a classical concerto on the keys, and a local (d) _____ displays beautiful landscape paintings in the gallery.

(Cartoonist, Journalist, Artist, Pianist)

(iv). Space exploration requires the expertise of an (a) _____ who studies stars and galaxies. On Earth, an (b) _____ analyzes human evolution and ancient cultures. To understand modern society, an (c) _____ studies the production and consumption of wealth, while a (d) _____ helps people deal with their mental and emotional challenges.

(Economist, Anthropologist, Astronomist, Psychologist)

(v). While traveling through Kerala, a (a) _____ visited the famous temples and backwaters. During his trip, he met a (b) _____ who was testing water samples for chemical purity in a lab. He also had a sudden toothache and had to find a (c) _____ quickly. Later, he read an article by a (d) _____ about the social habits of the local tribes.

(Chemist, Dentist, Tourist, Journalist)

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Trills and Thrills: Birdwatching in India

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

(i). One of the standard questions _____(a) in me is about the thrilling ____(b) adventeres in a lifetime of exploring for birds. _____(c) Me answer must seem disappointing. Ornithology as a hobby or profession, _____(d) through full of adventures, rewards and disappointments, _____(e) are usually one of the most peaceful of pursuits. It is certainly not _____(f) lacked in excitement and thrills, though.

(ii). While the field study _____(a) on birds is a peaceful ____(b) ocuupation, it is not entirely without hazards. In elephant-ridden jungles in South _____(c) india for instance, I have frequently _____(d) fond myself in disturbing situations. A wild elephant, suddenly _____(e) came upon at close quarters – a situation by no means uncommon in _____(f) part of Karnataka and Kerala – can be an unnerving experience

(iii). He was an Austrian _____(a) anthrapologist, Baron Omar Rolf. He claimed ornithology ____(b) so be his second love and expressed great keenness on accompanying _____(c) my the next morning. Led by a forest guard, we were stalking along a narrow animal _____(d) tail through dense tall grassland above five feet _____(e) hight – the right kind of habitat for the Broad-tailed Grass _____(f) warbler.

(iv). Just as I got it in the field _____(a) on my glasses, it hopped ____(b) an bit further up. So, to get a better view _____(c) my took a step back, with the glasses still glued to my eyes, entirely _____(d) unmindfull of where I was standing with my back to _____(e) a abyss. As I did so, I felt a small pebble slip from under my heel and heard a faint continuing clatter as it went rolling _____(f) up the hill.

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

(i). Ornithology, though often thought thrilling, is mostly peaceful. The narrator _____ (a) reading about birds and began observing them closely. In the field, he sometimes _____ (b) unexpected dangers like elephants. Such risks must be _____ (c), yet they never _____ (d) the joy of discovery, even as forests _____way_____ (e)development.

(look back, grow up, take away, put up with, make for, come upon)

(ii). During his journey and birdwatching experiences, the narrator would _____ (a) early to observe birds closely. While exploring forests, he often _____ (b)unusual behaviour and sudden dangers. Once, he_____ (c) just as stones _____ (d) a slope. Such thrilling moments _____ (e) a lasting charm to his otherwise peaceful pursuit of ornithology.

(grow up, put on, get up, roll down, look back, come across)

(iii). The narrator, who had _____ (a) loving birds, met Baron Omar Rolf at Parambikulam. While stalking a warbler, they suddenly faced a tusker and had to flee. Though fear did not make them _____ (b) birdwatching, the forest later _____ (c) for development. The incident made the narrator_____ (d) and _____ (e) with amusing memories of adventure.

(come up, grow up, make way, give up, set up, look back)

(iv). During a Himalayan journey, the narrator _____ (a) a terrifying moment on a narrow trail. As he _____ (b) observing a bird, a pebble _____ (c), revealing how close he was to

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disaster. Though the risky search could have been _____ (d), his passion for birds made him _____ (e) despite the danger.

(roll down, come upon, carry on, go on, come across, call off)

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

(i). I had grown up only _____(a) the traditional accounts of ____(b) nesting habits of birds. These were interesting enough for _____(c) keen bird photographer, as I was, to want _____(d) record on film. But while concealed in a canvas hide, perched high _____(e) on a stepladder, a few yards away from the nests, I noticed some unusual goings on which clearly showed that _____(f) birds had not read the textbooks.

(an, the, up, on, a, to, the)

(ii). My journey by _____(a) romantic Cochin Forest Tramway was ____(b) February 1946, shortly before it was dismantled to make way _____(c) the gigantic Parambikulam hydro-electric project. The huge dam _____(d) reservoir has now completely submerged Parambikulam and all _____(e) lovely country around it. We reached Parambikulam just as it _____(f) getting dark.

(and, the, for, an, the, in, was)

(iii). Upon turning a bend in _____(a) path, the forest guard suddenly ducked, excitedly pointing ____(b) front. I just glimpsed the head of _____(c) tusker striding down the same path from _____(d) opposite direction, and turned _____(e) flee as fast as I could, motioning to Omar, who was ten yards _____(f) me, to do likewise. I have not seen anyone react more quickly.

(to, behind, the, a, in, on, the)

(iv). Ornithology may sometimes entail hazards of _____(a) different kind. I recall one particularly hair-raising incident along ____(b) Himalayan trail from Almora _____(c) the Lipu Lekh Pass on my way to Lake Manasarovar and Mount Kailas _____(d) 1945. It was at a particularly narrow part _____(e) the trail with a thousand feet of vertical scarp on one side and the roaring Kali river some 300 feet vertically _____(f) the other.

(down, an, in, a, to, the, of)

4. Complete the conversation.

Complete the conversation between Salim Ali and a Young Companion

Salim Ali: _____(a)_____?
Companion: I am watching a sunbird feeding on nectar.
Salim Ali: You have been observing birds very patiently,_____(b)_____?
Companion: Yes, I have been learning birdwatching for two years.
Salim Ali: Before I reached here, I had been walking along this trail alone.
Companion: If we keep silent, _____(c)_____.
Salim Ali: You had better _____(d)_____.
Companion: Why do birds get disturbed so easily?
Salim Ali: Birds are sensitive because _____(e)_____.
Companion: This journey is truly thrilling.

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(i). Complete the conversation between Salim Ali and a Forest Guard

Guard: Why are you standing near the cliff, sir?
Salim Ali: I am noting the nesting habits of rare birds.
Guard: You have been travelling through difficult terrain, _____(a)_____?
Salim Ali: Yes, I have been exploring these mountains for many years.
Guard: Before sunrise, _____(b)_____ continuously.
Salim Ali: _____(ac)_____, our work will become risky.
Guard: You had better _____(d)_____.
Salim Ali: How do you protect birds from hunters?
Guard: We stay alert and _____(e)_____.
Salim Ali: Your duty supports conservation greatly.

(ii). Complete the conversation between Salim Ali and a Village Boy

Boy: Sir, _____(a)_____?
Salim Ali: I am recording bird calls and movements.
Boy: You have been watching birds since morning, _____(b)_____?
Salim Ali: Yes, I have been enjoying this peaceful environment.
Boy: Before you arrived, I had been _____(c)_____.
Salim Ali: If you listen carefully, you can identify birds by sound.
Boy: I had better _____(d)_____

Salim Ali: _____(e)_____?
Boy: They make the village lively and beautiful.
Salim Ali: That love will make you a good naturalist.

Complete the conversation between Salim Ali and a Fellow Ornithologist

Ornithologist: Which bird species are you studying now?
Salim Ali: I am studying _____(a)_____.
Ornithologist: You have been documenting bird behaviour extensively, _____(b)_____?
Salim Ali: Yes, I have been collecting data for my research book.
Ornithologist: Before joining you, _____(c)_____ near the lake.
Salim Ali: If migration patterns change, it may indicate climate issues.
Ornithologist: We had better _____(d)_____.
Salim Ali: _____(e)_____?
Ornithologist: I have worked as a researcher for ten years.
Salim Ali: Together, we can strengthen bird conservation.

Complete the conversation between Salim Ali and a Curious Tourist

Tourist: _____(a)_____ ?
Salim Ali: Discovering rare species in nature is thrilling.
Tourist: You have been travelling across India, _____(a)_____?

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Salim Ali: Yes, I have been studying birds in different habitats.
Tourist: Before meeting you, I had been unaware of India's bird diversity.
Salim Ali: If people understand birds, _____(a)_____ better.
Tourist: I had better _____(a)_____.
Salim Ali: Why do you want to learn birdwatching?
Tourist: It connects me with nature.
Salim Ali: _____(a)_____ .

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) Salim Ali: What are you observing through the binoculars?
(b) Baron Omar: I am watching a rare bird near the water body.

(a) Companion: How long have you been travelling for birdwatching?
(b) Salim Ali: I have been exploring different regions of India for many years.

(a) Forest Guard: Don't make any noise here!
(b) Salim Ali: Yes, I will remain silent while observing the birds.

(a) Salim Ali: What a beautiful call that bird has!
(b) Young Boy: Yes, sir, it sounds very musical.

(a) Guard: Should we move closer to the nest?
(b) Salim Ali: No, we must keep a safe distance to avoid disturbing the birds.

6. Complete the passage with suitable choosing from the brackets.

(i). Salim Ali always chose the (a) _____ route while trekking through forests. In autumn, the trees shed their dry (b) _____ along the forest path. Every living creature has a (c) _____ to survive freely in nature. At dawn, the birdwatcher quietly (d) _____ the campsite.

(right, leaves)

(ii). Birdwatching demands a special (a) _____ of patience and dedication. Mumbai, the financial (b) _____ of India, is often mentioned in travel notes. Salim Ali observed every (c) _____ of bird with equal interest. Knowledge is the greatest (d) _____ for a naturalist in the field.

(capital, kind)

(iii). A high (a) _____ of alertness is required to spot rare birds. The forest (b) _____ was hidden behind thick bushes. Salim Ali earned a science (c) _____ before becoming a renowned ornithologist. At the (d) _____ of winter, migratory birds arrive in large numbers.

(degree, entrance)

(iv). Salim Ali decided to (a) _____ the audience on the need for conservation. The colourful (b) _____ of peacock feathers amazed the visitors. He carefully noted the nesting (c) _____ of birds in his diary. Rare species were kept on public (d) _____ in the sanctuary.

(address, display)

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(v). Salim Ali made a (a) _____ discovery during his Himalayan expedition. A tiny (b) _____ ran across the forest floor near the camp. During leisure hours, he enjoyed reading a (c) _____ by lamplight. The observer learned to (d) _____ silently to avoid disturbing birds.

(novel, mouse)

UNIT 5

Beloved Boles

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

(i). When I was a student at _____(a) moscow, I happened to live alongside _____(a) an Polish woman, Teresa by name. She _____(a) are tall and strong, with bushy black eyebrows, _____(a) bark brown hair and a large coarse face. The _____(a) gleem of her dark eyes, her thick bass voice, and _____(a) his muscular vigour, horrified me.

(ii). I should have liked to change _____(a) me quarters; but my little chamber was ____(b) an nice one. There was such a _____(c) vide view from the window, and it was always _____(d) soo quiet in the street below–so I endured. One morning I _____(e) is sprawling on my couch, trying to find _____(f) sum sort of excuse for not attending my class.

(iii). I understood at last. And I felt _____(a) no sick, so miserable, so ashamed, somehow. Alongside ____(b) on me, not three yards away, _____(c) live a human creature _____(d) how had nobody in the world to treat her _____(e) kindingly. With no one to be affectionate to her, this human being had invented a friend for _____(f) himself!

(iv). Well, well, the more _____(a) an human creature has tasted of bitter things, the more ____(b) its hungers after the sweet _____(c) thinks of life. And we, wrapped in _____(d) a rags of our virtues, regard others through the mist of our self-sufficiency. Convinced of our righteousness, we _____(e) does not understand this. And the _____(f) hole thing turns out pretty stupidly–and very cruelly.

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

(i). As a student in Moscow, the narrator _____ (a) live beside Teresa and _____ (b) the top floor opposite her room. Frightened by her appearance, he never _____ his door _____ (c). One morning, when she entered suddenly, he _____ (d), startled, and almost _____ (e) in fear and surprise.

(go on, lived on, happen to, burst out, leave open, sit down)

(ii). Teresa came in timidly and _____ (a) help to write a letter. Though amused, the narrator did not _____ (b) and wrote it seriously. He decided not to _____ (c) that evening and _____ (d) her to finish dictating before politely _____ her _____ (e).

(come across, fool around, go out, ask for, send away, wait for)

(iii). When Teresa returned seeking another letter, the narrator could not _____ (a) her story and harshly accused her. He _____ (b) at her frightened face and waited to see what would _____ (c) the confusion. Later, he _____ it _____ (d) and resolved to _____ (e) to her kindly.

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(think over, come of, make out, go on, come back, look up)

(iv). The narrator _____ (a) enter Teresa's room and _____ (b) as she revealed her lonely secret. Shocked, he did not _____ (c) in anger. After listening to her painful explanation, he _____ it _____ (d) with shame and resolved to _____ (e) with compassion and understanding

(burst out, happen to, turn up, come back, think over, leave open)

(v). The narrator did not _____ (a) in judgment but continued helping Teresa by writing letters. He rarely _____ (b), trying to _____ (c) her pain. Later, he _____ (d) she was imprisoned. In the end, the story _____ (e) sadly, revealing how human loneliness is often misunderstood and cruelly ignored.

(find out, burst out, go out, come out, make out, turn out)

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

(i). I lived on _____(a) top floor and her room was opposite mine. I never left ____(b) door open when I knew her to be at home. Sometimes I chanced _____(c) meet her on the staircase or in _____(d) yard, and she would smile _____(e) me. Occasionally, I saw her drunk, with bleary eyes, _____(f) tousled hair. On such occasions she would speak to me.

(a, to, the, and, the, at, my)

(ii). "Mr Student!" she began, _____(a) suddenly, waving her hand, ____(b) turned abruptly towards the door and went out. I remained with _____(c) very unpleasant feeling in my mind. I listened. Her door was flung open violently and _____(d) slammed shut. I thought it over, and resolved _____(e) go to her. I'd invite her to come back _____(f) here and write everything she wanted.

(on, and, then, she, in, a, to)

(iii). Look, now! you wrote me _____(a) letter to Boles, and I gave it to someone else ____(b) read it to me; and when they read it to me, I listened _____(c) fancied that Boles was there. And I asked you _____(d) write me a letter from Boles to Teresa–that is to me. When they write such _____(e) letter for me, and read it to me, I feel quite sure _____(f) Boles is there. And life grows easier for me.

(and, a, to, an, to, a, that)

(iv). And thenceforth, regularly, twice _____(a) week, I wrote a letter to Boles, and ____(b) answer from Boles to Teresa. She, of course, listened to them, _____(c) wept like anything. She roared, I should say, _____(d) her bass voice. And in return _____(e) my service, she began to mend _____(f) holes I had in my socks, shirts, and other articles of clothing.

(in, a, an, and, with, for, the,)

4. Complete the conversation.

(i). Complete the conversation between the Narrator and Teresa

Narrator: You look very busy today, Teresa.

Teresa: I am trying to think of _____(a)_____.

Narrator: _____(b)_____?

Teresa: I am writing to Boles, my beloved.

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Narrator: You have mentioned him before, _____(c)_____?
Teresa: Yes, he is my only happiness in this cold city.
Narrator: If you tell me your thoughts, _____(d)_____.
Teresa: Please write that I miss him every single hour.
Narrator: I think it would be better _____(e)_____ his return.
Teresa: How deeply I love that man!

(ii). Complete the conversation between the Narrator and Teresa.

Narrator: _____(a)_____?
Teresa: I can, but it feels embarrassing! _____(b)_____!
Narrator: Do you mind if I suggest a change?
Teresa: Go ahead, I trust you.
Narrator: Sorry to interrupt, but you would better _____(c)_____.
Teresa: I know, but I fear the truth.
Narrator: If Boles knew everything, _____(d)_____.
Teresa: Perhaps. I would rather imagine him kind.
Narrator: You care about him deeply, _____(e)_____?
Teresa: Yes, it feels real even if he doesn't exist.

(iii). Complete the conversation between the Narrator and a Neighbour.

Neighbour: _____(a)_____?
Narrator: I have noticed she seems quite lonely.
Neighbour: Do you mind if I _____(b)_____ about her?
Narrator: Please do, I am curious about her situation.
Neighbour: They say Boles does not even exist.
Narrator: Sorry to interrupt, but she shows me _____(c)_____ from him.
Neighbour: Would you rather believe a lonely woman's dreams or the cold truth?
Narrator: I prefer to _____(d)_____.
Neighbour: Why do you waste your time helping her write those fake replies?
Narrator: _____(e)_____!

(iv). Complete the conversation between the Narrator a friend.

Narrator: Could you explain why Teresa writes to Boles?
Friend: She feels lonely. _____(a)_____!
Narrator: Do you mind if I comment on her letters?
Friend: No, please do.
Narrator: Sorry to interrupt, but I think you would better _____(b)_____ .
Friend: Maybe, but it could hurt her.
Narrator: If she finds out too late, _____(c)_____ .
Friend: True. I would rather_____(d)_____ .
Narrator: She writes beautifully, _____(e)_____ ?
Friend: Absolutely, it shows her emotions strongly.

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(v). Complete the conversation between the Narrator and Teresa.

Narrator: Teresa, do you mind if we discuss Boles?
Teresa: No, _____(a)_____. What an idea!
Narrator: Could you tell me why you invent him?
Teresa: _____(b)_____ alone.
Narrator: Sorry to interrupt, but you would better _____(c)_____.
Teresa: I'm afraid, but I guess you are right.
Narrator: If you stop imagining, _____(d)_____.
Teresa: Perhaps, but I would rather feel hope than emptiness.
Narrator: You love him truly, _____(e)_____?
Teresa: Yes, and it is all in my heart.

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) Narrator: Teresa, could you read me the letter?
(b) Teresa: Yes, I can, but it feels embarrassing.

(a) Narrator: Why do you write letters to Boles?
(b) Teresa: Because it comforts me when I am lonely.

(a) Narrator: Who is Boles really?
(b) Teresa: There is no real Boles; I only imagined him.

(a) Narrator: You would better tell the truth someday.
(b) Teresa: I am scared, but I suppose you are right.

(a) Narrator: If Boles were here, what would you say to him?
(b) Teresa: I would tell him everything I feel.

6. Complete the passage with suitable portmanteau words choosing from the brackets.

(i). Teresa spent her mornings writing letters to Boles while listening to a _____ (a) about famous writers, which kept her updated and entertained. Her friend suggested she start a _____ (b) to share her experiences with imaginary friends and letters. After writing for hours, Teresa felt tired; she joked that she was a _____ (c) because she could not stop creating stories. One afternoon, she invited her friend over for a special drink, a refreshing _____ (d), while they discussed literature. To capture her letters and stories, she used a _____ (e) to record them for her own memory and future reading.

(camcorder, infotainment, workaholic, podcast, blog, mocktail)

(ii). Teresa often listened to a writing _____ (a) while composing letters to Boles, which gave her useful tips. One evening, she stayed at a small _____ (b) near the city when she visited a friend's house. Her friends invited her for a late morning _____ (c) after a long walk in the countryside. On the streets, the heavy _____ (d)made it difficult for her to see her way clearly. Her teacher recommended attending a _____ (e) about creative writing to improve her skills from home.

(webinar, podcast, brunch, smog, blog, motel)

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(iii). While staying at home, Teresa recorded her thoughts on Boles using a _____ (a). She watched a new _____ (b) program on literature, which gave her both information and enjoyment. She joked that she was a _____ (c), spending all her time writing letters. To reach more people, she decided to create a _____ (d) about her imaginary adventures. Sometimes she listened to a storytelling _____ (e) that inspired her letters.

(smog, camcorder, infotainment, workaholic, podcast, blog)

(iv). Teresa served a special _____ (a) to her visiting friend while discussing Boles. During her journey, she stayed at a quiet _____ (b) near the station. She enjoyed a relaxed _____ (c) on Sunday after finishing her letters. The thick _____ (d) in the city made her cough as she walked to the café. Her teacher suggested attending a _____ (e) to learn new techniques in writing online.

(podcast, mocktail, motel, brunch, smog, webinar)

(v). Teresa used a _____ (a) to record her imaginary letters for future reference. She enjoyed listening to a storytelling _____ (b) in the evening. Her friends said she was a real _____ (c) because she spent hours writing every day. She decided to start a _____ (d) to share her experiences and thoughts about life. One afternoon, she made a refreshing _____ (e) to celebrate finishing her letters.

(blog, camcorder, workaholic, podcast, mocktail, motel)

Préférence Nationale

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

(i). If you're married _____(a) on a French citizen, ____(b) it will now take two years for you to claim _____(c) an benefits of citizenship. By this delay, Mr Borders _____(d) are relying on the nature of his countrymen to break up the _____(e) relationship. Then, as the ex-wife of a Frenchman, the foreign woman becomes no more than an ex-object. And as with any object, she has no _____ (f) right, not even the right to earn an honest living.

(ii). My French friends _____(a) has no awareness of ____(b) why life here was like for me. The next morning I went to _____(c) an bakery. Apart from the _____(d) chokolate cakes, everything was _____(e) whiten. The boss welcomed me with a German moustache, an _____(f) alsace accent and a hat in the colours of the French flag.

(iii). Still without work, three days later, I started _____(a) look through the free paper again. A new ad caught ____(b) I eye: Tutor required for _____(c) french lessons. Degree essential. Call _____(d) on 7 p.m. I took down the number, but this time didn't mention _____(e) at to my friend. She would have asked me how it had gone at the bakery and wouldn't have _____(f) belieaved what I told her.

(iv). Madame is French, true, but hasn’t even passed _____(a) she degree and seems to ____(b) thing she could not tutor her daughter _____(c) himself. She is refusing me work on account of my black lips _____(d) when can drone _____(e) a niceties of French grammar better than hers. Pouring

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_____(f) mocktale on top of my rage, I stand up and leave her with this parting shot: “Goodbye, madame.

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

(i). The new citizenship law forces foreign spouses to _____ (a) acceptance while officials _____ (b) time to _____(c) marriages. The narrator _____ (d) this injustice in daily life and _____ (e) its quiet cruelty. Ordinary people enforce the policy, proving that discrimination grows strong through small, unnoticed actions.

(go through, come across, look for, write down, rely on, break up)

(ii). While _____ (a) free papers for work, the narrator _____ (b) a bakery address. Her friend was _____ (c) teacher training, but she had to survive. At the bakery, she _____ (d) silent rejection and _____ (e) that prejudice mattered more than qualifications in securing employment.

(find out, look through, finish up, go through, break up, take down)

(iii). The narrator _____ (a) a tutoring advertisement and _____ (b) the number carefully. She _____ (c) after seven and met the employer in a café. When rejected unfairly, she _____ (d) with dignity and left, refusing to _____ (e) to humiliation despite needing the work.

(write down, come across, stand up, put up with, ring up, come back)

(iv). After _____ (a) for her self-respect, Fatou Diome refuses to _____ (b) excuses for discrimination. Though such bias can _____ (c) lives, she helps a friend who is _____ (d) her studies. The friend _____ (e) the employer and easily gets the job, revealing unfair prejudice.

(put up, ring up, stand up, break up, finish up, make up, ring up)

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

(i). They won't give me citizenship, _____(a) my Senegalese cat has his papers. Perhaps it's because he's ginger. Laws ____(b) gather pace when ordinary people start applying them. Termites can cause _____(c) collapse of African mahogany trees, and _____(d) size of an anthill depends on the number of worker ants. It is thus _____(e) small employers who make the policy _____(f)preference nationale effective.

(the, but, the, only, of, the)

(ii). You have impoverished our African soil _____(a) making us grow sugarcane ____(b)peanuts for your people. You've plundered our resources _____(c) enrich your country at our expense. And,

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to top it _____(d) off, you've used my people as cannon fodder in your war. _____(e) war in which you made them kill in the name of _____(f) freedom you refuse them in their own African soil.

(a, by, all, a, to, and, a)

(iii). At 7.10 p.m. I rang _____(a) number. A woman answered. She told me she was ____(b) cashier at one of the big Strasbourg supermarkets. She was looking _____(c) someone to tutor her eleven-year-old daughter. She suggested meeting _____(d) following afternoon, in a city-centre café. When I arrived at the cafe it was packed, _____(e) Madame had told me she would _____(f) wearing 'a white jersey with blue stripes'. I spotted her immediately.

(an, the, a, for, the,but, be)

(iv). She sat _____(a) muttering. She was scarlet. Inside, I thanked God ____(b) not afflicting me with that particular mark of embarrassment or anger. My skin, _____(c) least, always keeps its dignity. Good riddance, madame! That evening I called _____(d) friend from college, a real white girl. She was looking _____(e) some part-time work while she did her degree. I gave her _____(f) cashier's number.

(for, there, for, a, at, the, and)

4. Complete the conversation.

(i). Complete the conversation between the narrator and a friend.

Narrator: Hello! _____(a)_____ ?
Friend: Sure! What kind of work are you looking for?
Narrator: Something in a bakery or café.
Friend: I saw an ad yesterday. _____(a)_____ tomorrow?
Narrator: Yes, I can do that. _____(a)_____ .
Friend: You should take your CV with you.
Narrator: I will. _____(a)_____?
Friend: Not really. You can walk there.
Narrator: I hope the boss is kind.
Friend: Don't worry. _____(a)_____!

(ii). Complete the conversation between the Narrator and a French Employer

Employer: We have many applicants today. _____(a)_____?
Narrator: I have the necessary qualifications and a strong work ethic, sir.
Employer: _____(a)_____ for verification?
Narrator: Certainly, here they are.
Employer: I see. However, your background is quite different from our usual staff.
Narrator: Diversity brings new perspectives to a team, _____(a)_____?
Employer: Perhaps, but our clients prefer familiarity.
Narrator: If I am given a chance, _____(a)_____.

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Employer: I'm not sure. I think it would be better _____(a)_____ fits in more easily.
Narrator: How narrow-minded this world can be!

(iii). Complete the conversation between the narrator and Madame Dupont.

Narrator: Excuse me,_____(a)_____ Madame Dupont?
Mother: Yes, I am she.
Narrator: Sorry to interrupt, but I wanted to confirm the time.
Mother: That's fine. _____(a)_____.
Narrator: Thank you. If I finish tutoring early, _____(a)_____?
Mother: Yes, but only after _____(a)_____.
Narrator: Alright. I will be careful.
Mother: Good. The child is a little strict.
Narrator: I understand. If she misbehaves, _____(a)_____.
Mother: That's good. I like your attitude.

(iv). Complete the conversation between the Narrator and a Local Official

Official: Next in line! State your business quickly.
Narrator: I am here to inquire about _____(a)_____.
Official: The rules have become stricter recently.
Narrator: Could you explain _____(a)_____?
Official: It's all in the handbook. You've read it, _____(a)_____?
Narrator: I have, but the language is quite complex.
Official: If you don't understand the law, _____(a)_____.
Narrator: I understand the law, but I find the "preference" system unfair.
Official: I am just a clerk; _____(a)_____.
Narrator: How frustrating this bureaucracy is!

(v). Complete the conversation between the Narrator and College Friend

Narrator: I had another rejection today.
Friend: _____(a)_____?
Narrator: Do you mind if I speak honestly?
Friend: Discrimination still exists, _____(a)_____?
Narrator: Sorry to interrupt, but I'm tired of _____(a)_____.
Friend: Why don't you complain officially?
Narrator: If laws protected everyone, _____(a)_____.
Friend: It would better to expose such injustice.
Narrator: I would rather _____(a)_____.
Friend: What courage you have!

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) Student: Could you help me find a job in the bakery?
(b) Friend: Yes, I'll give you a tip about one nearby.

(a) Employer: You should speak a little Alsatian, shouldn't you?
(b) Student: I'm sorry, I only know my dialect.

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(a) Student: I would rather sell bread than starve.
(b) Friend: At least you will survive while looking for something better.

(a) Friend: Do you mind if I give you a tip about a part-time job?
(b) Student: Not at all, please tell me.

(a) Employer: Go back to your jungle!
(b) Student: I won't, I will leave politely.

6. Complete the passage with suitable coordinating conjunctions choosing from the brackets.

(i). The narrator was well educated, (a) _____ she was denied citizenship benefits. She wanted to earn an honest living, (b) _____ she searched for jobs patiently. She visited the bakery (c) _____ spoke to the employer confidently. She continued her struggle bravely, (d) _____ survival in a foreign land was difficult.

(for, and, but, so)

(ii). The narrator was qualified, (a) _____ she was treated unfairly. She was neither lazy (b) _____ unwilling to work. Her friends offered advice, (c) _____ they failed to understand her reality. She faced discrimination daily, (d) _____ she never lost her dignity.

(nor, but, and, yet)

(iii). The law appeared neutral, (a) _____ it worked against immigrants. She could accept any job, (b) _____ she was repeatedly rejected. She carried her certificates carefully, (c) _____ she hoped for fair treatment. She needed employment urgently, (d) _____ survival was difficult without income.

(for, or, and, yet)

(iv). The tutor's mother examined the degree, (a) _____ she returned it coldly. The narrator felt humiliated, (b) _____ she stood up for herself. She spoke firmly (c) _____ walked away with confidence. She neither argued (d) _____ begged for sympathy.

(but, so, and, nor)

(v). The narrator remained calm, (a) _____ she was deeply hurt by rejection. She respected herself, (b) _____ dignity mattered more than money. She left the café quietly (c) _____ refused to insult herself further. She could stay silent (d) _____ speak the truth boldly.

(yet, for, and, or)

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Key_Language Elements_SSLC 2026

UNIT 1

A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

(i). (a) the (b) in (c) trying (d) his (e) to (f) mothballs
(ii). (a) had (b) they (c) two-storey (d) so that (e) the (f) get in
(iii). (a) the (b) of (c) chicken (d) there (e) seemed (f) at

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

i. (a) took away (b) looked at (c) got up (d) coming back (e) called in
ii. (a) knocked down (b) watched over (c) locked up (d) going to bed (e) dragged out
iii. (a) woke up (b) took away (c) locked up (d) went out (e) put on

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

i. (a) the (b) at (c) the (d) for (e) in (f) the
ii. (a) the (b) a (c) in (d) over (e) to (f) with
iii. (a) of (b) a (c) the (d) to (e) the (f) for

4. Complete the conversation.

i
(a) aren't we
(b) What shall we do with all this money
(c) save money for the future
(d) we will earn more money
(e) stay alert
ii
(a) isn't he
(b) treat him with more respect
(c) nor strong
(d) miracles may happen
(e) do you really think he can cure the sick

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) The neighbour woman said that he was an angel.
(b) Elisenda replied that the poor fellow was so old that the rain had knocked him down.

(a) Elisenda asked Pelayo where he had found the old man.
(b) Pelayo replied that the man had been lying face down in the mud at the rear of their courtyard.

(a) The neighbour woman suggested that they should try to make the old man eat some mothballs.
(b) Pelayo replied that he ate nothing but eggplant mush.

(a) Elisenda said that both the old man and the child had come down with chicken pox at the same time.
(b) The doctor said that he had found so much whistling from his heart and so many sounds in the kidneys.

6. Complete the passage with suitable idioms choosing from the brackets.

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i. (a) hold his tongue (b) spilled the beans

ii. (a) a piece of cake (b) the icing on the cake

iii. (a) hold one's tongue (b) the icing on the cake

In the Attic

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

i. (a) fingers (b) for (c) were (d) had (e) played (f) the
ii. (a) the (b) something (c) of (d) entrance (e) this (f) eat
iii. (a) monotonous (b) and (c) were (d) a (e) went (f) to
iv. (a) in (b) then (c) the (d) and (e) lay (f) squeaking

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

i. (a) go into (b) bringing up (c) try out (d) hang on (e) take out
ii. (a) fetch down (b) venture out (c) put on (d) put out (e) look out
iii. (a) looked out (b) took to (c) rushed up (d) came down (e) go on out

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

i. (a) an (b) of (c) the (d) for (e) the (f) of
ii. (a) about (b) an (c) to (d) the (e) for (f) of
iii. (a) in (b) over (c) the (d) a (e) a (f) of
iv. (a) the (b) around (c) the (d) the (e) of (f) the

4. Complete the conversation.

(i)
(a) haven't you
(b) nor free for years
(c) I would not have survived
(d) regain your strength now and start again
(e) How did music keep you alive during such times
(ii)
(a) aren't you
(b) Then why are you wearing a German overcoat
(c) neither a German
(d) we would have shot you
(e) You should report to headquarters now
(iii)
(a) are you
(b) Then why are you wearing that uniform
(c) nor an enemy
(d) If people see you like this
(e) help a fellow Pole

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) The German captain asked whether anyone was there.
(b) Szpilman replied that he was there and that he was hiding in the attic.

(a) The Polish lieutenant asked Szpilman what he was doing in the German coat.
(b) Szpilman replied that he had put it on to keep himself from freezing.

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(a) Szpilman asked how he would survive the war hiding there.
(b) The captain replied that he had brought him a larger supply of bread and a warm eiderdown.

6. Complete the passage with suitable options choosing from the brackets.

i. (a) urgent (b) anxiously (c) entirely (d) peacefully
ii. (a) must (b) shouldn't (c) can (d) must
iii. (a) closely (b) enquiring (c) obviously (d) reassuringly
iv. (a) must (b) can (c) needn't (d) will

UNIT 2

Breaking Barriers, I will Fly

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

i. (a) saw (b) be (c) showered (d) were (e) the (f) myself
ii. (a) there (b) to (c) competitive (d) didn't (e) the (f) Berkeley
iii. (a) a (b) nurture (c) than (d) have (e) students (f) much
iv. (a) leave (b) compassion (c) doesn't (d) the (e) people's (f) of

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

i. (a) sat on (b) sent to (c) fit into (d) take up (e) sit for
ii. (a) led back (b) giving up (c) look at (d) work in (e) look back

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

i. (a) the (b) in (c) a (d) a (e) in (f) an
ii. (a) a (b) with (c) to (d) the (e) into (f) to
iii. (a) the (b) a (c) on (d) the (e) on (f) of
iv. (a) of (b) a (c) to (d) the (e) on (f) of

4. Complete the conversation.

(i)
(a) isn't he
(b) he would follow the usual path
(c) we must find a special school
(d) asking the neighbors to support him too
(e) he will grow confident
(ii)
(a) aren't you
(b) What made you believe in me when others doubted me
(c) recording my lessons on audio tapes
(d) guide me if I make mistakes
(e) you will succeed
(iii)
(a) don't you
(b) the youth of India have the power to change the nation
(c) allowing me to be part of this project
(d) how to motivate students from rural areas
(e) I would still dedicate my life to serving the nation

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5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) Srikanth asked the teacher whether she would help him when he made mistakes.
(b) The teacher replied that she certainly would and added that if he continued to work hard, he would achieve success**.**

(a) Srikanth told his father that his short legs made it difficult for him to help him on the farm.
(b) His father replied that Srikanth did not fit into the traditional farming model and added that he had to study.

(a) Srikanth questioned why blind children should be made to sit on the last bench.
(b) His friend replied that he had to build a strong support system for the disabled.

6. Complete the passage with suitable choosing from the brackets.

i. (a) although (b) because (c) since (d) as
ii. (a) because (b) though (c) until (d) unless

A Phoenix Rises

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

i. (a) been (b) the (c) supervision (d) leaving (e) to (f) get
ii. (a) on (b) to (c) wrapped (d) an (e) startled (f) forty
iii. (a) a (b) had (c) to (d) the (e) procured (f) to
iv. (a) and (b) in (c) the (d) by (e) women's (f) whole

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

i. (a) dropped out (b) help out (c) took over (d) sauntered out (e) came to know
ii. (a) go back (b) pulled out (c) spread out (d) put back (e) handed over
iii. (a) pulled out (b) spread out (c) make out (d) run around (e) give up
iv. (a) dropped out (b) help out (c) pulled out (d) spread out (e) make out

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

i. (a) a (b) for (c) to (d) a (e) the (f) the
ii. (a) for (b) the (c) towards (d) the (e) a (f) in
iii. (a) the (b) the (c) a (d) on (e) to (f) the
iv. (a) a (b) from (c) the (d) between (e) to (f) a

4. Complete the conversation.

(i)
(a) Why are you spending all your time on this machine
(b) aren't they
(c) telling me how this project will help poor women
(d) promise that this work will not destroy our family life
(e) I love you
(ii)
(a) poor women cannot afford sanitary pads
(b) aren't they
(c) they will be able to use affordable sanitary pads
(d) I would never help these women
(e) your mission succeeds

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(iii)
(a) hasn't he
(b) he started this "pad" project
(c) I might have to leave and go to my mother's house
(d) telling him how much this is hurting our reputation
(e) throw it away before anyone else sees it
(iv)
(a) don't you
(b) I have to close the shop for lunch
(c) it is a sensitive item
(d) Why is this small bundle of cotton so expensive
(e) go and study this material to see

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) Bablu asked Gowri why she was leaving him alone.
(b) Gowri replied that she would return only when he gave up his madness.

(a) Bablu asked why women were forced to use dirty rags.
(b) The doctor replied that it was because sanitary pads were too expensive for them.

(a) Gowri told Bablu that people were laughing at his strange obsession.
(b) Bablu replied that he did not care what society said.

(a) Bablu said that he would not stop the project.
(b) His mother advised him that he should think about the family's honour.

(a) The villager said that the work was shameful.
(b) Bablu replied that it was meant to help poor women.

(a) The teacher asked Bablu whether he believed in the success of his project.
(b) Bablu replied that it would change many lives.

6. Complete the passage with suitable choosing from the brackets.

i. (a) will get (b) understood (c) were (d) will lead
ii. (a) would respect (b) would abandon (c) understood (d) are
iii. (a) was (b) will avoid (c) accepted (d) will see
iv. (a) would become (b) trusted (c) will learn (d) will regain
v. (a) shows (b) would support (c) uses (d) gain

UNIT 3
War

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

i. (a) stuffy (b) in (c) had (d) a (e) followed (f) His
ii. (a) their (b) of (c) to (d) Sulmona (e) a (f) months
iii. (a) excessive (b) than (c) children (d) is (e) in (f) the
iv. (a) to (b) us (c) reach (d) were (e) the (f) stronger

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

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i. (a) hoisted in (b) broken up (c) turned round (d) pulled up (e) taking away
ii. (a) come back (b) sent back (c) see off (d) belong to (e) showed off
iii. (a) belong to (b) join in (c) show off (d) turned to (e) broke into
iv. (a) taken away (b) see off (c) broken up (d) broke down (e) coming back

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

i. (a) a (b) the (c) for (d) to (e) of (f) the
ii. (a) at (b) a (c) a (d) of (e) were (f) at
iii. (a) a (b) to (c) are (d) if (e) they (f) should
iv. (a) a (b) the (c) to (d) to (e) a (f) of

4. Complete the conversation.

(i)
(a) had been serving
(b) don't you
(c) Either my son lives
(d) war would end sooner
(e) grief cannot be hidden
(ii)
(a) observing everyone's reactions
(b) isn't it
(c) nor despair changes reality
(d) speak softly
(e) with your calm attitude
(iii)
(a) I received the telegram
(b) don't you
(c) Either we survive this pain
(d) they would oppose it
(e) rest for a while
(iv)
(a) hoping for a miracle
(b) doesn't it
(c) nor defeat
(d) If war continues
(e) speak the truth

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) The father said that their son had been brave till the end.
(b) The mother agreed but added that no parent should lose a child to war.

(a) The traveller said that he had received a letter from his son the previous day.
(b) The father replied that his son had been missing for three months.

(a) The father asked the mother why she was trembling like that.
(b) The mother told him to control himself and exclaimed that it was a terrible war.

(a) The father said that he had sent his son to fight for the country.
(b) The traveller replied that every parent there had made the same sacrifice.

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(a) The traveller asked whether their children would return alive from the war.
(b) The father advised him not to lose hope and exclaimed that it was a tragic time they were living in.

6. Complete the passage with suitable choosing from the brackets.

i. (a) address (b) fair (c) address (d) fair
ii. (a) well (b) right (c) well (d) right
iii. (a) current (b) current (c) watch (d) watch
iv. (a) close (b) express (c) close (d) express
v. (a) bear (b) bear (c) kind (d) kind

A Piece of String

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

i. (a) the (b) and (c) to (d) it (e) or (f) leafy
ii. (a) was (b) an (c) from (d) mouth (e) passed (f) peasants
iii. (a) to (b) Goderville (c) present (d) this (e) and (f) containing
iv. (a) to (b) the (c) his (d) pass (e) at (f) he

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

i. (a) picked up (b) roll up (c) look for (d) ran to (e) called out
ii. (a) go away (b) set out (c) drew out (d) fall out (e) take away
iii. (a) spread through (b) get out (c) went along (d) turned out (e) pass by
iv. (a) came out (b) shut up (c) mixed up (d) took to (e) kept on
v. (a) came out (b)set out (c) called out (d) turned out (e) get out

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

i. (a) at (b) the (c) a (d) on (e) to (f) from
ii. (a) the (b) outside (c) to (d) the (e) after (f) a
iii. (a) the (b) of (c) to (d) in (e) on (f) by
iv. (a) with (b) to (c) by (d) of (e) to (f) the

4. Complete the conversation.

(i)
(a) didn't I
(b) Why were you bending down near the ground
(c) whispering about the purse
(d) nor money
(e) explain everything clearly
(ii)
(a) didn't you
(b) telling the same truth to everyone
(c) either the string
(d) If you had spoken earlier
(e) I apologise, Sir
(iii)
(a) aren't you
(b) Why do you always suspect me
(c) I stole neither purse
(d) stop spreading lies

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(e) but I must defend myself
(iv)
(a) don't they
(b) What harm did I do by picking up a string
(c) to clear my name
(d) nor purse
(e) keep proving my honesty
(v)
(a) don't you
(b) repeating the same story
(c) or misunderstanding
(d) you would be at peace now
(e) die than live with false blame

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) Hauchecorne asserted that he had only picked up a piece of string from the ground.
(b) The villager informed him that people believed he had stolen the purse.

(a) The Mayor questioned Hauchecorne why he had bent down in the marketplace.
(b) Hauchecorne explained that he was only picking up a piece of string.

(a) Malandain claimed that he had seen Hauchecorne take something from the ground.
(b) Hauchecorne denied that, calling Malandain a liar and insisted he had taken nothing but a string.

(a) A neighbour asked Hauchecorne why he had been repeating the same story everywhere.
(b) Hauchecorne replied that he had been trying to clear his name.

(a) Hauchecorne cried that it was a cruel world.
(b) The doctor advised him that he must control his emotions.

6. Complete the passage with suitable choosing from the brackets.

i. (a) neither (b) nor (c) neither (d) nor
ii. (a) either (b) or (c) neither (d) nor
iii. (a) either (b) or (c) neither (d) nor
iv. (a) either (b) or (c) either (d) or
v. (a) neither (b) nor (c) either (d) or

UNIT 4
Shākuntalam

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

i. (a) the (b) his (c) my (d) fears (e) with (f) does
ii. (a) think (b) walks (c) with (d) in (e) the (f) for
iii. (a) a (b) The (c) in (d) shows (e) ripening (f) own
iv. (a) on (b) the (c) hermitage (d) our (e) to (f) gone

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

i. (a) hold back (b) draw near (c) go on (d) run away (e) draw back
ii. (a) run up (b) call upon (c) drive on (d) wait for (e) care for

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iii. (a) drive on (b) wait for (c) care for (d) call upon (e) run up
iv. (a) draw near (b) draw back (c) wait for (d) cling to (e) drop from
v. (a) cling to (b) care for (c) go on (d) drive on (e) wait for

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

i. (a) to (b) the (c) the (d) to (e) to (f) the
ii. (a) the (b) a (c) on (d) will (e) to (f) to
iii. (a) to (b) the (c) for (d) a (e) in (f) a
iv. (a) the (b) in (c) a (d) a (e) a (f) the

4. Complete the conversation.

(i)
(a) hasn't it
(b) will you increase the speed
(c) driving faster as we reach the plain
(d) Where is the deer now
(e) not let it escape into the thicket
(ii)
(a) doesn't it
(b) restore your arrow to the quiver
(c) If you protect the innocent
(d) Why is this deer so sacred to you
(e) not hunt in these sacred precincts again
(iii)
(a) isn't it
(b) We arrive at the gates now
(c) leave your bow and ornaments with me
(d) Would you mind holding these for a moment
(e) not go too deep into the forest alone
(iv)
(a) doesn't he
(b) as I love them
(c) filling the trenches about the trees
(d) What makes this creeper so special to you
(e) forget the mango tree
(v)
(a) aren't you
(b) watch out
(c) you should call for help
(d) Who will save me from this dreadful bee
(e) be so annoyed with a little bee

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) The Charioteer told the King that he had been holding the horses back as the ground had been rough.
(b) The King replied that they were then on level ground and he would easily overtake the deer.

(a) The Hermit informed the King that the deer belonged to the hermitage and must not be killed.
(b) The King responded that he would stop the chariot immediately.

(a) Anasuya asked Shakuntala why she was watering the spring creeper so lovingly.
(b) Shakuntala replied that the creeper was her sister and she wanted to give her water.

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(a) Shakuntala cried out to her friends to save her from that dreadful bee.
(b) Priyamvada suggested that she should call upon King Dushyanta because he was the protector of the grove.

(a) The King questioned why he should wear those jewels while entering the hermitage.
(b) The Charioteer agreed with the King and remarked that one must be modest in a sacred place.

6. Complete the passage with suitable choosing from the brackets.

(a) Pulmonologist (b) Dermatologist (c) Cardiologist (d) Pharmacist
(a) Botanist (b) Ornithologist (c) Geologist (d) Biologist
(a) Journalist (b) Cartoonist (c) Pianist (d) Artist
(a) Astronomist (b) Anthropologist (c) Economist (d) Psychologist
(a) Tourist (b) Chemist (c) Dentist (d) Journalist

Trills and Thrills: Birdwatching in India

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

i. *(a) to (b) adventures (c) my (d) though (e) is (f) lacking*
ii. *(a) of (b) occupation (c) India (d) found (e) come (f) parts*
iii. *(a) anthropologist (b) to (c) me (d) trail (e) high (f) Warbler*
iv. *(a) of (b) a (c) I (d) unmindful (e) the (f) down*

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

i. (a) grew up (b) came upon (c) put up with (d) take away (e) make for
ii. (a) get up (b) came across (c) looked back (d) rolled down (e) put on
iii. (a) grown up (b) give up (c) made way (d) look back (e) come up
iv. (a) came upon (b) went on (c) rolled down (d) called off (e) carry on

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

i. *(a) on (b) the (c) a (d) to (e) up (f) the*
ii. *(a) the (b) in (c) for (d) and (e) the (f) was*
iii. *(a) the (b) in (c) a (d) the (e) to (f) behind*
iv. *(a) a (b) the (c) to (d) in (e) of (f) down*

4. Complete the conversation.

(i)
(a) What are you looking for near the bushes
(b) haven't you
(c) we may spot more birds
(d) move slowly and avoid sudden sounds
(e) they depend on alertness for survival
(ii)
(a) haven't you
(b) I had been patrolling this area
(c) If weather conditions worsen
(d) complete your notes before dusk
(e) report suspicious movements
(iii)
(a) what are you writing in that notebook
(b) haven't you

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(c) grazing cattle near the pond
(d) learn this skill from you.
(e) Why do you like birds
(iv)
(a) migratory birds along this route
(b) haven't you
(c) I had been observing birds
(d) publish these findings soon
(e) How long have you been in this field
(v)
(a) What makes birdwatching so exciting
(b) haven't you
(c) they will protect nature
(d) carry binoculars next time
(e) Yeah, curiosity is the first step to conservation

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) *Ali asked Baron Omar what he was observing through the binoculars.*
(b) *Baron Omar replied that he was watching a rare bird near the water body.*

(a) *The companion asked Salim Ali how long he had been travelling for birdwatching.*
(b) *Salim Ali said that he had been exploring different regions of India for many years.*

(a) *The forest guard warned them not to make any noise there.*
(b) *Salim Ali assured him that he would remain silent while observing the birds.*

(a) *He then exclaimed that the bird had a beautiful call.*
(b) *The young boy agreed and said that it sounded very musical.*

(a) *The guard asked if they should move closer to the nest.*
(b) *Salim Ali replied that they must keep a safe distance to avoid disturbing the birds.*

6. Complete the passage with suitable choosing from the brackets.

(i). (a) right (b) leaves (c) right (d) leaves
(ii). (a) kind (b) capital (c) kind (d) capital
(iii). degree (b) entrance (c) degree (d) entrance
(iv). (a) address (b) display (c) address (d) display
(v). (a) novel (b) mouse (c) novel (d) mouse

UNIT 5

Beloved Boles

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

i. (a) Moscow (b) a (c) was (d) dark (e) gleam (f) her
ii. (a) my (b) a (c) wide (d) so (e) was (f) some
iii. (a) so (b) of (c) lived (d) who (e) kindly (f) herself
iv. (a) a (b) it (c) things (d) the (e) do (f) whole

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

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i. *(a) happened to (b) lived on (c) left open (d) sat down (e) burst out*
ii. *(a) ask for (b) fool around (c) go out (d) wait for (e) send away*
iii. *(a) make out (b) look up (c) come of (d) think over (e) come back*
iv. *(a) happen to (b) leave open (c) burst out (d)think over (e) come back*
v. *(a) burst out (b) go out (c) make out (d) find out (e) turn out*

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

i. *(a) the (b) my (c) to (d) the (e) at (f) and*
ii. *(a) and (b) she (c) a (d) then (e) to (f) in*
iii. *(a) a (b) to (c) and (d) to (e) a (f) that*
iv. *(a) a (b) an (c) and (d) with (e) for (f) the*

4. Complete the conversation.

(i)
(a) what to say in a letter
(b) Could you tell me who you are writing to
(c) haven't you
(d) I will write them down clearly
(e) to describe how you are waiting for
(ii)
(a) Could you read this letter to me first
(b) What a long letter
(c) be honest someday
(d) he might forgive you
(e) don't you
(iii)
(a) Have you noticed how Teresa talks to herself lately
(b) tell you what the others are saying
(c) the letters she receives
(d) believe in whatever gives her comfort
(e) What a tragic life she leads
(iv)
(a) What a sad story
(b) tell her the truth
(c) she will be disappointed
(d) help her slowly understand
(e) doesn't she
(v)
(a) let's talk
(b) It comforts me when I am
(c) know reality soon
(d) it might feel lonely at first
(e) don't you

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) The narrator asked Teresa if she could read him the letter.
(b) Teresa replied that she could, but added that it felt embarrassing.

(a) The narrator asked her why she wrote letters to Boles.
(b) Teresa answered that she did so because it comforted her when she was lonely.

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(a) The narrator then asked who Boles really was.
(b) Teresa confessed that there was no real Boles and that she had only imagined him.

(a) The narrator advised that she had better tell the truth someday.
(b) Teresa admitted that she was scared but said that she supposed he was right.

(a) Finally, the narrator asked what she would say to Boles if he were there.
(b) Teresa replied that she would tell him everything she felt.

6. Complete the passage with suitable choosing from the brackets.

i. (a) infotainment (b) blog (c) workaholic (d) mocktail (e) camcorder
ii. (a) podcast (b) motel (c) brunch (d) smog (e) webinar
iii. (a) camcorder (b) infotainment (c) workaholic (d) blog (e) podcast
iv. (a) mocktail (b) motel (c) brunch (d) smog (e) webinar
v. (a) camcorder (b) podcast (c) workaholic (d) blog (e) mocktail

Préférence Nationale

1. Edit the passage. Errors are underlined.

i. (a) to (b) it (c) the (d) is (e) relationship (f) rights
ii. (a) had (b) what (c) the (d) chocolate (e) white (f) Alsace
iii. (a) looking (b) my (c) French (d) after (e) it (f) believed
iv. (a) her (b) think (c) herself (d) which (e) the (f) mocktail

2. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

i. (a) look for (b) rely on (c) break up (d) comes across (e) writes down
ii. (a) looking through (b) took down (c) finishing up (d) went through (e) found out
iii. (a) came across (b) wrote down (c) rang up (d) stood up (e) come back
iv. *(a)* standing up *(b)* make up *(c)* break up *(d)* finishing up *(e)* rings up

3. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets.

i. (a) but (b) only (c) the (d) the (e) the (f) of
ii. (a) by (b) and (c)to (d) all (e) a (f) a
iii. (a) the (b) a (c) for (d) the (e) but (f) be
iv. (a) there (b) for (c) at (d) a (e) for (f) the

4. Complete the conversation.

(i)
(a) Could you help me find a part-time job
(b) Could you go to the shop
(c) Thank you
(d) Is it far from here
(e) I'm sure you will do well
(ii)
(a) Why should I hire you
(b) Could you provide your residency papers
(c) doesn't it
(d) I will prove my capability
(e) to look for someone who

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(iii)
(a) is this where I should meet
(b) Please sit down
(c) can I leave
(d) reviewing your work
(e) I will be patient
(iv)
(a) the renewal of my work permit
(b) which specific laws have changed
(c) haven't you
(d) you will face many hurdles
(e) I don't make the rules
(v)
(a) Could you tell me what happened
(b) doesn't it
(c) explaining myself
(d) I wouldn't suffer like this
(e) keep my dignity intact

5. Report the following dialogue.

(a) The student asked her friend if she could help her find a job in the bakery.
(b) The friend replied that she would give her a tip about one nearby.

(a) The employer remarked that she should speak a little Alsatian.
(b) The student apologised and said that she knew only her own dialect.

(a) She added that she would rather sell bread than starve.
(b) The friend said that at least she would survive while looking for something better.

(a) Later, the friend asked if she minded giving her a tip about a part-time job.
(b) The student replied that she did not mind and asked her to tell her.

(a) The employer rudely told her to go back to her jungle.
(b) The student said that she would not do so and that she would leave politely.

6. Complete the passage with suitable choosing from the brackets.

(i). (a) but (b) so (c) and (d) for
(ii). (a) but (b) nor (c) and (d) yet
(iii). (a) yet (b) or (c) and (d) for
(iv). (a) but (b) so (c) and (d) nor
(v). (a) yet (b) for (c) and (d) or

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Model Question Paper 1 (Prepared by SCERT)

ENGLISH

Time : 2½ hrs

Std : X **Total Score: 80**

INSTRUCTIONS:

- ♦ 15 minutes is given as cool off time.
- ♦ This time is to be used for reading the question paper.
- ♦ You are not supposed to write anything during the cool off time.
- ♦ Attempt the questions according to the instructions.

Questions 1 – 5: Read the excerpt taken from *Trills and Thrills: Birdwatching in India* and answer the questions that follow. (5x1=5)

We reached Parambikulam just as it was getting dark. In the verandah of the forest bungalow, I found a large group of Kadar adivasis, and in their midst, a bare-footed 'topless' European male in crumpled khaki shorts.

We soon introduced ourselves. He was an Austrian anthropologist, Baron Omar Rolf. He claimed ornithology to be his second love and expressed great keenness on accompanying me the next morning. Led by a forest guard, we were stalking along a narrow animal trail through dense tall grassland above five feet high – the right kind of habitat for the Broad-tailed Grass Warbler.

Upon turning a bend in the path, the forest guard suddenly ducked, excitedly pointing in front. I just glimpsed the head of a tusker striding down the same path from the opposite direction, and turned to flee as fast as I could, motioning to Omar, who was ten yards behind me, to do likewise.

1.Who did Dr. Salim Ali meet in the forest bungalow?

2.What did the narrator do when he saw the tusker?

3.What does the narrator's and Omar's reaction to the tusker suggest about the wild?

A. The beauty of untouched wild

B. The unpredictability and danger of the wild

C. The need for exploration in the wild

D. The bond between humans and animals in the wild

4.What does the description of Baron "a bare-footed 'topless' European male in crumpled khaki shorts" tell us about his personality?

5.What does the term 'anthropologist' mean?

A. A person who studies plants and trees

B. A person who studies human societies and cultures

C. A person who protects wildlife

D. A photographer who travels to different countries

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Questions 6 – 9: Read the lines from the dramatic speech *Friends, Romans, Countrymen...* and answer the questions that follow. (4x1=4)

He was my friend, faithful and just to me:
But Brutus says he was ambitious;
And Brutus is an honourable man.
He hath brought many captives home to Rome,
Whose ransoms did the general coffers fill:
Did this in Caesar seem ambitious?
When that the poor have cried, Caesar hath wept:
Ambition should be made of sterner stuff:
Yet Brutus says he was ambitious;
And Brutus is an honourable man.

6. What claim does Brutus make about Caesar in the lines given above?

7. Which of the following best describes Mark Antony's tone of speech in the line "And Brutus is an honourable man"?

A. Genuine praise B. Sarcasm
C. Indifference D. Fearful obedience

8.Which of the following arguments are used by Antony to question the claim that Caesar was ambitious?

A. Caesar brought captives home to Rome.
B. Caesar accepted the crown offered by the Senate.
C. Caesar wept when the poor cried.
D. Caesar filled the public treasury with ransom money.

Choose the correct option from the following:

i) A, B, C, and D ii) A, C, and D
iii) A and D only iv) B, C, and D

9. Identify the **literary device** used in the repeated line 'And Brutus is an honourable man.'

10. [A] Read the lines given below from the poem ***The Mirror*** and write an **appreciation** focusing on its theme and poetic techniques. **(1x5=5)**

Now I am a lake. A woman bends over me,
Searching my reaches for what she really is.
Then she turns to those liars, the candles or the moon.
I see her back, and reflect it faithfully.
She rewards me with tears and an agitation of hands.
I am important to her. She comes and goes.
Each morning it is her face that replaces the darkness.
In me she has drowned a young girl, and in me an old woman
Rises toward her day after day, like a terrible fish.

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OR

10. [B] Given below are the lines from the songs *Another Day in Paradise* by Phil Collins and *Heal the World* by Michael Jackson. Read the lines and write a **paragraph** comparing the themes of both the songs.

Another Day in Paradise	Heal the World
You can tell from the lines on her face You can see that she's been there Probably been moved on from every place 'Cos she didn't fit in there Oh think twice, cause it's another day for You and me in paradise	Heal the world Make it a better place For you and for me And the entire human race There are people dying If you care enough for the living Make a better place For you and for me

Questions 11 - 14: Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow. (4x1=4)

Robotics is the branch of science and technology that deals with the design, construction, and operation of robots. A robot is a machine that can perform tasks automatically, relying on computer programming. Robots are designed to make human life easier, safer, and more efficient.

The field of robotics combines knowledge from mechanics, electronics, computer science, and artificial intelligence. Some robots are controlled by humans and they act according to instructions; while others are autonomous, meaning they can make decisions on their own, guided by sensors and software.

In factories, industrial robots assemble cars and electronic devices with great precision. In medicine, robotic arms assist doctors in performing delicate surgeries. Robots are also used in space exploration, underwater research, disaster management, and various other fields.

In recent years, humanoid robots, machines that resemble human and behave like us, have gained popularity. Educational robots teach programming and problem-solving skills to students. Robotics is an area of rapid growth and development, shaping the future of work and learning. As technology advances, robots will become even more intelligent and efficient.

11. What are the main areas of knowledge combined in robotics?

12. How do humanoid robots differ from human-controlled robots?

13. Which of the following statements best describes a robot?

a) A non-living creature that imitates humans
b) A machine that can perform tasks automatically
c) A computer program that plays games
d) A tool used in factories

14. Which of the following statements about robots are **NOT** true?

A. All robots are humanoid robots.
B. Robots are used in industries, medicine, and space exploration.

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C. Humanoid robots are designed to look and act like humans.
D. Educational robots do not help students learn programming skills.

Choose the correct option from the following:

i. Only A ii. Both A and D
iii. Both A and C iv. A, C and D

Question 15 - 18: Answer either A or B.

15. [A] The story, *The Old Man with Enormous Wings,* portrays how people often respond to the unusual with curiosity, greed, and cruelty instead of compassion or understanding. Prepare a **write-up** on the topic 'The Old Man's Wings: Burden or Blessing?', using evidence from the story to discuss human reactions to the mystery surrounding the angel's presence. **(1x7=7)**

(Hints: - confusion and fear – villagers' curiosity and greed – Pelayo and Elisenda exploit the situation – mockery-imprisonment – the mystery of the old man – the story-a reflection on human nature – suspicion and selfishness – lack of compassion – human reactions to the miraculous – the angel's fight to freedom)

OR

15. [B] In A *Piece of String,* Guy de Maupassant presents the manner in which suspicion and prejudice can distort the truth and destroy an individual's peace of mind. Based on your reading of the story, prepare a short **review** focusing on the themes, the characterisation, and the moral lesson.

(Hints: - Hauchecome – honest - humiliated – Malandain – suspicious and vengeful – the villagers make quick judgements– false accusation - injustice – social prejudice-misunderstanding and ruin)

16. [A] Shakuntala, the foster daughter of Sage Kanva, represents purity and the ideal of natural beauty. Prepare a **character sketch** as revealed in Act I focusing on her innocence, devotion to nature, and her graceful personality. **(1x6=6)**

OR

16. [B] Fatou Diome writes a letter to a friend in Senegal describing her experience in France. In it, she explains the challenges she faces, her feelings toward the French idea of "préférence nationale," and her message for those who dream of working abroad. Draft the **letter**.

17. [A] Srikanth Bolla faced several social and institutional barriers preventing him from pursuing the study of science despite his outstanding performance in the board examinations. The issue was widely covered by the major national newspapers. Prepare a **news article** highlighting the hurdles and challenges he overcame before securing admission to study science. **(1x6=6)**

OR

17. [B] Heavy rains and floods caused widespread devastation in major parts of Uttarakhand, leading to great damage to homes and infrastructure. Prepare a **news report** detailing the impact of the floods on the affected areas, and the ongoing rescue and relief efforts.

(Hints: - Uttarakhand - heavy monsoon rains –cloudbursts and flash floods – widespread destruction in many parts of the state – homes and cars swept away – severe damage to property –

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rivers overflowed – hundreds stranded – dozens killed– roads and bridges damaged – IMD issues red alert – NDRF, SDRF, and fire brigade deployed – landslides caused many fatalities – government announces relief packages – the rescue efforts continue amid all the challenges)

18. [A] Your school's Film Club is producing a short film highlighting the danger and the impacts of rising drug and substance abuse among youth. Prepare two catchy, rhythmic sentences that could serve as **promotional tag lines** for the film. **(1x4=4)**

OR

18. [B] Write a **paragraph** on the theme of prejudice and discrimination in *Préférence Nationale*. Explain how the author highlights issues of racism, inequality, and human dignity in the story.

Questions 19 - 21: Answer all the questions.

19. Using the clues given below, write a **biographical sketch** of Gabriel García Márquez. **(1x6=6)**

Early Life:
- Born on 6 March, 1927, in Aracataca, Colombia
- Studied law at the National University of Colombia but chose a career in journalism

Major Events:
- Worked as a journalist and wrote short stories and novels
- *One Hundred Years of Solitude* in 1967 - brought him worldwide fame
- Active in bringing political and social issues of Latin America to the attention of the world

Accomplishments:
- Pioneer of magical realism
- Best known novels: *Love in the Time of Cholera*, *Chronicle of a Death Foretold*
- Won the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1982

Interesting Facts:
- Known affectionately as “Gabo”
- Inspired by his grandmother’s storytelling.
- Died on 17 April, 2014, in Mexico City

20. With the support of the Young Innovators Programme, you have developed an innovative device, the ‘EcoClean Extractor’ to remove plastic waste from the surroundings. You are planning the grand launch of the product and have invited Srikanth Bolla as the special guest. Prepare an **event invitation** to be send to nearby educational institutions inviting them to attend the ceremony. Include details such as the date, time, venue, and a brief note about your product. **(1x4=4)**

21. Read the passage below and frame **three appropriate WH-questions** and **one Yes/No question** based on it. **(1x4=4)**

And thenceforth, regularly, twice a week, I wrote a letter to Boles, and an answer from Boles to Teresa. She, of course, listened to them, and wept like anything. She roared, I should say, with her bass voice. And in return for my service, she began to mend the holes I had in my socks, shirts, and

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other articles of clothing. Three months later she was thrown into prison for some reason or the other and by now she must surely be dead.

Questions 22-26: Find below blurbs of three global best sellers. Read the blurbs carefully and answer the questions that follow. (5x1=5)

1. *The Alchemist*

Some books are meant to be read, loved, and passed on. *The Alchemist* by Paulo Coelho is one of those books. It tells the story of a shepherd boy from the Spanish region of Andalusia who journeys to the exotic markets of North Africa and then into the Egyptian desert, where a fateful encounter with the alchemist awaits him.

2. *A Brief History of Time*

"One of the most brilliant scientific minds since Einstein." Was there a beginning of time? Could time run backwards? Is the universe infinite or does it have boundaries? These are just some of the questions explored in this internationally acclaimed masterpiece by Stephen Hawking.

3. *The God of Small Things*

"Some lives are shaped by the smallest things."

Arundhati Roy's *The God of Small Things* tells the unforgettable story of fraternal twins, Rahel and Estha, growing up in the town of Ayemenem in Kerala. Their lives are forever altered by family secrets, forbidden love, and strict social rules of caste and tradition.

22. Which literary piece tells the story of a shepherd boy?

23. Who wrote the book that explores questions about time, the universe, and its boundaries**?**

a) Arundhati Roy b) Paulo Coelho
c) Stephen Hawking d) Albert Einstein

24. How are Rahel and Estha's lives forever changed in *The God of Small Things*?

25. Where does the protagonist in *The Alchemist* travel to?

26. Which author's work emphasizes that "some lives are shaped by the smallest things"?

a) Stephen Hawking b) Paulo Coelho
c) Albert Einstein d) Arundhati Roy

27. Edit the passage below. The errors are given in bold. (6x½=3)

Parentel (a) love is not like bread that can be **break** (b) in pieces and split amongst the children in equal shares. A father **give** (c) all his love to each one of **their** (d) children without discrimination, **weather** (e) it be one or ten. If I am suffering now for my two sons, I am not suffering half for each of **they** (f) but double...

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28. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets. **(5x1=5)**

Hauchecome .....(a)..... to the tavern one day, determined to clear his name. He was really .....(b)..... when a group of villagers still doubted him, despite his efforts to prove his innocence. They .....(c)..... mocking and laughing at him. He could not ..... (d)..... their cruel remarks and the humiliation. But he refused to .....(e)..... his efforts, no matter how hopeless they seemed.

(go on, give up, taken aback, put up with, set out)

29. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets. **(6x½=3)**

A marsh harrier tried to swoop .....(a)..... it, as it flew .....(b)..... the military dairy farm, where it flew .....(c)..... the grassy meadow disturbing .....(d)..... foraging Cattle Egret. Then it slowly lifted high .....(e)..... the sky and I watched till it was .....(e)..... speck in the sky.

(of, over, at, in, a, towards, the)

30. Complete the conversation between Bablu and his wife Gowri. **(5x1=5)**

Bablu: Gowri, guess what! I have got something special for you today.

Gowri: Really? .....(a).....?

Bablu: It's a pack of sanitary napkins.

Gowri: Sanitary napkins? But I have heard they are very expensive, ...(b).....?

Bablu: Yes, forty rupees a pack. You had better .....(c).....

Gowri: I know they are healthier than rags. But, if Shalu and I start buying napkins every month, ... (d).....

Bablu: That's true, we may not have money to buy household goods. Would you mind .....(e).....?

Gowri: No. That's impossible! I cannot support you in making sanitary napkins at home.

31. Report the following dialogue. **(2x1=2)**

Szpilman : Please don't shoot! I'm Polish!

Polish lieutenant : What are you doing in the German coat?

a. .....

b. .....

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32. Complete the passage choosing appropriate homonyms from the brackets. (2x1=2)

(watch, ring, fair)

Ravi woke up early one morning to get ready for the village ....(a)..... He looked at his .....(b)..... to check the time. It was seven o'clock. He had to .....(c)..... out for traffic and cycle as fast as he could to purchase the tickets. He was happy to know that the cost of the tickets was .....(d)....., so he could enjoy all the rides and games.

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Model Question Paper - II

ENGLISH

Time : 2½ hrs

Std : X **Total Score: 80**

INSTRUCTIONS:

- ♦ 15 minutes is given as cool off time.
- ♦ This time is to be used for reading the question paper.
- ♦ You are not supposed to write anything during the cool off time.
- ♦ Attempt the questions according to the instructions.

Questions 1 – 5: Read the excerpt taken from *Beloved Boles* and answer the questions that follow. (5x1=5)

And thenceforth, regularly, twice a week, I wrote a letter to Boles, and an answer from Boles to Teresa. She, of course, listened to them, and wept like anything. She roared, I should say, with her bass voice. And in return for my service, she began to mend the holes I had in my socks, shirts, and other articles of clothing. Three months later she was thrown into prison for some reason or the other and by now she must surely be dead.

My acquaintance shook the ash from his cigarette, looked pensively up at the sky, and thus concluded: Well, well, the more a human creature has tasted of bitter things, the more it hungers after the sweet things of life. And we, wrapped in the rags of our virtues, regard others through the mist of our self- sufficiency. Convinced of our righteousness, we do not understand this.

And the whole thing turns out pretty stupidly–and very cruelly. But enough of this. It is all as old as the hills. So old that it is a shame to speak of it. Very old indeed–yes, that's what it is!

1. Why did Teresa weep while listening to the letters?

A) They reminded her of her hardships
B) They were badly written
C) They brought her emotional comfort and memories
D) They contained bad news

2. How did Teresa repay the narrator for writing the letters?

A) By giving him money
B) By cooking meals for him
C) By mending his clothes
D) By protecting him from others

3. Which statements reflect the acquaintance's reflection on human nature?

A) People who suffer value sweetness more deeply
B) Humans judge others through self-righteousness
C) Everyone is naturally kind and understanding
D) People often fail to understand others' pain

Choose the right option

i) A, B and D
ii) A and C
iii) B, C and D
iv) All the above

4. What message does the acquaintance convey through his concluding remarks?

5. Find a word from the passage that means *thoughtfully or deeply.*

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Questions 6 – 9: Read the lines from *Wild Swans at Coole* and answer the questions that follow. (4x1=4)

Unwearied still, lover by lover,
They paddle in the cold
Companionable streams or climb the air;
Their hearts have not grown old;
Passion or conquest, wander where they will,
Attend upon them still.

But now they drift on the still water,
Mysterious, beautiful;
Among what rushes will they build,
By what lake's edge or pool
Delight men's eyes when I awake some day
To find they have flown away?

6. How do the swans paddle and soar?
7. Why does the sight of the swans fail to delight the poet?
8. Which poetic device is used in the line ‘Passion or conquest, wander where they will, Attend upon them still’.
   i. Simile ii. Metaphor
   iii. Personification iv. Irony
9. Find out the rhyme scheme of the stanza.

10. [A] Read the following lines from the poem *The Seedling* and prepare an **appreciation** focussing on the theme, the poetic devices and the contemporary relevance of the poem.

Little folks, be like the seedling,
Always do the best you can;
Every child must share life’s labour
Just as well as every man.

And the sun and showers will help you
Through the lonesome, struggling hours,
Till you raise to light and beauty
Virtue’s fair, unfading flower

OR

10. [B] Write a **paragraph** comparing the themes of the songs below. **(1x5=5)**

Another Day in Paradise (Phil Collins)	**Heal the World (Michael Jackson)**
You can tell from the lines on her face You can see that she's been there, Probably been moved on from every place 'Cause she didn't fit in there.	Heal the world Make it a better place For you and for me And the entire human race

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Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for You and me in paradise. Oh, think twice, it's just another day for you, You and me in paradise.	There are people dying If you care enough for the living Make a better place For you and for me

Questions 11 - 14: Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow. (4x1=4)

In recent years, community libraries have begun to reappear in towns and villages, taking on new forms and purposes. Unlike traditional libraries that focused mainly on silent reading, modern community libraries function as shared learning spaces. They offer books, newspapers, digital resources, and even workshops for people of all ages. These libraries play a crucial role in promoting reading habits, especially among children who may not have access to books at home. Community libraries also help bridge the digital divide. Many of them provide free internet access and basic computer training, enabling people to apply for jobs, access government services, and learn new skills. For elderly people, these spaces offer a sense of belonging, while young learners benefit from group activities such as storytelling sessions and reading clubs.

Beyond education, community libraries strengthen social bonds. They encourage interaction among people from different backgrounds and promote values such as cooperation and mutual respect. In a world increasingly dominated by individual screen time, these libraries remind us of the importance of shared spaces for collective growth. By nurturing curiosity and lifelong learning, community libraries quietly contribute to the intellectual and social development of society.

11. Which of the following best describes the role of modern community libraries?
    A. Places meant only for storing old books
    B. Silent spaces restricted to individual reading
    C. Shared learning spaces that support education and social interaction
    D. Centres used only by students preparing for examinations
12. Which of the following benefits of community libraries are mentioned in the passage?
    A. Providing free internet access
    B. Offering workshops and group activities
    C. Supplying financial aid to villagers
    D. Helping people access government services

Choose the correct option from the following:

i) B and C only ii) A and C only
iii) A, B, and D iv) A, B, C, and D

13. How do community libraries help bridge the digital divide?
14. According to the passage, how do community libraries strengthen social bonds?

Question 15 - 18: Answer either A or B.

15. [A] The narrator mentions that her "Senegalese cat has his papers" while she does not have hers, adding, "Perhaps it's because he's ginger." What is the narrator suggesting about the French bureaucracy or the country's priorities by drawing this comparison between her cat's immigration status and her own? Prepare a **write up**.

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[[Hints: personal irony in narration – contrast between human and animal status – bureaucracy valuing documents over dignity – hint of racial bias in the "ginger" remark – absurdity of immigration laws – dehumanisation of migrants – satire on French administrative priorities – emotional pain hidden under humour – criticism of preference nationale – message on identity, belonging, and justice] **(1x7=7)**

OR

15. [B] Prepare a **review** of the short story *War*, focusing on its portrayal of human emotions and the theme of loss.
[Hints: train journey – parents of soldiers – false bravery – grieving mother – suppressed sorrow – irony – impact of war – universal suffering]

16. [A] Prepare a **character sketch** of the old man in *A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings*. Highlight his appearance, behaviour, and symbolic significance in the story. **(1x6=6)**

OR

16. [B] Using the character of Teresa, prepare a **paragraph** explaining the contrast between her harsh outward appearance and her inner emotional need. What message does Gorky convey about the way society treats people like her?

[Hints: Teresa's frightening appearance – people's fear and judgement – her need for love and attention – letters as emotional comfort – kindness hidden behind rough behaviour – society ignoring inner pain – judging people by looks – Gorky's message on sympathy and understanding]

17. [A] Kerala School Olympics held at Thiruvananthapuram was applauded for its meticulous planning and masterly execution. Prepare a **news report** of the sports event. **(1x6=6)**

[Hints: Held across 12 venues from 21st to 28th February - nearly 20000 students participated - 24 new records including 17 in athletics - Thiruvananthapuram becomes the overall champions with 1825 points - receives the Chief Minister's Gold Cup - Malappuram emerges Champions in athletics - Honourable Governor appreciates the Olympic - style State School Sports Meet]

OR

17. [B] After listening to the public crier's announcement, Malandain decided to draft an email to the Mayor accusing Hauchcome of stealing the pocketbook. Draft the likely **email.**

18. [A] The Talent Club of your school plans to discuss the topic 'Advancement in Technology Makes us Lazy'. Fill in the blanks with suitable ideas **for and against** the motion, giving valid arguments to support your views. **(1x4=4)**

Arguments in favour of the topic (Advancement in Technology Makes us Lazy)

1. _____
2. _____

Arguments against the topic (Advancement in Technology Makes us Lazy)

1. _____
2. _____

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OR

18. [B] Imagine that Salim Ali writes a diary entry after his first serious birdwatching experience. Write the **diary** entry expressing his excitement and curiosity.

Questions 19 - 21: Answer all the questions.

19. Read the passage below and frame **three Wh-questions** and **one Yes/No question** based on it. **(1x4=4)**

Hauchecome had just arrived at Goderville, and he was walking towards the public square. Then he saw a little piece of string on the ground. He thought that everything useful ought to be picked up. He took the bit of thin cord from the ground and began to roll it carefully. Then he noticed Malandain, on the threshold of his door, looking at him. They were on bad terms with each other. Hauchecome was seized with shame to be seen thus by his enemy. He concealed his find quickly in his trousers pocket. He pretended to be looking on the ground for something else. Then, he went towards the market.

20. The Nature Club of your school plans to celebrate the World Bird Day on 5 January. You decide to invite the famous ornithologist Neelakandan to your school as the chief guest of the function to create an awareness about the importance of caring for the trees and birds in nature. Draft an **event invitation** to the nearby schools to participate in the event. Include date, time, venue, other details of the event and the credentials of the chief guest. **(1x4=4)**

21. Using the details below, write a **biographical sketch** of Dr. Salim Ali. **(1x6=6)**

Title	:	_____
Early Life	:	born in 1896, Bombay – loses parents at an early age – early interest in birds - studies zoology – higher studies in Germany under a famous ornithologist
Major Events	:	begins bird watching as a hobby - conducts bird surveys across India - publishes *The Book of Indian Birds* - works with Bombay Natural History Society - advocates for wildlife conservation
Major Accomplishments	:	recognized as the 'Birdman of India' - author of several books on Indian birds - recipient of Padma Bhushan (1958) and Padma Vibhushan (1976)- his research transforms bird study in India - establishes bird sanctuaries and conservation laws
Interesting Facts	:	efforts save the Bharatpur Bird Sanctuary - birthday (November 12) - celebrated as National Bird Watching Day - researcher even in old age – inspires generations of nature lovers and scientists

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Questions 22 - 26: The following are the details of certain mountain ranges. Study the details carefully and answer the questions that follow: (4x1=4)

1. Himalayan Mountains Location : India, Nepal, Bhutan, China (Tibet), Pakistan Highest Peak : Mount Everest (8,848 m / 29,029 ft) Length : Approximately 2,400 km Formation : Formed 50 million years ago due to collision of Indian and Eurasian tectonic plates
2. Andes Mountains Location : Western South America Highest Peak : Aconcagua (6,961 m / 22,838 ft) Length : About 7,000 km Formation : Formed by subduction of the Nazca Plate beneath the South American Plate
3. Atlas Mountains Location : North Africa Highest Peak : Toubkal (4,167 m / 13,671 ft) Length : Around 2,500 km Formation : Result of the collision between the African and Eurasian tectonic plates
4. Alps Mountains Location : Central Europe Highest Peak : Mont Blanc (4,808 m / 15,774 ft) Length : Approximately 1,200 km Formation : Formed by the collision of the African and Eurasian tectonic plates

22. Which one is the longest among the mountain ranges mentioned below?

A. Himalayas B. Alps
C. Andes D. Atlas

23. Which mountain ranges were formed due to the collision of the African and Eurasian tectonic plates?

i) Atlas Mountains ii) Alps Mountains
iii) Andes Mountains iv) Himalayan Mountains

Choose the right option:

A. i and ii B. ii and iii
C. ii and iv D. ii, iii and iv

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24. Among all the peaks mentioned above, which one is the highest?

25. Which mountain range is spread across the Asian continent?

26. Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the brackets. (6x $^{1}/_{2}$=3)

At 7.10 p.m. I rang _____(a) number. A woman answered. She told me she was ____(b) cashier at one of the big Strasbourg supermarkets. She was looking _____(c) someone to tutor her eleven-year-old daughter. She suggested meeting _____(d) following afternoon, in a city-centre café. When I arrived at the cafe it was packed, _____(e) Madame had told me she would _____(f) wearing 'a white jersey with blue stripes'. I spotted her immediately.

(an, the, a, for, the,but, be)

27. Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets. (4x1=4)

After _____ (a) for her self-respect, Fatou Diome refuses to _____ (b) excuses for discrimination. Though such bias can _____ (c) lives, she helps a friend who is _____ (d) her studies.

(put up, give up, stand up, break up, finish up, make up, ring up)

28. Complete the passage choosing appropriate words from the brackets. (4x$^{1}/_{2}$=2)

Bablu is in a dilemma .....(a)..... (if/although) he has started working on the sanitary pad project. Neither his family nor the villagers .....(b)..... (support/supports) him in his new venture. Now, he has the choice of .....(c)..... (neither/either) giving up on his dream ..... (d)..... (or/nor) staying determined to go ahead with it.

29. Report the following dialogue. (2x1=2)

Neighbour : Please take care of the angel. The poor fellow is so old that the rain has knocked him down.

Pelayo : Sure. I'll lock him up with hens in the chicken coop.

a. .....

b. .....

30. Complete the conversation between Narrator and Teresa. (4x1=4)

Narrator : _____(a)_____?

Teresa : I can, but it feels embarrassing! _____(b)_____!

Narrator : Do you mind if I suggest a change?

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Teresa : _____(c)_____

Narrator : Sorry to interrupt, but you had better _____(d)_____.

Teresa : I know, but I fear the truth.

Narrator : If Boles knew everything, _____(e)_____.

Teresa : Perhaps. I would rather imagine him kind.

Narrator : You care about him deeply, _____(f)_____?

Teresa : Yes, it feels real even if he doesn't exist.

31. Edit the passage. The errors are shown in bold. **($6x^1/_2 = 3$)**

If you're married **on** (a) a French citizen, **it** (b) will now take two years for you to claim **an** (c) benefits of citizenship. By this delay, Mr Borders **are** (d) relying on the nature of his countrymen to break up the **relationship** (e). Then, as the ex-wife of a Frenchman, the foreign woman becomes no more than an ex-object. And as with any object, she has no **right** (f), not even the right to earn an honest living.

32. Complete the passage using appropriate words from the brackets. **($6x^1/_2 = 3$)**

They won't give me citizenship, _____(a) my Senegalese cat has his papers. Perhaps it's because he's ginger. Laws ____(b) gather pace when ordinary people start applying them. Termites can cause _____(c) collapse of African mahogany trees, and the size of ____(d) anthill depends on the number of worker ants. It ____ (e) thus small employers_____(f) make the policy of the preference nationale effective.

(is, the, but, an, only, of, who)